Town Manager's Financial Plan

Fiscal Year 2027

Christopher G. Senior, Town Manager
Mark J. Twogood, Assistant Town Manager
Stacie Ward, Comptroller

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SECTION I

Transmittal Letter

Town of Winchester
Christopher G. Senior
Town Manager

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Budget Transmittal Letter

TO: Honorable Select Board and Finance Committee
FROM: Christopher Senior, Town Manager
DATE: February 15, 2026
SUBJECT: Town Manager's FY 2027 Financial Plan

Pursuant to Chapter 4, Section 1.2 of the Winchester Code of Bylaws, I present the proposed budget for Fiscal Year 2027.

Since the adoption of the FY 2026 budget by Town Meeting in May of 2025, the Winchester community has been engaged in an intensive analysis of short- and long-term municipal finances and how best to address both rising operational costs as well as ways to incorporate important new initiatives into the budget. Known as the State of the Town, this working group represents a cross-section of Winchester's elected and appointed leadership. Working with Town staff, this group produced a wealth of information on everything from capital budgeting to educational priorities to non-property tax revenues. The State of the Town consensus reached after months of discussion is that seven years after the adoption of the last Proposition 2 ½ operating override in 2019, it is time to present Winchester voters with another operating override question in 2026. On February 12, 2026, the Select Board certified such a question for the ballot for the March 21, 2026, Town Election.

Under Winchester's Bylaws, this proposed budget must be presented in February, a month before the override question reaches the ballot. Therefore, this budget must be built based on the fiscal realities of the moment, not on any potential override. The Finance Committee will take up the budget process next and will be working over the next several months on developing an FY27 budget to present to Town Meeting. During this time FinCom will have the opportunity to make changes to the budget based on new information, and I and other staff will work closely with them as they deliberate.

So, with that preface, let me present the proposed FY 27 Winchester Budget.

The Budget Process

Winchester is governed by a Town Charter, approved in 1975, which designates a five-member elected Select Board as the executive branch, a representative Town Meeting of 192

members, 24 elected from each of eight precincts, as the legislative branch, and a professional manager appointed by the Select Board to serve as the Chief Administrative Officer. It is the Town Manager's responsibility under the Charter to prepare a proposed annual budget, which is then presented to the Finance Committee in February for public review and deliberation. This review generally takes place from February through April, with the Finance Committee's budget presented to Town Meeting for adoption in May.

Town staff begin preparing their budgets in the fall, with meetings taking place into December as a final proposed budget takes shape. In January the Town receives updates on the cost of benefits and insurance, as well as the proposed costs and revenue sharing in the Governor's fiscal year budget (with the largest single items being Chapter 70 School Aid and Unrestricted General Government Aid).

This year, following the year-long community conversation led by the State of the Town working group, the Select Board voted to instruct the Town Manager to limit the use of free cash in developing the FY27 budget. The vote allowed for the use of $2.1 million in projected FY26 turnbacks/surplus revenue (as projected by the State of the Town model), with a cap on the use of additional free cash to a range of not more than $3 - $4 million. Following that directive, the proposed total budget figure presented here includes the $2.1 million of turnbacks/surplus revenue projected from FY26 as well as $3 million in additional free cash.

The Proposed Budget

The proposed FY27 budget totals $171,733,429 across all departments and expense lines, which represents a 3.18% increase from FY26. It will require that $1,737,059 be cut from the proposed budgets, shared proportionately by the municipal, school and undistributed budgets as noted in the budget summary in the next section. Addressing these gaps will require additional conversations in the weeks ahead.

Among the highlights:

Revenue

- **Property tax** remains the Town's primary revenue source. The property tax levy is permitted to increase 2.5% over the prior year, plus the taxable value of new construction, also known as new growth. Prior year new growth becomes part of the tax base, and FY26's new growth added into next year's base brings the FY27 levy increase to a total of 3.77% (this does not include debt exclusions, capital/building reserve funds, or Chapter 110)
- **New growth:** Based on the recommendation of the Director of Assessments, the new growth projection for FY27 is $750,000, reduced from the FY26 actual figure of $1,302,085.
- **State aid:** The Governor's proposed FY27 budget allocates a total of $13,800,793 in state aid to Winchester, up 2.71% from FY26. These preliminary figures are

subject to change as the budget moves through the House and Senate on Beacon Hill and may be updated prior to Town Meeting.

- **Local receipts** increase to $12,671,000 for FY27, which includes additional revenue in projected investment income as well as additional revenue based on the adoption of a new building and zoning fee schedule.
- **Overlay reserve:** On February 6, 2026, the Board of Assessor's voted to release $450,000 from the overlay surplus account. This proposed budget includes the use of these funds in FY27
- As noted above, this budget utilizes $2.1 million in projected **FY26 turnbacks/surplus revenue** plus an additional $3 million in available **free cash.**

Expenses

- **Municipal department budgets** reflect an overall increase of 4.62%, primarily attributable to the implementation of two years of contract salary adjustments and enhanced investment in the IT Department's cybersecurity infrastructure. This recommendation maintains existing service delivery without the addition of new staff positions.
- The **School Department** level services budget increases 5%. (The School Committee's adopted budget, which includes strategic additions, increases 8.3% and assumes the passage of an override, is included within).
- **Undistributed expenses**, which cover shared and mandated expenses like energy costs, employee benefits, and insurance, rise 9.93%, including:
    - **Health Insurance** base rate increases for active employee plans of 14.4%, and 10% for Medicare supplemental plans for retirees
    - **Worker's Comp** increase of 12.82% to cover active claims
    - **General Insurance** increase of 5.88% for property/casualty coverage
    - **Contributory Retirement** increase of 4.83%

As noted above, this proposed budget includes unallocated reductions spread among the three primary cost centers – municipal, schools, and unallocated. The figures are identified in red on the spreadsheet which follows. Outlines of how these gaps would be filled were presented at the Special Town Meeting of February 9, 2026. Further conversations will take place on specific next steps, heavily influenced by the outcome of the March 21 election.

The Financial Environment

Federal cuts, particularly to research grants and health care, have placed increasing pressure on Beacon Hill lawmakers as they develop the FY27 State Budget. While the Governor's budget contains no cuts to local aid, it falls short of addressing sharply increased costs impacting both general municipal and school budgets, including health care expenses and special education, to name two of the most significant.

Despite these fiscal challenges, Winchester's financial foundation remains strong. Moody's has assigned Winchester a AAA rating, most recently affirmed in a February 2025 report. This

rating provides significant savings when the Town borrows for long-term capital investments, including the recently completed Lynch Elementary School and a host of smaller drainage and other flood mitigation projects. Moody's next rating update will be released later this February.

Looking Ahead

Winchester went into the FY26 budget process with a $3.9 million deficit, funded with $3.5 million of free cash and $400,000 of the overlay surplus. While this filled the budget gap, it did not correct the underlying expense and revenue imbalance.

Planning for the FY27 budget started with an even larger imbalance, fueled by the ever-increasing costs of employee benefits, as well as contractual settlements necessary to retain and maintain a strong professional staff across school and municipal operations.

Winchester's budget remains highly dependent on the real property tax, which covered roughly 73% of the FY26 budget (including debt exclusions for capital projects). Some 95% of that number is generated by residential property. State aid and local receipts combine to cover about 15% of the budget.

As part of the effort to help ease some of that burden, the Select Board has charged the Town Manager's office with developing a plan to generate more non-property tax revenue. This budget reflects first steps in these areas, with the first new building and zoning fee schedule since 2021 heading for the Select Board, and updated revenue targets for investment income being implemented. Work will continue in the months ahead on these and other efforts to find new non-property tax revenue.

The Select Board has also directed the Town Manager's office to look at ways to address current and future employee benefit costs. With Winchester on target to fund its accrued pension obligations in FY28 (ahead of the state mandated deadline), funding the future costs of retiree health coverage remains an ever-growing challenge.

Conclusion

Winchester's tradition of making investments in its people, its programs and services, and its critical infrastructure are central to the community's success. As discussions begin on this proposal and residents address longer-term financial decisions, these traditions anchor Winchester's fiscal foundation.

My thanks to all those who are instrumental in preparing this budget, particularly Assistant Town Manager Mark Twogood, Jennifer Cafarella in the Town Manager's office, Comptroller Stacie Ward and her staff, Superintendent Dr. Frank Hackett and his team, Town Department heads, as well as all the boards and committees involved in the budget process, especially

the Select Board, School Committee, Finance Committee, and all those who served on the State of the Town working group.

Respectfully submitted,

Christopher Senior
Town Manager

SECTION II

Revenues, Expenses and Reserves

Revenues

CATEGORY	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 PROJECTION
TAX REVENUE			
Property Tax Revenue	101,145,681	104,763,783	108,717,515
Property Tax to Cap & Bldg Stab Funds	7,234,997	7,415,872	7,601,269
New Growth Revenue	1,059,299	1,302,085	750,000
Water & Sewer	5,235,015	5,808,298	5,907,470
Debt Exclusion Override Tax Revenue:			
Lincoln	228,170	-	-
Vinson-Owen	978,298	954,240	925,592
High School	5,075,711	4,964,446	4,857,570
Wright-Locke Farm	236,049	230,986	225,923
Aberjona River Culvert	400,525	400,775	400,525
Skillings Environmental Remediation	237,931	242,181	240,931
Skillings Turf Field	204,390	202,140	204,640
McCall Renovations Phase I & II	603,903	603,278	601,778
Muraco Repairs	276,750	266,500	256,250
Lynch School (including Parkhurst Swing Space)	2,530,898	3,798,713	4,124,345
Muraco Culvert	328,799	287,252	613,299
Adjustments - from reserves for debt premiums	(2,834)	(2,547)	(2,322)
Total Debt Exclusions	11,098,590	11,947,964	12,448,531
TOTAL TAX REVENUE	**125,773,582**	**131,238,002**	**135,424,785**
STATE REVENUE			
Cherry Sheet State Aid	12,677,768	13,436,484	13,800,793
TOTAL STATE REVENUE	**12,677,768**	**13,436,484**	**13,800,793**
LOCAL RECEIPTS			
Motor Vehicle Excise & Boat Excise	4,970,351	4,390,000	4,715,000
Meals Tax	273,124	225,000	300,000
Penalties & Interest	358,406	300,000	377,000
PILOT Payment	138,000	138,000	138,000
Trash Disposal	2,618,684	2,400,000	2,533,000
Fees (includes Ambulance fees)	1,225,150	1,200,000	1,260,000
Rentals	63,861	15,000	15,000
Cemetery	206,225	190,000	218,000
Other Departmental	85,194	35,000	74,000
Building Permits	1,513,947	1,300,000	1,587,000
Other Licenses & Permits	499,421	450,000	500,000
Fines & Forfeits	76,515	50,000	74,000
Investment Income	1,845,719	600,000	750,000
Medicaid Reimbursement	127,514	45,000	130,000
Miscellaneous Non-recurring	52,328	-	-
TOTAL LOCAL RECEIPTS	**14,054,439**	**11,338,000**	**12,671,000**
STABILIZATION FUND TRANSFERS IN			
Building Stabilization - to fund debt service	1,702,486	1,106,307	738,175
Capital Stabilization - to fund debt service	666,708	738,455	703,678
Building Stabilization - to fund capital	3,530,000	2,600,000	*TBD*
Capital Stabilization - to fund capital	2,801,000	2,673,421	*TBD*
TOTAL STABILIZATION TRANSFERS IN	**8,700,194**	**7,118,183**	**1,441,853**
OTHER TRANSFERS IN			
Enterprise Funds - Indirects & Other	2,244,725	2,316,953	2,332,676
Parking Meter Fund	125,000	105,000	90,000
Parking Meter Fund - Wedgemere/Town Center	42,000	20,000	*TBD*
Cemetery Perpetual Care	140,000	140,000	140,000
Transfer from Other Funds	463,693	379,000	80,000
Unallocated Wage Article Fund	532,214	128,646	-
TOTAL OTHER TRANSFERS IN	**3,547,632**	**3,089,599**	**2,642,676**
FUND BALANCE AND FREE CASH			
Free Cash - Annual operating budget	980,412	3,761,689	5,100,000
Free Cash - Strategic maintenance	200,000	200,000	200,000
Free Cash - One-time capital/other uses	3,655,000	520,000	-
Fund Balance - Reserved for debt premiums	2,834	2,547	2,322
Fund Balance - Reserved for overlay	-	400,000	450,000
TOTAL FUND BALANCE AND FREE CASH	**4,838,246**	**4,884,236**	**5,752,322**
TOTAL REVENUES	**169,591,861**	**171,104,504**	**171,733,429**

Expenses

CATEGORY	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
GENERAL GOVERNMENT						
1210 Town Manager	1,115,709	1,044,055	1,092,897	1,092,837	1,092,837	0
1310 Finance Committee	5,000	2,979	3,000	3,000	3,000	0
1330 Comptroller	592,315	573,413	609,403	628,066	628,066	0
1340 Assessor's	437,679	405,732	435,500	423,762	423,762	0
1350 Treasurer/Collector	554,564	528,184	586,937	610,676	610,676	0
1360 Audit	98,000	97,750	90,000	102,000	102,000	0
1412 Engineering	688,314	625,163	689,542	572,351	700,829	0
1413 Building	576,981	569,082	649,053	759,999	679,999	0
1415 Conservation	101,006	98,511	103,507	197,537	110,787	0
1420 Planning Board	244,624	211,804	241,962	252,855	252,855	0
1510 Legal	500,000	423,085	500,000	500,000	500,000	0
1520 Human Resources/ADA	276,333	266,760	285,216	322,502	291,167	0
1530 Information Technology	853,500	822,104	880,588	1,033,957	1,033,957	0
1540 General Services	163,750	150,985	163,750	164,150	164,150	0
1610 Town Clerk	648,602	602,343	613,692	686,861	686,861	0
TOTAL GENERAL GOVERNMENT	**6,856,377**	**6,421,949**	**6,945,047**	**7,350,553**	**7,280,946**	**0**
CULTURE						
6110 Library	2,497,619	2,413,104	2,620,594	2,679,056	2,699,056	0
6940 Archival Center	23,512	23,356	25,107	39,914	25,457	0
6941 Historical Commission	6,000	2,767	15,500	15,500	3,000	0
TOTAL CULTURE	**2,527,131**	**2,439,227**	**2,661,201**	**2,734,470**	**2,727,513**	**0**
HEALTH/SOCIAL						
5110 Health	515,585	473,805	562,888	600,774	545,716	0
5410 Council on Aging	471,276	468,476	497,867	565,957	511,457	0
5420 Veterans' Services	55,623	44,422	55,853	56,153	56,153	0
TOTAL HEALTH/SOCIAL	**1,042,484**	**986,704**	**1,116,608**	**1,222,884**	**1,113,326**	**0**
PUBLIC SAFETY						
2110 Police Department	6,762,425	6,631,297	6,695,005	6,833,211	6,833,211	0
2210 Fire Department	7,297,750	6,995,662	7,346,844	7,485,903	7,485,903	0
2420 Sealer of Weights and Measures	11,250	9,605	11,480	11,480	11,480	0
TOTAL PUBLIC SAFETY	**14,071,425**	**13,636,564**	**14,053,329**	**14,330,594**	**14,330,594**	**0**
PUBLIC WORKS						
4100 DPW	9,489,711	9,274,224	9,693,288	9,926,966	9,926,966	0
4171 Snow and Ice	797,139	795,280	500,000	500,000	500,000	0
TOTAL PUBLIC WORKS	**10,286,850**	**10,069,504**	**10,193,288**	**10,426,966**	**10,426,966**	**0**
UNALLOCATED EXPENSES	**0**	**0**	**340,719**	**1,061,000**	**1,061,000**	**0**
MUNICIPAL REDUCTIONS					**(486,377)**	
TOTAL MUNICIPAL	**34,784,267**	**33,553,948**	**35,310,192**	**37,126,467**	**36,453,969**	**0**
EDUCATION						
3100 Schools	66,144,295	66,135,644	70,415,718	73,936,504	73,936,504	0
School Reductions					**(972,753)**	
3610 Vocational School	278,993	187,416	340,000	402,201	402,201	0
TOTAL EDUCATION	**66,423,288**	**66,323,061**	**70,755,718**	**74,338,705**	**73,365,952**	**0**
TOTAL MUNICIPAL AND EDUCATION	**101,207,555**	**99,877,008**	**106,065,910**	**111,465,172**	**109,819,920**	**0**

CATEGORY	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
UNDISTRIBUTED						
1910 Energy	2,156,861	2,154,504	2,234,456	2,263,541	2,153,541	0
Personnel Benefits						
9110 Contributory Retirement	7,098,270	7,098,270	7,462,210	7,822,682	7,822,682	0
9120 Workers' Compensation	350,000	322,371	390,000	540,000	440,000	0
9130 Unemployment Compensation	90,000	84,715	100,000	100,000	100,000	0
9140 Health Insurance	14,045,550	13,975,912	16,240,716	18,944,732	18,866,219	0
9150 Medicare Tax	1,254,250	1,248,921	1,306,463	1,550,000	1,500,000	0
9623 GASB OPEB Fund	350,000	350,000	350,000	350,000	350,000	0
Miscellaneous						
9450 General Insurance	693,000	605,103	765,000	850,000	810,000	0
9430 Reserve Fund	412,496	0	400,000	400,000	400,000	0
9460 Environmental Remediation Services	54,600	54,600	74,000	70,000	70,000	0
Undistributed reductions					**(277,929)**	
TOTAL UNDISTRIBUTED	**26,505,027**	**25,894,396**	**29,322,845**	**32,890,955**	**32,234,512**	**0**
CAPITAL APPROPRIATIONS						
Current Year Expenditures						
Capital Articles (General Fund Revenues/Free Cash/RFT)	2,975,000	2,975,000	300,000	0	0	
Capital Articles (from Cemetery)	70,000	70,000	70,000	70,000	70,000	
Capital/Building Stabilization Fund (Direct Appropriations)	6,331,000	6,331,000	5,273,421	0	0	
Capital Strategic Maintenance (from Free Cash)	200,000	200,000	200,000	200,000	200,000	
1711 Funded Debt	7,555,000	7,555,000	7,418,500	7,680,000	7,680,000	
1712 Interest on Funded Debt	6,760,185	6,760,185	7,186,378	6,855,035	6,855,035	
Sub-Total Current Year Expenditures	**23,891,185**	**23,891,185**	**20,448,299**	**14,805,035**	**14,805,035**	**0**
Capital Fund Transfers						
1961 Building Stabilization - Annual Appropriation	3,637,485	3,637,485	3,728,422	3,821,633	3,821,633	
Building/Capital Stabilization - Additional transfer	30,000	30,000	30,000	0	0	
1962 Capital Stabilization - Annual Appropriation	3,597,512	3,597,512	3,687,450	3,779,636	3,779,636	
Sub-Total Capital Fund Transfers	**7,264,997**	**7,264,997**	**7,445,872**	**7,601,269**	**7,601,269**	**0**
TOTAL CAPITAL & DEBT SERVICE	**31,156,182**	**31,156,182**	**27,894,171**	**22,406,304**	**22,406,304**	**0**
NON-APPROPRIATED						
State Assessments	659,940	662,126	719,415	737,400	722,120	
Allowance for Abatements/Overlay	305,647	305,647	453,943	465,292	400,000	
Cherry Sheet Offsets (non General Fund State Aid)	55,836	55,836	55,561	56,950	58,103	
TOTAL NON-APPROPRIATED	**1,021,423**	**1,023,609**	**1,228,919**	**1,259,642**	**1,180,223**	**0**
OTHER						
Water & Sewer	5,235,015	5,235,015	5,808,298	5,907,470	5,907,470	
Recreation General Fund Subsidy	175,000	175,000	175,000	175,000	175,000	
Transfer to Cultural Council Special Fund	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	
Transfers to Healthcare & Health Insurance Stabilization Fun	125,000	125,000	70,000	0	0	
Transfers to Capital Project Funds	2,000,000	2,000,000	0	0	0	
Other Special Article Appropriations	597,000	597,000	319,000	0	0	
TOTAL OTHER	**8,142,015**	**8,142,015**	**6,382,298**	**6,092,470**	**6,092,470**	**0**
TOTAL EXPENSES	**168,032,202**	**166,093,210**	**170,894,144**	**174,114,543**	**171,733,429**	**0**

Reserves

Operating Reserves as a Percentage of Estimated Revenue	
General Fund Undesignated Fund Balance (6/30/25)	23,280,286
General Stabilization Fund (12/31/25)	5,363,884
Total Operating Reserves	28,644,170
Free Cash used at Fall 2025 Town Meeting	(671,000)
Estimated Free Cash uses at Spring 2026 Town Meeting:	
For FY26 Supplemental	(500,000)
Other potential estimates	(500,000)
For FY27 Budget	(5,100,000)
Estimated Undesignated Fund balance replishment	3,800,000
Total after uses, potential uses and replenishment	25,673,170
Total FY26 Estimate Revenue	160,359,144
Operating Reserves as a % of FY26 Estimated Revenue	16.0%

SECTION III

Service Programs – General Government

Town Manager (1210)

Finance Committee (1310)

Comptroller (1330)

Assessors (1340)

Treasurers/Collector (1350)

Audit (1360)

Engineering (1412)

Conservation (1415)

Planning Board (1420)

Legal (1510)

Human Resources/ADA (1520)

Information Technology (1530)

General Services (1540)

Town Clerk (1610)

TOWN MANAGER

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	896,823	965,347	955,037	955,037	0
Other Expenses	147,232	127,550	137,800	137,800	0
Total	1,044,055	1,092,897	1,092,837	1,092,837	0
Staffing					
Managerial	3	3	3	3	
Clerical	1	1	1	1	
Professional/Technical	3	3	3	3	
Total	7	7	7	7	0

Program Description

The Select Board appoints the Town Manager, and most of the duties and responsibilities are detailed in the Town Charter, first adopted in 1975. The Manager is responsible for the day-to-day operations of the Town, including the appointment of department heads and employees not serving directly under elected boards, for the enforcement of State Law, Town by-laws and the Town Charter, and for preparing and administering the Town's annual budget, purchasing supplies and materials for all Town agencies, and awarding all contracts for all agencies. The Sustainability Department is included in the Town Manager's budget.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Develop a policy on managing health insurance expenses for review by the Select Board
- Create a Transfer Station working group to review all fees and charges and report back to the Select Board by July 1
- Work with Select Board on an analysis of OPEB expenses
- Work with the Capital Planning Committee on updating the capital planning process
- Complete the employee compensation and classification study
- Work with WCCP to implement grant agreement process and continue to build out the approval and grant management process
- Work with Affordable Housing Trust to complete the 160 Forest Street project and other initiatives

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Worked with WCCP to implement the Community Preservation Act
- Worked with the State of the Town working group to review Town Finances
- Onboarded a new Town Manager

		TOWN MANAGER	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0112101	51101	PERMANENT	922,898	876,115	929,797	921,237	921,237	
0112101	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	6,750	5,143	11,250	9,500	9,500	
0112101	51251	TEMPORARY	10,000	6,069	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0112101	51359	OVERTIME	5,000	196	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0112101	51900	AUTO ALLOWANCE	0	9,300	9,300	9,300	9,300	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**944,648**	**896,823**	**965,347**	**955,037**	**955,037**	**0**
0112102	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	5,000	3,893	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0112102	52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUC SUPPLI	1,500	2,195	1,500	2,000	2,000	
0112102	52105	COMPUTER SUPPLIES	4,000	2,874	8,000	6,000	6,000	
0112102	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	450	613	450	600	600	
0112102	52180	FOOD & GROCERIES	500	271	500	500	500	
0112102	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	6,200	6,035	6,200	6,200	6,200	
0112102	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	1,200	9,464	2,200	5,000	5,000	
0112102	53105	DPTMENTL REPORTS	1,200	0	1,200	0	0	
0112102	53106	REPRODUCING SVC	0	0	0	0	0	
0112102	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	0	2,860	0	3,000	3,000	
0112102	53115	ADVERTISING	6,000	1,971	6,000	5,000	5,000	
0112102	53117	BIND & BK REPAIRS	0	0	0	0	0	
0112102	53117	AUTO ALLOWANCE	9,000	0	0	0	0	
0112102	53118	PROF SERVICES	119,711	107,526	70,000	80,000	80,000	
0112102	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0112102	53123	OUT OF STATE TRAVEL	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0112102	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	1,000	185	5,000	4,000	4,000	
0112102	53166	TUITION	2,800	1,620	4,000	4,000	4,000	
0112102	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	10,000	7,726	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0112102	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	0	0	5,000	2,000	2,000	
0112102	54106	INSURANCE/SURETY	500	0	500	2,500	2,500	
0112102	54129	BANK SERVICE CHARGES	0	0	0	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**171,061**	**147,232**	**127,550**	**137,800**	**137,800**	**0**
		TOWN MANAGER TOTAL	**1,115,709**	**1,044,055**	**1,092,897**	**1,092,837**	**1,092,837**	**0**

FINANCE COMMITTEE

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	2,504	2,800	2,800	2,800	0
Other Expenses	475	200	200	200	0
Total	2,979	3,000	3,000	3,000	0

Program Description

The Finance Committee consists of fifteen voters appointed for staggered three-year terms. Five appointments are made annually by appointing committee consisting of the Moderator, and the Chairman of the Select Board and Finance Committee respectively. Under the provision of the Town Charter and ByLaws, the Finance Committee receives and reviews the proposed budget submitted by the Town Manager, and after public hearings, submits a budget to the Town Meeting. The ongoing function of the Committee is to act upon requests for "transfers"; i.e., appropriations from the Reserve Fund to meet extraordinary and unforeseen needs of town departments and agencies which may arise during the course of the fiscal year.

		FINANCE COMMITTEE	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0113101	51251	TEMPORARY	4,000	2,504	2,800	2,800	2,800	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**4,000**	**2,504**	**2,800**	**2,800**	**2,800**	**0**
0113102	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	500	0	200	200	200	
0113102	53115	ADVERTISING	0	171	0	0	0	
0113102	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	500	304	0	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**1,000**	**475**	**200**	**200**	**200**	**0**
		FINANCE COMMITTEE TOTAL	**5,000**	**2,979**	**3,000**	**3,000**	**3,000**	**0**

COMPTROLLER

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	562,857	588,053	599,716	599,716	0
Other Expenses	10,556	21,350	28,350	28,350	0
Total	573,413	609,403	628,066	628,066	0
Staffing					
Managerial	2	2	2	2	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	3	3	3	3	
Total	5	5	5	5	0

Program Description

The Comptroller is appointed by the Select Board and is responsible by Town Charter and State statute for maintaining the general and budgetary accounting records of the Town, preparing the weekly payroll and accounts payable warrants, preparing various financial reports of a statutory and/or administrative nature, developing methods of installation and supervision of all accounting records of the Town, developing standard practices relating to account matters, and the continuously reconciling, reviewing and auditing account balances and activity. The Comptroller provides budget and forecast planning support during the budget development process and as needed.

The Comptroller's Office administers the unemployment activity and the general insurance program which includes property, liability (and excess liability), public official, flood, vacancy and other coverage.

In addition to the day-to-day duties and responsibilities, the Comptroller's Office is responsible for preparing the Department of Revenue Division of Local Services (DLS) reports and data for the Free Cash certification, preparing/coordinating the DLS tax recapitulation for tax rate certification, preparing and filing IRS required forms (employee W-2's, vendor 1099's and Affordable Care Act 1095c forms) annually. The Comptroller's Office also coordinates the annual financial statement audit, which includes providing a myriad of supporting documentation and analysis and coordinates the Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB) actuarial studies and roll-forwards, which includes preparing complex insurance and retiree census data.
The Comptroller is the ex-officio voting member of the Winchester Contributory Retirement Board, an ex-officio non-voting member of the Commissioners of Trust Funds and an ex-officio non-voting member of the Town's Retiree Health Insurance Advisory Committee.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue meeting internal and external deadlines.
- Continue to find ways to make operations more effective and efficient.
- Continue to provide training and other assistance associated with the accounting software.
- Continue to explore new programs in the accounting software to utilize.
- Implement more facets of the Tyler Content Manager program.
- Collaborate with Town Management to update the Financial Policies and Procedures Manual.
- Collaborate with Town Management to develop a formal risk assessment policy.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Closed fiscal year 2025 timely in August 2025.
- Commenced the fiscal year 2025 audit in early September 2025.
- Obtained Department of Revenue's (DOR) certification of Free Cash in September of 2025.
- Obtained DOR's certified tax rate timely in November of 2025.
- Issued FY25 Financial Statement drafts in November 2025.
- Prepared and filed DOR's Schedule A timely.
- Prepared W-2's, 1099's and 1095c by their respective deadlines.
- Issued the annual American Rescue Plan Act report to the Treasury.

COMPTROLLER			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0113301	51101	PERMANENT	569,415	562,857	584,978	594,466	594,466	
0113301	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	0	0	0	2,250	2,250	
0113301	51251	TEMPORARY	0	0	0	0	0	
0113301	51359	OVERTIME	2,050	0	3,075	3,000	3,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**571,465**	**562,857**	**588,053**	**599,716**	**599,716**	**0**
0113302	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	500	2,053	1,000	2,000	2,000	
0113302	52137	SUPPLIES, SMALL EQUIPMENT	500	0	500	1,500	1,500	
0113302	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	3,000	2,431	3,000	3,000	3,000	
0113302	53115	ADVERTISING	0	0		0	0	
0113302	53118	PROF SERVICES	10,000	2,000	10,000	15,000	15,000	
0113302	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	2,500	1,311	2,500	2,500	2,500	
0113302	53166	TUITION	3,000	1,508	3,000	3,000	3,000	
0113302	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	1,350	1,252	1,350	1,350	1,350	
0113302	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	0	0	0	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**20,850**	**10,556**	**21,350**	**28,350**	**28,350**	**0**
		COMPTROLLER TOTAL	**592,315**	**573,413**	**609,403**	**628,066**	**628,066**	**0**

ASSESSORS

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	308,525	315,670	320,770	320,770	0
Other Expenses	97,206	119,830	102,992	102,992	0
Total	405,732	435,500	423,762	423,762	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	2	2	2	2	
Professional/Technical	0	0	0	0	
Total	3	3	3	3	0

Program Description

The Board of Assessors consists of three members elected by the voters for three-year terms. The Board is part-time and meet weekly at Town Hall. Assessors are required by Massachusetts law to value all real and personal property within their community. They also have responsibility for motor vehicle excise tax bills originated by the Registry of Motor Vehicles. By keeping values at the market standard, the Assessors assist in maximizing the resources available to fund municipal services.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Streamline workload for additional adopted exemptions
- Re-organize staffing and duties
- Continuation of assessing education

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Software upgrade and conversion
- Increase in assessing education classes
- Inspection of commercial and exempt properties

		ASSESSOR	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0113401	51101	PERMANENT	292,629	290,897	297,950	298,000	298,000	
0113401	51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	8,150	8,091	8,150	4,700	4,700	
0113401	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	2,250	2,250	2,250	2,250	2,250	
0113401	51359	OVERTIME	1,500	1,468	1,500	10,000	10,000	
0113401	51900	AUTO ALLOWANCE	5,820	5,820	5,820	5,820	5,820	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**310,349**	**308,525**	**315,670**	**320,770**	**320,770**	**0**
0113402	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	250	717	250	250	250	
0113402	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	500	89	500	500	500	
0113402	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	750	374	750	750	750	
0113402	53106	REPRODUCING SVC	50	0	50	50	50	
0113402	53117	AUTO ALLOWANCE		0	0	0	0	
0113402	53118	PROF SERVICES	106,500	79,500	99,000	75,000	75,000	
0113402	53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	500	0	500	500	500	
0113402	53149	CO/R&M FURN & OFFICE	750	0	750	750	750	
0113402	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	750	0	750	750	750	
0113402	53166	TUITION	0	0	0	0	0	
0113402	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	16,580	15,243	16,580	23,742	23,742	
0113402	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	700	1,284	700	700	700	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**127,330**	**97,206**	**119,830**	**102,992**	**102,992**	**0**
		ASSESSOR TOTAL	**437,679**	**405,732**	**435,500**	**423,762**	**423,762**	**0**

TREASURER/COLLECTOR

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	430,686	475,287	498,026	498,026	0
Other Expenses	97,498	111,650	112,650	112,650	0
Total	528,184	586,937	610,676	610,676	0
Staffing					
Managerial	2	2	2	2	
Clerical	2	2	2	2	
Professional/Technical	0.98	0.98	1.2	0.98	
Total	4.98	4.98	5.2	4.98	0

Program Description

The Treasurer / Collector's Office is responsible for the receipt and disbursement of all Town funds. Primary responsibilities of the Treasurer include the custody and investment of all Town general funds as well as Trust, OPEB and Stabilization Funds, the issuance and management of all long- and short-term debt, the management of all Tax Title accounts, management of deferred compensation plans, the issuance of payroll and vendor payments, reconciling and depositing all payments to the IRS and the Department of Revenue as well as accompanying required reporting. The Collector responsibilities include the issuance and collection of all real estate, personal property and motor vehicle excise tax bills, water and sewer bills, PILOT payments, Police details, parking tickets, and the issuance of Municipal Lien Certificates and Tax Title Liens.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue to maintain and provide a high level of customer service.
- Continue maintaining high tax and collection revenue rate exceeding 95% for all Real Estate, Personal Property, Motor Vehicle Excise, and Water & Sewer bills.
- Continue the Tailings process as established in the office.
- Reestablish routine meetings with Town Management and Comptroller to review finances.
- Continue reconciling monthly.
- Maintain a successful working relationship with the Trust Fund Commissioners.
- Continue Tax Taking process.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Manuals completed and distributed. These manuals allow for consistent training with staff, especially newer staff members, by providing the necessary tools to be successful in their positions.
- Continue to maintain and provide a high level of customer service.
- Continue maintaining high tax and collection revenue rate exceeding 95% for all Real Estate, Personal Property, Motor Vehicle Excise, and Water & Sewer bills.

- Continue the Tailings process established to address outstanding payroll and vendor checks.
- Article 200A Section 9A was accepted at the 2025 Spring Town Meeting allowing the Town to escheat funds related to the Tailings process, instead of turning the funds over to the State.
- Abating of Uncollectibles started with the help of the Assessors' office.

		TREASURER/COLLECTOR	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0113501	51101	PERMANENT	447,264	430,279	474,287	497,026	497,026	
0113501	51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	0	0	0	0	0	
0113501	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	0	0	0	0	0	
0113501	51251	TEMPORARY	2,000	0	0	0	0	
0113501	51359	OVERTIME	1,000	407	1,000	1,000	1,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**450,264**	**430,686**	**475,287**	**498,026**	**498,026**	**0**
0113502	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	3,450	3,094	3,450	3,450	3,450	
0113502	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	2,000	1,707	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0113502	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	15,000	10,886	15,000	15,000	15,000	
0113502	53108	POSTAGE	37,000	27,552	40,000	40,000	40,000	
0113502	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	700	631	800	800	800	
0113502	53115	ADVERTISING	1,500	1,817	1,500	1,500	1,500	
0113502	53118	PROF SERVICES	3,300	2,390	6,000	6,000	6,000	
0113502	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	1,600	1,246	1,400	1,400	1,400	
0113502	53316	BOND ISSUANCE COSTS	9,000	7,588	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0113502	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	750	235	500	500	500	
0113502	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	0	0	0	0	0	
0113502	54129	BANK SERVICE CHARGES	30,000	40,351	31,000	32,000	32,000	
0113502	56001	MISC EXPENSE	0	0	0	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**104,300**	**97,498**	**111,650**	**112,650**	**112,650**	**0**
		TREASURER/COLLECTOR TOTAL	**554,564**	**528,184**	**586,937**	**610,676**	**610,676**	**0**

AUDIT

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	0	0	0	0	0
Other Expenses	97,750	90,000	102,000	102,000	0
Equipment	0	0	0	0	0
Total	97,750	90,000	102,000	102,000	0

Program Description

The Audit budget provides funding for the annual financial statement audit performed in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards and standards applicable to financial audits contained in Government Auditing Standards. A financial statement audit is an examination of the Town's books and records and includes the review of accounting transactions, policies, procedures, and internal controls. The Town is required to obtain a financial statement audit due to the level of federal funds expended and due to bond disclosure requirements.

The Select Board established an Audit Advisory Committee in 2006 to assist them in their oversight of the annual financial statement audit. The Audit Advisory Committee facilitates communication between the Select Board, the audit firm and town management. They also make recommendations related to the selection of the audit firm and review the financial statements and other audit reports regarding financial management issues. The Comptroller is responsible for the day-to-day management of the audit process and works closely with the audit firm. Fiscal Year 2027 is the first year of a new audit contract which is estimated to cost $90,000. The Audit Advisory Committee has recommended to continue the relationship with CliftonLarsonAllen, LLP.

The audit budget also provides funding for a biennial Other Post Employment Benefit (OPEB) actuarial valuation and consulting services. The Town currently provides postemployment benefits including medical, dental and life insurance to retirees and their dependents. The actuarial valuation is required to provide the necessary data associated with these benefits to comply with financial statement reporting and disclosure requirements in accordance with Governmental Accounting Standards Board Statements No.74 & 75. There will not be an actuarial valuation performed in FY26, but there will be one in FY27, so funds were added in the FY27 budget

AUDIT				FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0113602	53118	PROF SERVICES		98,000	97,750	90,000	102,000	102,000	
			EXPENSES TOTAL	**98,000**	**97,750**	**90,000**	**102,000**	**102,000**	**0**
			AUDIT TOTAL	**98,000**	**97,750**	**90,000**	**102,000**	**102,000**	**0**

ENGINEERING

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	526,203	579,512	454,321	582,799	0
Other Expenses	98,960	110,030	118,030	118,030	0
Total	625,163	689,542	572,351	700,829	0
Staffing					
Managerial	3	3	3	3	
Clerical	1	1	1	1	
Professional/Technical	1	1	1	1	
Total	5	5	5	5	0

Program Description

The Engineering Department is dedicated to meeting the needs of Town departments, boards, committees, and residents. The projects and initiatives undertaken by the Department have a direct impact on the quality of services provided for our residents both in the short and long-term. The projects and policies initiated by the Engineering Department are intended to address on-going infrastructure, flooding, and traffic-related problems; improve educational, recreational, or open space facilities and resources; and meet state or federal requirements. In particular, the Engineering Department provides project management services and oversight for the planning, design, and construction of various infrastructure and capital projects, including flood mitigation, water, sewer, stormwater management, and traffic calming. Additionally, we conduct technical reviews and field inspections related to various private development projects that fall under the jurisdiction of the Planning Board, Zoning Board of Appeals, and the Conservation Commission. We maintain custody of all plans and engineering records for the Town, the Traffic Review Committee (TRC). The Engineering Department also administers the Town Center parking permit program for residents and employees

FY2027 Initiatives

- Assist the Town Manager's office with the implementation of the Town's Flood Mitigation Program, including construction of the culvert at the railroad crossing behind the Muraco School, and long-term maintenance activities related to previously completed projects.
- Begin developing 25-percent level design drawings for improvements at Symmes Corner, for future funding through the State Transportation Improvement Program.
- Continue to administer and maintain compliance with the Town's MS4 stormwater permit.
- Administration of the NRD funds obtained by the Town for the design of improvements to Davidson Park.
- Complete engineering reviews of private development projects (including 40B developments) submitted to the Winchester Planning Board, Zoning Board of Appeals, and Conservation Commission.

- Provide construction inspection services for on-going Town and private development projects.
- Chair the Town's Traffic Review Committee (TRC) and work with the Select Board and Traffic and Transportation Advisory Committee (TTAC) to develop and implement safe pedestrian and motor vehicle transportation policies, and traffic calming projects.
- Oversee updates to the Town's GIS assessor's data, and other data layers.
- Administer the Town's FEMA Community Rating System (CRS) program, which provides residents with a 20% discount on their flood insurance.
- Participate in the Mystic River Steering Committee organized by EPA and the Resilient Mystic Collaborative organized by the Mystic River Watershed Association (Myra).

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Completed the Lynch School Neighborhood Traffic Improvements.
- Developed a traffic calming plan for Kenwin Road.
- Obtained grant funding from MassDOT for installation of a rectangular rapid flashing beacon on Johnson Road at Cox Road.
- Obtained a technical assistance grant from MassDOT to evaluate congestion at several intersections in the Town Center.
- Completed repairs of the Shore Road culverts over the Aberjona River.
- Administered Permit Year 7 of EPA's MS4 stormwater permit (permit term July 1, 2025, through June 30, 2026).
- Coordinated with various public utilities on grants of location (GOL) and other infrastructure improvements.
- Provided technical reviews for projects submitted to the ZBA, Planning Board, and Conservation Commission.
- Provided inspectional services for a variety of private development projects.
- Coordinated with the MBTA on reconstruction of the Winchester Center Commuter Rail Station.

		ENGINEERING	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0114121	51101	PERMANENT	575,571	518,778	572,119	446,756	575,234	
0114121	51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	4,188	0	4,293	4,315	4,315	
0114121	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	4,500	0	2,100	2,250	2,250	
0114121	51359	OVERTIME	1,025	7,424	1,000	1,000	1,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**585,284**	**526,203**	**579,512**	**454,321**	**582,799**	**0**
0114122	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	1,000	358	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0114122	52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUC SUPPLI	7,500	3,670	7,500	7,500	7,500	
0114122	52105	COMPUTER SUPPLIES	200	35	200	200	200	
0114122	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	100	0	100	100	100	
0114122	52123	HARDWARE	50	0	50	50	50	
0114122	52138	SUPPLIES, AUTOMOBILE	200	0	200	200	200	
0114122	52146	OFFICE EQUIPMENT	0	0	0	0	0	
014122	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	6,000	5,664	6,000	6,000	6,000	
0114122	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	500	190	500	500	500	
0114122	53106	REPRODUCING SVC	500	0	500	500	500	
0114122	53108	POSTAGE-GEN SERVICES	0	176	0	0	0	
0114122	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	480	0	480	480	480	
0114122	53115	ADVERTISING	500	455	500	500	500	
0114122	53118	PROF SERVICES	75,000	80,435	82,000	90,000	90,000	
0114122	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	250	0	250	250	250	
0114122	53,127	R&M AUTOMOTIVE	0	0	0	0	0	
0114122	53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	500	0	500	500	500	
0114122	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	2,000	0	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0114122	53166	TUITION	750	1,185	750	750	750	
0114122	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	7,000	6,427	7,000	7,000	7,000	
0114122	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	500	366	500	500	500	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**103,030**	**98,960**	**110,030**	**118,030**	**118,030**	**0**
		ENGINEERING TOTAL	**688,314**	**625,163**	**689,542**	**572,351**	**700,829**	**0**

BUILDING

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	534,495	607,258	712,629	632,629	0
Other Expenses	34,586	41,795	47,370	47,370	0
Total	569,082	649,053	759,999	679,999	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	1.69	1.69	1.69	1.69	
Professional/Technical	2.3	3.13	4		
Total	4.99	5.82	6.69	2.69	0

Program Description

The Building Department is responsible for enforcing the Massachusetts State Building code and the Winchester Zoning By-Law for all construction within Winchester. The Building Department issues permits and performs inspections for construction, wiring, plumbing and gas. In addition, the Building Commissioner acts as the Zoning Enforcement Officer pursuant to Massachusetts law, making formal determinations on the applicable use of land. The Building Department provides staff support to the Zoning Board of Appeals and serves as a resource to the Town when designing and construction of municipal buildings and related projects.

2027 Initiatives

- Oversee the 40B project on Cross St and act as the liaison between neighbors and the developer to address any issues as they arise.
- Work with Ken Pruitt to develop a curriculum for the local developers to assist them with the transition to the Opt-in Specialized Energy Code.
- Create a work group with the Arlington and Lexington Building Commissioners to discuss trends in our industry and maintain a level of consistency in our communities regarding building code/energy code requirements.
- Maintain a Board of Director status for the Massachusetts Building Commissioners and Inspectors Association.
- Create a builders' email distribution/forum to send updates pertaining to zoning and building codes requirements.

		BUILDING	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0114131	51101	PERMANENT	494,996	489,982	555,950	659,578	579,578	
0114131	51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	6,818	5,936	6,894	7,351	7,351	
0114131	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	2,572	686	3,214	4,500	4,500	
0114131	51251	TEMPORARY	10,000	21,021	20,000	20,000	20,000	
0114131	51359	OVERTIME	5,000	670	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0114131	51900	AUTO ALLOWANCE	16,200	16,200	16,200	16,200	16,200	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**535,586**	**534,495**	**607,258**	**712,629**	**632,629**	**0**
0114132	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	1,500	1,664	1,500	1,500	1,500	
0114132	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	200	40	600	600	600	
0114132	52137	SUPPLIES, SMALL EQUIPMENT	3,500	1,500	3,500	3,500	3,500	
0114132	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	3,000	2,518	3,000	3,000	3,000	
0114132	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	1,050	268	1,050	1,050	1,050	
0114132	53106	REPRODUCING SVC	200	219	200	200	200	
0114132	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	1,200	0	1,200	1,200	1,200	
0114132	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	100	0	100	100	100	
0114132	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	0	0	0			
0114132	53167	TUITION	2,520	1,030	2,520	2,520	2,520	
0114132	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	27,825	26,880	27,825	33,400	33,400	
0114132	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	300	467	300	300	300	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**41,395**	**34,586**	**41,795**	**47,370**	**47,370**	**0**
		BUILDING TOTAL	**576,981**	**569,082**	**649,053**	**759,999**	**679,999**	**0**

CONSERVATION

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	96,619	101,294	98,972	101,222	0
Other Expenses	1,892	2,213	98,565	9,565	0
Total	98,511	103,507	197,537	110,787	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	0	0	0	0	
Total	1	1	1	1	0

Program Description

The Conservation Commission is appointed by the Town Manager and is responsible for protecting the Town's natural resources. The Conservation Commission manages over 130+ acres of open space, dedicated to passive recreation and to the preservation of wildlife habitat. These areas give quiet refuge and an opportunity to experience nature and serve as habitat for wildlife. We do this on a small budget, making use of much volunteer help, both with Commission members and volunteers who donate their time to clear passages, build crossings, construct signs, and blaze trails. With each permit issued, we educate landowners in the importance of food and cover to native and migrating species and require them to landscape for their preservation. We are actively involved in promoting clean water, and work to ensure that discharges into waterbodies are free of pollutants. We have watched waterfowl and fish return to our waterways, the return of migrating herring, and the return of apex species - indicative of a healthy ecosystem. In the long term, it is these preserved areas, and the efforts of educated landowners, that will contribute to flood resilience, drought control, and a quality of life that incorporates nature and its many benefits.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Establish and maintain trails, boardwalks and bridges in Conservation Area that enables the use of these spaces,
- Remove invasive species and repopulate native plants in conservation and open spaces to increase biodiversity, promote pollinators, and improve wildlife habitat,
- Restore the public shoreline of Winchester's Great Ponds: Wedge Pond and Winter Pond,
- Manage invasive aquatic species in Winchester water bodies to restore the natural resource and provide wildlife habitat,
- Work in conjunction with the Town to improve water quality in the Aberjona River, Wedge Pond, and Winter Pond to restore the natural resources, improve resident's health and well-being and provide wildlife habitat.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Wedge Pond: A WCCP grant for an aeration system to improve water quality in Wedge Pond was approved by Town Meeting and will be installed. Worked with Friends of Wedge Pond on shoreline restoration.
- Continued restoration of Mill and Judkins Pond shorelines, protected snapping turtle nests.
- Working with the Boy Scouts, Information Kiosks have been installed at Mt. Pisgah and the Town Forest, and picnic tables have been built at Elliot Park. Working with the Girl Scouts, a Pollinator Garden has been planted at the Highland Ave. Park.
- A volunteer Forest Steward has joined the Commission to oversee all conservation lands and is currently working to develop a Forest Management Plan for the Town Forest, using a grant from the Department of Conservation Services.
- The Commission has contracted to provide a GIS map for all resource areas in town, to be posted on the town website.
- Invasive Plant Removal: The Commission continued with its annual spring trash pickup and invasives removal volunteer day, an effort that was continued with the Fall Invasive Species Removal Day.
- Permits on Town Land: Borggaard Beach Volleyball Courts - two sand volleyball courts at the beachfront**.** Shore Road Bridge Rehabilitation - maintenance on the existing bridge including repairing walls, deck resurfacing and replacing bridge railings. Muraco Culverts – Installation of two new openings to provide greater flood mitigation. Sculpture Park at Shore Road **–** In addition to new benches and public sculpture, this location has been planted with native plants. Lynch School: The Lynch School has been planted with numerous native plants to provide wildlife habitat and pollinator gardens.

		CONSERVATION	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0114151	51101	PERMANENT	96,619	96,619	99,044	98,972	98,972	
0114151	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	2,250	0	2,250	0	2,250	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**98,869**	**96,619**	**101,294**	**98,972**	**101,222**	**0**
0114152	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	300	308	300	300	300	
0114152	52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUC SUPPLI	300	0	300	300	300	
0114152	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	100	0	100	100	100	
0114152	53115	ADVERTISING	200	152	200	200	200	
0114152	53118	PROF SERVICES	0	0	0	96,000	7,000	
0114152	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	100	0	100	100	100	
0114152	53166	TUITION	300	550	300	700	700	
0114152	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	837	882	913	865	865	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**2,137**	**1,892**	**2,213**	**98,565**	**9,565**	**0**
		CONSERVATION TOTAL	**101,006**	**98,511**	**103,507**	**197,537**	**110,787**	**0**

PLANNING BOARD

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	160,399	185,512	191,855	191,855	0
Other Expenses	51,405	56,450	61,000	61,000	0
Total	211,804	241,962	252,855	252,855	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	2	2	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	0	0	0	0	
Total	1	1	2	2	0

Program Description

The Planning Board and Planning Department submit the following budget request for FY27. This request reflects the operational needs of the Board and Department, addresses long-term planning responsibilities, and ensures that staff can continue to deliver high quality municipal planning services while managing increasing demands on workload and regulatory coordination. The FY27 request contains modest adjustments to personal services and targeted changes to departmental expenses that better align recurring costs with the Department's evolving responsibilities.

Personal Services

Personal services costs increase only minimally in FY27, reflecting standard salary progression. The request does not include any new positions and does not expand staffing levels.

Department Expenses and Realignment of Technology Costs

The FY27 budget introduces a software expense line which replaces the previous computer supplies line. This realignment better reflects the actual needs of the Planning Department and the Planning Board, given the increasing reliance on software-based services, digital permitting systems, and modern imagery tools.

The estimated cost of required software in FY27 is $2,500. This amount is expected to recur annually with reasonable increases. These services are necessary for permitting management, research, mapping, and record keeping and directly support both staff and Board members.

The funds granting to the Planning Board at Fall Town Meeting for GIS training and services is not included in this budget.

Professional Services

The professional services request increases from $45,000 in FY26 to $50,000 in FY27. This adjustment is essential to maintain the capacity to complete at least one planning process or study each year. Even at this increased level, the amount represents the absolute minimum needed for planning related consulting services.

The Planning Board currently faces a significant backlog of required and overdue plans. This includes preparation of the next Master Plan, which is a critical document for state funding eligibility, and the Board's ongoing effort to recodify and modernize the Zoning Bylaw. Both tasks are large in scope and require outside technical assistance. Professional services funding is also needed to update other plans and studies that support economic development, housing, infrastructure planning, and compliance with evolving state regulatory requirements. Without this increase, the Board cannot realistically address its statutory responsibilities or make measurable progress on long-standing priorities.

Other Adjustments

Other operational expenses show routine adjustments in FY27 to reflect minor changes in expected needs. These adjustments ensure adequate funding for advertising, public notices, reproduction, printing, training, and general operating support. While these changes are not substantial, they preserve the Department's ability to meet public notice obligations, support board operations, and maintain required records and communications.

FY2027 Initiatives

- **Strengthening Economic Development as a Core Function of the Planning Department:** Focus on making economic development a more active part of the Planning Department's work. This will involve identifying how our existing planning tools and processes can better support business and community growth.
- **Advance the Review and Improvement of the Site Plan Review Process:** This goal will focus on evaluating how our current procedures align with regional best practices. The result should be a set of recommendations that make the review process clearer for applicants while supporting the Board's intent and maintaining design standards. This work will likely be completed with the help of an outside consultant.
- **Developing a Database of Historically Significant Structures:** Work with the Historical Commission and other interested members of the community to begin developing a comprehensive, working database of historically significant structures in Winchester. The goal is to centralize existing data from past surveys and studies and supplement it with new information gathered over time. This project will improve access to information for town staff, property owners, and the public, and will be used as a starting point for all future preservation initiatives.
- **Prepare for the Procurement and Initial Work of the Next Master Plan:** Begin laying the groundwork for the next Master Plan. This includes defining the scope, timeline, and procurement process to engage a qualified consultant team. This project is expected to extend beyond the upcoming year.
-

FY2026 Accomplishments

- **Main Street Mixed-use District:** The Planning Board approved its first project under the new Main Street Mixed Use District zoning, which will create 13 new residential units, including one affordable unit, along with new commercial space.
- **Inclusionary Housing Update:** At Fall Town Meeting, an update to the MBTA Overlay District was approved that increased the required number of affordable units for developments with more than six residential units, while maintaining compliance with the MBTA Communities Act.

		PLANNING BOARD	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0114201	51101	PERMANENT	168,224	156,305	177,512	183,855	183,855	
0114201	51251	TEMPORARY	8,000	4,094	8,000	8,000	8,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**176,224**	**160,399**	**185,512**	**191,855**	**191,855**	**0**
0114202	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	1,005	1,005	200	1,500	1,500	
0114202	52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUC SUPPLI	940	716	3,000	1,000	1,000	
0114202	52105	COMPUTER SUPPLIES	500	0	1,000	0	0	
0114202	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	250	0	500	250	250	
0114202	52185	SOFTWARE				2,500	2,500	
;0114202	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	1,250	1,134	1,250	1,250	1,250	
0114202	53115	ADVERTISING	1,005	1,005	1,500	1,500	1,500	
0114202	53118	PROF SERVICES	60,000	47,525	45,000	50,000	50,000	
0114202	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	200	0	500	500	500	
0114202	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	250	0	1,000	0	0	
0114202	53166	TUITION	2,000	0	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0114202	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	1,000	20	500	500	500	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**68,400**	**51,405**	**56,450**	**61,000**	**61,000**	**0**
		PLANNING BOARD TOTAL	**244,624**	**211,804**	**241,962**	**252,855**	**252,855**	**0**

LEGAL

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	0	0	0	0	0
Other Expenses	423,085	500,000	500,000	500,000	0
Total	423,085	500,000	500,000	500,000	0

Program Description

The Legal budget provides funds for all legal services utilized by the municipal government. Town Counsel is appointed by the Select Board and advises various Town boards, committees, and departments. They prepare or review contracts and other legal instruments for the Town, represent the Town in litigation and other matters, and generally supervise all legal matters. Also included in this budget are legal services not directly handled by Town Counsel, such as fees for special counsel retained for extraordinary legal matters as deemed necessary by the Select Board. This budget also provides funds for the Town's labor counsel that advises staff on collective bargaining agreements and other employment related disputes.

LEGAL			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0115102	53118	PROFESSIONAL SERVICES						
0115102	533081	LEGAL COUNSEL / IN-HOUSE	390,000	360,837	390,000	390,000	390,000	
0115102	533082	LEGAL COUNSEL / OUTSIDE	110,000	62,248	110,000	110,000	110,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**500,000**	**423,085**	**500,000**	**500,000**	**500,000**	**0**
		LEGAL TOTAL	**500,000**	**423,085**	**500,000**	**500,000**	**500,000**	**0**

HUMAN RESOURCES

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	251,333	257,616	293,802	262,467	0
Other Expenses	15,427	27,600	28,700	28,700	0
Total	266,760	285,216	322,502	291,167	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	1	1	1.5	1	
Total	2	2	2.5	2	0

Program Description

The Human Resources Department provides a variety of services to all departments within the Town and assists department heads and employees with all issues related to employment. In addition, the Department is responsible for ADA oversight and compliance and for implementation of the Town's approved ADA Transition Plan.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue to act as a resource for department heads, employees, and the general public.
- Implement a consistent performance evaluation document and process for all employees, non-union and union. Specifically, work with individual departments to determine if a variation of the document can be created to better suit the needs of each department.
- Work with different departments to increase training for employees on specific issues.
- Continue to transition all human resources related functions in other departments to the Human Resources Department.
- Track and maintain records on trending human resources related issues, especially those amongst employees and departments.
- Continue to oversee ADA compliance and to work with the Engineering Department in order to complete ADA related projects.
- Continue to work with the Disability Access Commission to increase disability awareness.
- Update the costs associated with and implement the 2019 ADA Transition Plan to fix the ADA deficits identified in Town Hall and Library. The High School will be reviewed by a sub-committee to determine next steps.
- Increase wellness programming to further develop the program and increase employee engagement.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Provided tailored trainings to various departments
- Full transitioned benefit administration from the Comptrollers Office to HR.
- Increased awareness of HR services to departments.
- Increased communication and availability of HR personnel to departments
- Assisted department heads in the recruiting process, labor relations, and other employee related matters.
- Significantly increased Wellness engagement for Town employees.
- Increased Wellness grant funding from MIIA to offer excursive equipment for the public safety buildings, standing desks and Fresh Fridges for Town employees.
- Revise and established and implemented a fully functioning process for department heads to follow for new hires and for new hires to complete benefits paperwork online or through the mail while working remotely.
- Created and continued to manage a new process for notification and posting of job vacancies.
- Provided courteous attention and assistance to our employees as well as the general public.
- Worked with the Engineering Department to complete various ADA projects.
- Oversaw the Disability Access Commission and worked with members to promote disability awareness and be proactive on ADA issues.
- Worked with the Special Projects Manager to hire a consultant for correcting ADA deficits at the Town Hall and Library.
- Successfully took over the Employee Self Service Program which allows employees to access their wages, W2s, and deductions.
- Learned the software and managed the creation of ID Badges for Town employees.
- Assisted in successfully negotiating collective bargaining agreements for three unions and negotiating improvements and benefits for non-union employees.

HUMAN RESOURCES/ADA			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0115201	51101	PERMANENT	249,333	249,360	255,616	291,802	260,467	
0115201	51359	OVERTIME	2,000	1,973	2,000	2,000	2,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**251,333**	**251,333**	**257,616**	**293,802**	**262,467**	**0**
0115202	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	2,000	1,552	2,500	2,500	2,500	
0115202	52180	FOOD & GROCERIES	400	394	500	500	500	
0115202	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	5,000	2,141	6,000	6,000	6,000	
0115202	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	0	0	0	0	0	
0115202	53115	ADVERTISING	500	0	500	500	500	
0115202	53118	PROF SERVICES	13,000	10,975	14,000	15,000	15,000	
0115202	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	500	0	500	600	600	
0115202	53166	TUITION	3,000	0	3,000	3,000	3,000	
0115202	54101	DUES, MEMBERSHIPS & SUBSCRIPTI	600	365	600	600	600	
0115202	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	0	0	0	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**25,000**	**15,427**	**27,600**	**28,700**	**28,700**	**0**
		HUMAN RESOURCES/ADA TOTAL	**276,333**	**266,760**	**285,216**	**322,502**	**291,167**	**0**

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	218,256	230,745	234,914	234,914	0
Other Expenses	567,472	601,843	751,043	751,043	0
Equipment	36,376	48,000	48,000	48,000	0
Total	822,104	880,588	1,033,957	1,033,957	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	2	2	2	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	0	0	0	0	
Total	1	2	2	2	0

Program Description

The objective of the IT Department is to support the Town's network, keep it up and running year-round. We also supply and maintain the equipment and software end users need to perform their jobs.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue working with the State on Cyber Security Training for Town employees
- Work with AudioEye to help the Town's website meet ADA requirements
- Manage the Town servers.
- Manage the MFA programs.
- Manage Service Desk.
- Maintain the fiber optic network infrastructure.
- Maintain SharePoint
- Update desktops, laptops, printers, and Application Software.
- Manage the VoIP phone system.
- Replace outdated network equipment
- Continue working with the School's IT department to support the Town's network

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Setting up SharePoint is a work in progress
- Migrated all computers to Windows 11
- Work with AudioEye to help the Town's website meet ADA requirements.
- Workedwith the State on Cyber Security Training for Town employees.
- Managed the Town servers.
- Managed the MFA programs.
- Managed Service Desk.
- Maintained the fiber optic network infrastructure.

- Updated desktops, laptops, printers, and Application Software.
- Managed the VoIP phone system.
- Worked with the School's IT department to support the Town's network.

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0115301	51101	PERMANENT	219,315	216,156	227,295	231,464	231,464	
0115301	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	2,250	900	2,250	2,250	2,250	
0115301	51,900	AUTO ALLOWANCE	0	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**221,565**	**218,256**	**230,745**	**234,914**	**234,914**	**0**
0115302	52105	COMPUTER SUPPLIES	60,000	41,360	60,000	65,000	65,000	
0115302	52185	SOFTWARE	8,000	2,212	8,000	8,000	8,000	
0115302	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	500	0	500	500	500	
0115302	53118	PROF SERVICES	99,959	114,282	80,000	175,000	175,000	
0115302	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	100	0	100	100	100	
0115302	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	500	405	500	500	500	
0115302	53166	TUITION	5,000	760	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0115302	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	421,400	408,453	447,643	496,943	496,943	
0115302	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	100	0	100	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**595,559**	**567,472**	**601,843**	**751,043**	**751,043**	**0**
0115303	55103	OFFICE EQUIPMENT	36,376	36,376	48,000	48,000	48,000	
		EQUIPMENT TOTAL	**36,376**	**36,376**	**48,000**	**48,000**	**48,000**	**0**
		INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY TOTAL	**853,500**	**822,104**	**880,588**	**1,033,957**	**1,033,957**	**0**

GENERAL SERVICES

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	0	0	0	0	0
Other Expenses	150,985	163,750	164,150	164,150	0
Total	150,985	163,750	164,150	164,150	0

Program Description

The General Services budget supports town-wide costs associated with many Town departments and is administered jointly by the Comptroller's Office and the Town Manager's Office. The costs supported by this budget include the VOIP phone system usage and maintenance, the purchase of paper, form stock and other office supplies and materials used by many town offices, the cost of shredding confidential documents and the cost to operate, lease and fund the central postage machine.

GENERAL SERVICES			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0115402	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	10,000	1,604	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0115402	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	8,000	7,620	8,000	8,200	8,200	
0115402	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	16,000	12,836	16,000	16,000	16,000	
0115402	53108	POSTAGE - GEN SERVICES	65,000	65,283	65,000	65,000	65,000	
0115402	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	64,000	62,687	64,000	64,000	64,000	
0115402	53118	PROF SERVICES	750	954	750	950	950	
0115402	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	0	0	0	-	-	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**163,750**	**150,985**	**163,750**	**164,150**	**164,150**	**0**
		GENERAL SERVICES TOTAL	**163,750**	**150,985**	**163,750**	**164,150**	**164,150**	**0**

TOWN CLERK

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	468,662	471,292	526,611	526,611	0
Other Expenses	133,681	142,400	160,250	160,250	0
Total	602,343	613,692	686,861	686,861	0
Staffing					
Managerial	2	2	2	2	
Clerical	2	2	2	2	
Professional/Technical	0	0	0	0	
Total	4	4	4	4	0

Program Description

As the primary provider of information, the Town Clerk's Office serves as the Chief Election Official, Official Recording Officer, and Record's Access Officer for the Town Government, State Ethics Liaison, Licensing Official, Notary Public and Commissioner to Qualify and the Clerk to the Town Meeting, Town Hall Records Administrator, Registrar of Vital Statistics and Registrar of Voters. The Town Clerk assists management in a variety of projects and initiatives upon request.

It is the mission of the Town Clerk's Office to promote public confidence, goodwill and to provide excellent customer service to the general public. The Town Clerk's Office upholds the integrity of the democratic process, maintains, and preserves public records, and fosters cooperation and coordination between departments as well as acts in the best interest of the community and the Commonwealth by providing innovative, efficient, quality service.

Most importantly, the Winchester Town Clerk's Office manages the electoral process through fair, open, transparent, and consistent administration of all federal, state, and local election laws. The Town Clerk provides educational opportunities to those residents and voters who may be interested in the structure of our town government and its electoral process. Training opportunities are available to those voters in Winchester who would like to serve as Poll Workers.

FY2027 Initiatives

- **Goal –** Continue to write, edit and print the remaining outstanding Annual Reports 2020-2025.
- Action Steps and Timeframe: Continue to encourage department hears, boards and commissions to write their outstanding reports for these years. The goal is additionally to create a clearer framework and template to educate both department heads and boards on this important state requirement.
- **Goal –**Secretary of the Commonwealth - Emergency Management Plan for elections. Work cooperatively with the staff at the SOC to write and publish proper procedures for evacuations on early voting dates and election day. Share and work with our public

safety departments to integrate the election law requirements with public safety standards for evacuations, fire and threats.

- **Goal –** Work internally with Town Clerk staff to organize the digital files in the office's collection. While the town is not able to fund a records management program for FY27 it is my goal to work through the voluminous collection of records that have been saved on the network drive for over twenty five years and cross reference these digital files in order to keep only the permanent records as required by the Commonwealth. This is a long term project that will span two to three years to complete. It is my hope that is the Town Archivist's hours are increased in FY27 the additional 7 hrs. per week will be dedicated to this project.
- **Goal –** Outline Phase II - Records Management Plan for the Capital Planning Committee and/or Town Manager. This may or may not be done with a consultant depending on funding. May seek to form a committee of volunteers from the community with the specific experience of digital records management. The Town has no specific digital records management plan or software that is used by each department to allow for ease of retrieving documents, filing documents on a daily basis, fulfilling public records requests in a timely manner and save space on the Town's digital network. This is a long term goal that will most likely remain on the list of goals for many years.
- **Goal –** Request to manage and work cooperatively with the HR Department on installing digital message boards and directories within Town Hall.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- **Decennial Review project** – completed in cooperation with the Committee on Government Regulations, staff and Town Attorney. Codified all amendments with General Code Publishers after approval from the Attorney General. The Committee on Gov't Regulations Decennial Review held nearly 40 meetings to conduct and complete the comprehensive 10 year review. I provided note taking and historical researched to the body. Significant hours have been logged on to this project outside my normal working hours. This project is complete.
- **Annual Reports -** Completed the production of outstanding Annual Reports for the years 2015-2019. Edited, complied, wrote and printed the outstanding years with the assistance of Rachael Phillips, Temporary Clerk in the Town Clerk's Office. Completed the decennial review amendments with the Attorney General and General Code to accurately codify the legal document of the Town of Winchester known as the Code of Bylaws.
- **Researched new software programs** to enhance the recordkeeping services for various workloads of the Town Clerk's Office. Hired LL Data, a software database vendor that designs and creates specific recordkeeping software programs for Massachusetts Town Clerks. Specially designed Poll Worker data base for ease of hiring and completing the payroll for the Federal State and Local Elections. Additionally, created and designed a database that manages more efficiently the

boards and commissions membership files. These files are essential for tracking elected office and preparing the ballots each spring.

- **Building Commissioner – Digital Records Project** Assisted and supported the Building Commissioners Office on the pilot program to scan the building files/records through a capital project funding. Continuing to provide guidance, insight and expertise on the project when necessary.
- **Master Plan Town Archives:** Continue to work with volunteer experts on a long-term master plan for the Town Archives. Specifically working towards the replacement of our long time Town Historian/Archivist Dr. Ellen Knight. She will be retiring at the end of fiscal year 2026. I have requested an increase in office hours from 12 p/wk. to 19 pr/wk. for FY27 for the purpose to expand the scope of work under the Town Archives to include records management.

		TOWN CLERK	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0116101	51101	PERMANENT	404,082	400,854	417,920	418,661	418,661	
0116101	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	2,000	0	0	0	0	
0116101	51251	TEMPORARY	74,032	48,290	42,968	96,200	96,200	
0116101	51359	OVERTIME	19,838	19,518	10,404	11,750	11,750	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**499,952**	**468,662**	**471,292**	**526,611**	**526,611**	**0**
0116102	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	6,850	7,981	5,600	8,750	8,750	
0116102	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	1,000	2,062	1,000	10,000	10,000	
0116102	52137	SUPPLIES, SMALL EQUIPMENT	0	2,890	0	0	0	
0116102	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	0	3,666	0	4,500	4,500	
0116102	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	34,000	32,677	29,000	35,350	35,350	
0116102	53106	REPRODUCING SVC	10,000	0	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0116102	53108	POSTAGE	22,000	27,751	20,000	25,000	25,000	
0116102	53115	ADVERTISING	5,000	1,091	10,000	3,000	3,000	
0116102	53116	BIND & BK REPAIRS	3,250	1,552	3,500	3,500	3,500	
0116102	53118	PROF SERVICES	37,000	35,288	41,500	25,400	25,400	
0116102	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	500	180	500	500	500	
0116102	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	10,300	2,269	10,300	0	0	
0116102	53166	TUITION	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0116102	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS &SUBSCRP	0	5,100	0	15,250	15,250	
0116102	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	750	410	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0116102	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	5,000	0	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0116102	57010	POLICE DETAIL SERVICES	12,000	10,764	4,000	12,000	12,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**148,650**	**133,681**	**142,400**	**160,250**	**160,250**	**0**
		TOWN CLERK TOTAL	**648,602**	**602,343**	**613,692**	**686,861**	**686,861**	**0**

SECTION IV

Service Programs – Culture

Library (1610)

Archival Center (6940)

Historical Commission (6941)

LIBRARY

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	1,850,548	2,009,744	2,053,406	2,073,406	0
Other Expenses	526,412	610,850	625,650	625,650	0
Equipment	36,144	0	0	0	0
Total	2,413,104	2,620,594	2,679,056	2,699,056	0
Staffing					
Managerial	2	2	2	2	
Clerical	8.8286	8.8286	8.8286	8.8286	
Professional/Technical	10.946	10.946	10.946	10.946	
Custodian	1.7429	1.7429	1.7429	1.7429	
Total	23.5175	23.5175	23.5175	23.5175	0

Program Description

The Winchester Public Library is a dynamic community resource that endeavors to improve the quality of life for Library patrons of all ages by providing:

- the resources, services and support they need to make informed decisions, resolve issues or answer questions throughout life.
- children and teens with the programs, services, and materials they need to succeed in school and satisfy their educational and recreational interests as they grow from infants to young adults.
- a safe and welcoming physical space to meet and interact with others or to sit quietly and read and have access to the ever-growing resources and services available through the library's web site.

To accomplish these endeavors and more, the Library relies upon a professional staff, a broad collection of current materials in a variety of formats, current information technology, and a well-maintained facility for patrons.
The Winchester Public Library is under the jurisdiction of a five-member elected Board of Trustees.

In FY25, the Library began the strategic planning process and is working with Barbara Alevras from Sage Consulting. There will be several ways for residents to participate in the planning process, including focus groups and a community survey in early 2026. The 3-year plan is projected to be completed by late spring 2026 and will guide next steps and initiatives.
There have been challenges in the past year, and moving forward, more staff (including serving teens and also custodial staff hours) are needed to continue to provide a safe and comfortable environment to all.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Begin to address wants and needs of the community as vocalized during the strategic planning process, including new and expanded collections and services

- Continue to envision how the Library space can be used differently, to maximize every opportunity
- Add staffing hours / positions as necessary, to maintain and improve services, including in custodial hours and staff who serve teens

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Further expanded Chinese foreign language collection
- Add second 3D printer and large format printer for patron use
- Completed installation of new flooring in Children's Room
- Installed new phone system and new security camera system
- Installed new PA system in Large Meeting Room with support of Friends of the Library

External Funding Sources

The Library receives outside funds from four different sources: State Aid, grants, donations from private individuals, and Endowment and Trust Fund income.
The Library is eligible each year for a state aid program that is contingent upon the Library meeting State certification requirements. This aid is used to supplement Town appropriated funds. Our FY25 award was $55,127.56, an increase of just under $5,000 over FY24.

The Library applies for grants to fund outreach efforts, special programs, and projects. In FY2025, gifts from individuals, all with specified intentions, totaled $22,738.75, including a $15,000 gift from the Donald R. Ellis Revocable Trust. Gifts from private individuals are held in designated gift accounts and used for their intended purpose – typically books in honor of someone. We are grateful for continued support from Mt. Vernon House for $3,000 in both April 2025, to be used toward the purchase of large print books.
Past private donations have led to the establishment of Trust Fund accounts and the Endowment Fund. Trust Fund income ($3,111.77 in FY25) is used to make book selections according to the wishes of the donor. Gifts to the Endowment Fund totaled $15,385 in FY25. Endowment Fund income is restricted to enriching and enhancing Library operations and services.

We are grateful for the support of our Friends of the Library. They received grants from the John and Mary Murphy Educational Foundation, En Ka, and the Rotary Club of Winchester as well as generous contributions from private individuals. The Friends fund all our Adult and Children's programming throughout the year, museum passes, and the library newsletter.

ARCHIVAL CENTER

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	21,561	22,807	37,014	22,807	0
Other Expenses	1,795	2,300	2,900	2,650	0
Total	23,356	25,107	39,914	25,457	0
Staffing					
Managerial	0	0	0	0	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	0.54	0.54	0.54	0.54	
Total	0.54	0.54	0.54	0.54	0

Program Description

The Archival Center functions as the repository for historical documents, photographs and media pertaining to the history of the town of Winchester. It is located on the ground floor of Town Hall and is supervised by the Town Clerk and overseen by the Archives Advisory Committee (AAC).

FY2027 Initiatives

- Expand the position to add a records clerk to the Town Clerk's staff. The position will be split between the Archives 12 hours per week and the Town Clerk's Office 7 hours per week.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- The Center continued to be open to the public through the end of the calendar year on Monday afternoons with the remaining hours being flexible for individual appointments and remote reference work.
- Our Reference Archivist Dr. Ellen Knight continued to assist a variety of walk-in and e-mail patrons. Subjects of interest ranged from house histories to Indigenous history, to the development of Hillside, and special projects such as the upcoming Rotary centennial and upcoming Jenks Center 50th (both in 2028), and an historical lecture by a Myopia Club member. Two new books acknowledging our Archives, *Chasing Chance* (on the Prince family) and a biography of Edward Brackett, were published.
- This year marking Winchester's 175th Anniversary, Knight collaborated with the Winchester Historical Society by being a speaker, assisting with a video on the town's boundaries, and by consulting on and providing images for the Historic Winchester sign to replace the Society's (weather damaged) gift from the 150th anniversary.
- Knight developed an inventory of all the collections and checked the status of finding aids and their entry into the digital catalog, PastPerfect, as well as the entry of the photo collections into the catalog. She continued entering photograph collections, such as the collection of 1979 Historical Commission house photographs, Vinson-Owen collection, and Second Congregational Church collection.

- AAC member Susan Keats developed a spreadsheet on Winchester houses and their status on historic lists for use by the Planning Board and other departments.
- The Archives processed several new donations, including 11 photographs of architect Robert Coit houses (the basis of a Historical Society program on the same) and a scrapbook on Winchester's Grand (piano), and acquired some new photographs, including the earliest known pictures of the original high school and of the Brown and Stanton Building.
- The Archives continued to work cooperatively with other departments, including the Town Clerk's Office, Engineering, Conservation Commission, the Historical Commission, Historical Society, and others when called upon for historical research.

		ARCHIVES	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0169401	51101	PERMANENT	21,712	21,561	22,807	37,014	22,807	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**21,712**	**21,561**	**22,807**	**37,014**	**22,807**	**0**
0169402	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	0	0	500	750	750	
0169402	52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	100	0	100	150	150	
0169402	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	100	1,320	100	100	100	
0169402	53116	BIND & BK REPAIRS	100	475	100	150	150	
0169402	53118	PROF SERVICES	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0169402	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	500	0	500	750	500	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**1,800**	**1,795**	**2,300**	**2,900**	**2,650**	**0**
		ARCHIVES TOTAL	**23,512**	**23,356**	**25,107**	**39,914**	**25,457**	**0**

HISTORICAL COMMISSION (6941)

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	1,384	3,000	3,000	3,000	0
Other Expenses	1,384	12,500	12,500	0	0
Total	2,767	15,500	15,500	3,000	0
Staffing					
Managerial	0	0	0	0	
Clerical	0	0	0	0	
Professional/Technical	0	0	0	0	
Total	0	0	0	0	0

Program Description

The mission of the Historical Commission is the preservation, protection, and development of our town's historical or archeological assets, and the establishment of protective measures of these assets for future generations.

Historic Preservation Actions

Consideration of Demolition Permit Applications

33 Everett Garage	Delay imposed	Unlikely to be saved
176 Dothan	No delay imposed	
30 Swan	Delay imposed	Unlikely to be saved
21High (Carriage House)	Delay imposed	Status in doubt; ongoing efforts for alternative use
1 Town Way	Delay imposed	Renovations underway; likely to be saved
3 Foxcroft Garage	No delay imposed	
10-16 Mt. Vernon	Delay imposed	Outcome uncertain
66-69 Hemingway	Delay imposed	In discussions with developer; likely to be saved
149-151 Swanton	No delay imposed	
31 Fells	Delay imposed	In discussions with developer; outcome uncertain

Other Actions and Efforts

- WHC efforts to save the Sanborne Carriage House
- WHC input on proposed plans for 10 Converse
- Participation on the Rangely Park Heritage District
- West Side Survey commissioning following successful grant from the State
- Significant input on replacement of Town library envelope/roof
- Participation on the Town CPA committee

- Participation in the Town's Central Business District votes and determinations
- Monthly determinations on ZBA petitions and the effect on the Town's Historical Assets

Ongoing Goals

- Continuing the survey of the town's properties to document its historic buildings and sites.
- Continuing efforts to preserve the Sanborne Carriage House.
- Continuing to influence decisions by the Zoning Board of Appeals and the Planning Board from a historical preservation.
- Greater participation in the Capital Planning Committee's priorities

HISTORICAL COMMISSION			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0169411	51251	TEMPORARY	3,000	1,384	3,000	3,000	3,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**3,000**	**1,384**	**3,000**	**3,000**	**3,000**	**0**
0169411	53118	PROF SERVICES	3,000	1,384	12,500	12,500	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**3,000**	**1,384**	**12,500**	**12,500**	**0**	**0**
		HISTORICAL COMMISSION TOTAL	**6,000**	**2,767**	**15,500**	**15,500**	**3,000**	**0**

SECTION V

Service Programs – Health and Social Services

Health Department (5110)

Council on Aging (5410)

Veteran Services (5420)

HEALTH DEPARTMENT

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	427,920	466,038	501,974	456,916	0
Other Expenses	45,885	96,850	98,800	88,800	0
Total	473,805	562,888	600,774	545,716	0
Staffing					
Managerial	2	2	2	2	
Clerical	1	1	1	1	
Professional/Technical	1.48	1.48	2	1.48	
Total	4.48	4.48	5	4.48	0

Program Description

The mission of the Health Department is to promote a healthy community by protecting the public's health and well-being through prevention and control of communicable disease and environmental health hazards.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Assist with BOH review and possible adoption of a regulation prohibiting the sale of kratom and synthetic THC products.
- Utilize additional opioid settlement funding for substance use disorder prevention, treatment and harm reduction measures.
- Review and update the format for the Plan Review Application process for food establishments.
- Generate draft BOH regulation to prevent grease from entering the public sewer from food establishments.
- Continued promotion of resources and connections to mental health care and deliver educational and prevention messaging.
- Continue to offer immunizations for the public including annual flu and COVID clinics, pneumonia, tetanus, shingles and RSV vaccines, as well as blood pressure and TB screenings.
- Continue to offer vaccination programs for children including mandatory childhood vaccines as well as, voluntary HPV vaccination clinics to high school seniors and middle school students.
- Hold school-based flu immunization clinic program in every school in collaboration with the School Department for the 18th year.
- Carry out all mandatory inspection and permitting requirements: food service, housing, pools, camps for children, wells, beach, Title V, etc.
- Contract with U.S. Wildlife Service for Canada geese control and contract with the Eastern Middlesex Mosquito Control District for mosquito control activities.
- Collaborate with police department to provide for medication and sharps kiosk collection in addition to holding two annual medication and sharps collection days.

- Continue education, prevention and mitigation response to respiratory illness data, including flu and COVID-19.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Utilized opioid settlement funding: to continue to support sober living expenses, contract with certified Recovery Coaches for individual and family support, provide connection and resources to care and provided a free CPR/Narcan certification class to the community in collaboration with the Recreation Dept.
- Conducted voluntary bladder cancer screening for Fire Department staff. Twenty-two (22) fire fighters participated.
- Continued free distribution of COVID home test kits to the public and town entities, including all school nurses.
- Operated 3 COVID vaccine clinics to ages 5 and older; 353 vaccines administered.
- Operated annual flu vaccine clinics:
    - 17th annual school clinics were held during the school day in all 7 schools with continued collaboration between the Health Department and School Nurses.
    - 1064 students and 225 staff received their flu vaccine (including shot and FluMist).
    - General Public Flu Clinics: 6 clinics, office appointments and home visits for a total of 812 flu vaccines administered.
- In addition to holding monthly meetings of the Winchester Coalition for a Safer Community (WCSC), the Community Health Program Manager (CHPM) arranged for the following programs (highlights):
    - Narcan Kits and Narcan education were made available to all WHS 2025 graduates.
    - The first community Recovery and Remembrance Candlelight Vigil was held at the Town Common to celebrate those in recovery from substance addiction and remember those who have passed.
    - "Gambling with our Kids: Recognizing When It Is a Problem" was presented by A.Cedrone, LMHC, Wakefield Schools Adjustment Counselor.
- Environmental Health Inspector conducted 380 inspections for compliance and/or permitting purposes: seasonal and permanent food service activities, new food establishments, camps for children, semi-public pools, housing complaints, as well as investigation into public health nuisance complaints.
- Environmental Health Inspector earned the National Certified Professional in Food Safety certification and completed the FDA standardized training for food inspections.
- Offered 8 free Household Hazardous Waste Collection events for residents through the Minuteman collaborative at the Lexington DPW.
- Held 2 medication/sharps disposal days in collaboration with the Winchester Police Department, U.S. Drug Enforcement Agency, and WHS volunteers. Continued to collect meds and sharps 24/7 at kiosk in police station lobby. Total sharps collected = 1519 lbs and Total Meds Collected = 915 lbs.

- Administered routine immunizations for children (38) and continued to provide shingles, Tdap, RSV and pneumonia vaccination to eligible adult residents (27).
- Investigated and provided case management on eighty-six (86) communicable disease cases (non-COVID, non-Influenza).
- Offered timely prevention and educational messaging to community for communicable and infectious illnesses, including COVID, RSV, Flu, Norovirus, and tick and mosquito-borne illnesses.
- Contracted for mosquito control and surveillance of West Nile Virus with the Eastern Middlesex Mosquito Control District.
- Continued to offer subsidized tick analysis program for residents.
- Contracted with U.S. Wildlife Service for Canada geese control.

		HEALTH DEPARTMENT	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0151101	51101	PERMANENT	421,395	420,855	456,410	490,474	445,416	
0151101	51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	0	245	2,900	2,000	2,000	
0151101	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	4,300	1,500	1,500	2,500	2,500	
0151101	51251	TEMPORARY	2,565	200	2,050	2,000	2,000	
0151101	51359	OVERTIME	3,075	5,120	3,178	5,000	5,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**431,335**	**427,920**	**466,038**	**501,974**	**456,916**	**0**
0151102	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	1,000	1,783	1,000	1,800	1,800	
0151102	52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUC SUPPLI	700	700	700	700	700	
0151102	52179	MEDICAL & DENTAL	5,000	3,230	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0151102	52,186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	0	0	0	0	0	
0151102	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	0	1,638	1,700	1,700	1,700	
0151102	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	300	300	300	300	300	
0151102	53115	ADVERTISING	350	0	350	300	300	
0151102	53118	PROF SERVICES	70,000	34,876	83,000	84,000	74,000	
0151102	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	300	69	300	300	300	
0151102	53123	OUT OF STATE TRAVEL	0	1,831	0	0	0	
0151102	53161	R&M FURNITURE/EQUIPMENT	2,500	243	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0151102	53166	TUITION	500	615	500	600	600	
0151102	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	400	600	500	600	600	
0151102	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	1,700	0	0	0	0	
0151102	55104	COMMUNICATIONS	1,500	0	1,500	1,500	1,500	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**84,250**	**45,885**	**96,850**	**98,800**	**88,800**	**0**
		HEALTH DEPARTMENT TOTAL	**515,585**	**473,805**	**562,888**	**600,774**	**545,716**	**0**

COUNCIL ON AGING

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	462,476	489,067	527,157	502,657	0
Other Expenses	6,000	8,800	38,800	8,800	0
Total	468,476	497,867	565,957	511,457	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	
Professional/Technical	3.29	3.29	3.29	3.29	
Total	5.79	5.79	5.79	5.79	0

Program Description

The Council on Aging (COA) is the local government agency, established by Massachusetts Law, to meet the needs of older adults within the community. The mission of the Winchester COA is to identify the needs of Winchester's seniors and to meet those needs through services, education and advocacy. The COA is governed by an eleven-member Board appointed by the Select Board. Professional staff assist the Board in carrying out its Mission.

The staff consists of the following: director, licensed social worker, registered nurse, transportation coordinator, administrative secretary, senor clerk and three part-time drivers to implement the Council on Aging's programs and services. In addition, the COA contracts consultative services with a nutritionist and a Mandarin speaking ambassador who is paid through the Cummings Foundation. In addition to ten volunteers through the tax abatement program, over 50 volunteers play an integral role in fulfilling the COA mission.

Approximately 3500 individual unduplicated clients received direct professional services in 2026 relating primarily to health maintenance, case management, food insecurity, nutrition and dining, transportation services, educational programs and events, information and referral to access resources. A majority of clients are age 75 and older and most are women. The COA continues to serve a growing population of Mandarin-speaking older adults, over 250 unduplicated contacts per month.

FY 2027 Initiatives

- Continue to work with the Winchester Chamber of Commerce to develop and implement employment fair for Winchester's older adults. Along with Job Fair, host "volunteer fair" to enable Winchester non-profits and government agencies an opportunity to provide meaningful work for seniors. Work with Select Board to modify and incentivize tax abatement participation as well as increase tax abatement placements within Town government and schools.
- To enhance nutritional outcomes, seek intern assistance from Tufts University.
- With Winchester Age-Friendly Committee, Town Planning staff and Planning, develop Age-Friendly Winchester workplan.

- Continue work to develop intergenerational programs with high school and middle school students.
- Plan Symposium on "Living Longer and Planning for an Uncertain Future".
- With COA board assistance, expand marketing efforts regarding COA programs and services.
- With nurse and social worker, maximize outreach efforts for caregiver respite program.
- Work with Assessors Office and COA financial counsellor to expand education to patrons regarding tax savings offered through Winchester, State and Federal governments.
- Continue planning efforts for the Jenks Center 50th anniversary in 2028—oral histories with Jenks founders of 1970s, patrons in the 1980s and 1990s as well as digitalization of archives.
- Continue efforts with COA board, Winchester Seniors Association board and Winchester Seniors Association Trust board, developing a Jenks space optimization strategic plan.

FY 2026 Accomplishments

- Promoted economic security through continuance of tax abatement program with 14 residents receiving $1500 abatement. Developed new guidelines for 2025 program providing greater financial incentives.
- Continuation of multiple transportation initiatives to benefit Winchester's older adults. The purchase of a Rav4 SUV enhanced the fleet of Jenks Shuttle bus and medical transportation van. More than 300 unduplicated contacts were served with COA transportation.
- The COA completed year one of Cummings Foundation initiatives with in-person and virtual instruction for ESL and American Citizenship classes. Funding also included the hire of an "ambassador", Michelle Zhang, a Mandarin-speaking consultant assisting with translation, survey assessments and programing to promote cultural competency that includes basic Mandarin conversation for Jenks English-speaking patrons, including the director.
- The COA nurse continued blood pressure and diabetes screening clinics at the Jenks and Winchester Housing Authority. A new program "caregiver respite", enables caregivers to bring vulnerable loved ones to Jenks for education, music and lunch while they have 3 hours of free time to tend to personal matters including massage/spa services. A grant from Winchester Mount Vernon House provided $8500 to enhance caregiver resources including a speaker series.
- Education programs provided legal, financial and medical information (retirement preparedness, Medicare enrollment, healthcare proxies, trusts/wills, etc.)
- Continued partnership with Minuteman Senior Services to reimagine congregate dining programs with addition of Traveling Chef in which chefs from Trio Catering come to Jenks to prepare and serve food subsidized by the COA's formula grant.

- The relaunch of Age-Friendly Winchester initiative began with the formation of a committee that received over 250 survey responses to ascertain resident perceptions of the Town of Winchester's age-friendly capacity. A public meeting will be held at the Jenks in December, and this feedback will be incorporated in a workplan shared with Select Board and Planning Board.
- Continued collaboration with Winchester Seniors Association and Winchester Seniors Association Trust to maximize organizational efficiencies and share resources.
- Hosted Symposium "Artificial Intelligence and its Impact to Foster Healthy Aging and Independence" with MIT Age-Lab faculty with over 225 attendees. This led to a visit to MIT Age Lab to develop a partnership with them on using technology to improve aging in place.
- Partnerships continue with Winchester organizations continue: Winchester Public Library "Sociological Book Club" intergenerational programing with Winchester High School and McCall Middle School, Griffin Museum rotating exhibits at the Jenks, Winchester Board of Health multiple Covid and flu vaccination, Red Cross blood drives and more.
- Celebrations are underway for the Jenks 50th Anniversary.
- Continue participation with Jenks Strategic Planning committee to optimize space utilization. Four architects responded to a recently issued request for proposals.

		COUNCIL ON AGING	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0154101	51101	PERMANENT	453,926	456,020	483,517	518,607	494,107	
0154101	51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	3,550	4,281	3,550	3,550	3,550	
0154101	51,161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	0	2,175	2,000	0	0	
0154101	51359	OVERTIME	5,000	0	0	5,000	5,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**462,476**	**462,476**	**489,067**	**527,157**	**502,657**	**0**
0154102	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	1,800	1,792	1,800	0	0	
0154102	52105	COMPUTER SUPPLIES	0	0	0	1,800	1,800	
0154102	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	2,000	1,338	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0154102	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	1,500	641	1,500	1,500	1,500	
0154102		LEASE PAYMENTS TO WSA	0	0	0	30,000	0	
0154102	53118	PROF SERVICES	2,000	1,810	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0154102	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	0	359	0	0	0	
0154102	53166	TUITION	1,500	60	1,500	1,500	1,500	
0154102	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	0	0	0	0	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**8,800**	**6,000**	**8,800**	**38,800**	**8,800**	**0**
		COUNCIL ON AGING TOTAL	**471,276**	**468,476**	**497,867**	**565,957**	**511,457**	**0**

VETERANS SERVICES

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	11,145	11,428	11,428	11,428	0
Other Expenses	33,277	44,425	44,725	44,725	0
Total	44,422	55,853	56,153	56,153	0
Staffing					
Managerial					
Clerical					
Professional/Technical					
Total	0	0	0	0	0

Program Description

State statue require each Massachusetts municipality to administer the State's General Assistance to Veterans program rather than require this assistance to filter through the regional general welfare services offices located in various areas of the State. The Veterans' Agent assists Winchester veterans in obtaining payments they are permitted to receive under various State and Federal laws. The Town is reimbursed for 75% of the payments made. It is noted that over the past several years the annual requirements and payments to eligible veterans has declined.

		VETERANS SERVICES	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0154201	51101	PERMANENT	11,148	11,145	11,428	11,428	11,428	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**11,148**	**11,145**	**11,428**	**11,428**	**11,428**	**0**
0154202	52112	FLAGS	3,500	3,499	3,500	3,500	3,500	
0154202	52136	AGRICULTURE AND HORTICULTURE	2,750	2,565	2,750	2,750	2,750	
0154202	53118	PROF SERVICES	10,000	0	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0154202	53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	300	0	300	300	300	
0154202	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	75	0	75	75	75	
0154202	54112	DIRECT CASH GRANTS	22,000	21,419	22,000	22,000	22,000	
0154202	54122	FOOD & CLOTHING ASSIST	300	0	300	300	300	
0154202	54126	CURRENT CHARGES	5,550	5,795	5,500	5,800	5,800	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**44,475**	**33,277**	**44,425**	**44,725**	**44,725**	**0**
		VETERAN SERVICES TOTAL	**55,623**	**44,422**	**55,853**	**56,153**	**56,153**	**0**

SECTION VI

Service Programs – Public Safety

Police Department (2110)

Fire Department (2210)

Sealer of Weights & Measures (2420)

POLICE DEPARTMENT

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	6,221,374	6,324,126	6,380,957	6,380,957	0
Other Expenses	291,923	311,879	328,254	328,254	0
Equipment	118,000	59,000	124,000	124,000	0
Total	6,631,297	6,695,005	6,833,211	6,833,211	0
Staffing					
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	2	2	2	2	
Professional/Technical	7FT, 3PT	7FT, 3PT	7FT, 3PT	7FT, 3PT	
Police Superior	12	12	12	12	
Police Patrol	27	27	27	27	
Public Works	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	
Parking Warden	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	
Crossing Guards part-time	28	28	28	28	
Total	72	72	72	72	0

Program Description

The Police Department's primary function is the enforcement of laws and protection of life and property. This includes prevention of crime, preservation of the peace, law enforcement and detection of violators. When law violators are detected, they can be cited, summonsed or arrested. In the case of juveniles and young adults, when appropriate the police department can utilize various diversion programs to prevent a juvenile or young adult from having a criminal record. The Police Department responds to emergencies, provides for the efficient movement of motor vehicle and pedestrian traffic, trains and supervises school crossing guards, animal control officer, public safety dispatchers, and the parking enforcement officer. The Police Department over the past several years has committed to the philosophy of community policing by forming alliances and partnerships with other communities, community groups, instituting new programs and the use of technology. Through an alliance with NEMLEC (North Eastern Massachusetts Law Enforcement Council), the Police Department shares valuable resources with 59 other police departments in northeastern Massachusetts. Locally, the Police Department works closely with many community groups and organizations, such as the School Department and WCSC (Winchester Coalition for a Safer Community through the Health Department). Community Policing based programs include the STARS Programs (Safety in our schools) and our on-going "Violence in the Work Place" education program for our local businesses and Town departments. Through the use of our Web Page, Twitter, Facebook, the Department continues to educate the community in crime prevention and public safety activities.

Budget Statement

The FY2027 budget reflects a level of funding to support the Administration, Patrol Division, Investigative Division, School Resource Officer program, Community Resource Officer, Civilian Dispatch staffing, Parking Enforcement, School Traffic Crossing Guards and the

department's Mental Health Social Worker position. This budget also addresses the repetitive upgrading and replacement of vehicles, equipment, technology and associated maintenance. It addresses the need for Parking Enforcement capabilities in the town center and adjacent lots. The FY2027 budget does not account for superior officer and patrol officer unions who are currently starting contract negotiations with the town. Both union contracts ended on the last day of FY26. The FY27 budget does not reflect any cost-of-living increase for non-union employees. The FY27 budget does take into account the recently settled Clerical Union contract. The budget does request that the vehicle replacement schedule be returned to two cruisers for FY27.

FY2027 Initiatives

- POST recertification for officers under the new POST time frame corresponding to officers' dates of birth.
- Field train four new officers who will be graduating from a MPTC academy in June/July 2026.
- Work on contract negotiations with superior officer and patrol officer unions for FY26-FY28.
- On-going objective to provide a proper work environment for all employees to include building cleanliness and maintenance, proper tools and equipment to do their jobs and competent, appropriate and responsive supervision continues. This is a day after day, year after year objective.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Hired two new patrol officers. One officer is on road the other the second officer is in field training.
- Hired four new patrol officers. Entering academy in January 2026.
- Hired two part-time civilian dispatchers.
- Able to complete the required POST recertification for all officers with last names between A-H.
- Replaced our end-of-life network domain controllers with the latest models.
- Upgraded phone systems to IP based system. Purchased two new switches.
- Purchased and installed new 911 recorder (no longer supported by state)
- Obtained grant funding to replace nine protective vests for officers.
- Obtained funding from capital to upgrade door access and cameras at the Rec Department's building.

External Funding

- For FY2026 the police department received two reimbursable grants from the State 911 Department. The two grants are the state 911 training grant which is reimbursable up to $18,201.04 and the state 911 support grant that is reimbursable up to $65,826.
- The training grant is to assist in training, certifying and recertifying our 911 PSAP (Public Safety Answering Point) dispatchers in various aspects of public safety dispatching. This training is ongoing annually.

- The support grant can be used to purchase certain equipment directly associated with our Dispatch Center (Fire, Police.EMS) or to provide additional PSAP coverage during times when it is determined that it is needed.
- These grants must be applied for annually.

	POLICE DEPARTMENT	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
51101	PERMANENT	5,137,835	4,659,758	5,093,952	5,161,662	5,161,662	0
51145	HOLIDAY	176,141	208,305	194,262	197,269	197,269	0
51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	8,077	7,619	8,561	9,129	9,129	0
51157	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - SUPERIOR OFFICER	80,136	69,122	67,904	68,533	68,533	0
51158	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - POLICE OFFICER	38,841	37,710	47,263	41,890	41,890	0
51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	4,750	3,375	4,500	4,500	4,500	0
51251	TEMPORARY	355,328	364,485	359,594	352,013	352,013	0
51359	OVERTIME	505,838	849,465	515,418	513,289	513,289	0
51363	SICK LEAVE COVERAGE	16,350	964	16,672	16,672	16,672	0
51364	COURT TIME	16,000	20,571	16,000	16,000	16,000	0
51365	OFF DUTY	0	0	0	0	0	0
	PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**6,339,296**	**6,221,374**	**6,324,126**	**6,380,957**	**6,380,957**	**0**
52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	7,700	3,568	7,700	7,700	7,700	0
52103	PRINTING & STATIONERY	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	0
52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	250	0	250	250	250	0
52113	CLEANING SUPPLIES	4,000	0	4,000	4,000	4,000	0
52115	HOUSEHOLD SUPPLIES	1,600	2,140	1,600	1,600	1,600	0
52123	HARDWARE	700	614	700	700	700	0
52125	PAINTING SUPPLIES	200	0	200	200	200	0
52138	SUPPLIES, AUTOMOBILE	6,700	6,541	6,700	6,700	6,700	0
52142	TIRES, TUBES & CHAINS	7,900	5,631	8,500	9,000	9,000	0
52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	100	3,244	100	100	100	0
52180	FOOD & GROCERIES	1,600	2,416	1,700	2,250	2,250	0
52181	PUBLIC SAFETY SUPPLY	42,500	41,602	42,500	42,500	42,500	0
52184	CLOTHING & UNIFORMS	59,650	29,953	61,500	61,500	61,500	0
52186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	1,450	0	1,450	1,450	1,450	0
52217	AUXILLARY UNIFORMS/EQUIPMENT	0	0	0	0	0	0
52250	EQUIP LEASES/RENTALS	0	2,376	3,000	3,000	3,000	0
53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	3,800	6,955	4,300	4,500	4,500	0
53107	POSTAGE	900	489	900	900	900	0
53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BUILDING	33,654	28,516	33,654	33,654	33,654	0
53115	ADVERTISING	300	489	600	600	600	0
53118	PROF SERVICES	16,000	19,390	13,000	15,000	15,000	0
53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	3,050	241	3,050	3,050	3,050	0
53123	OUT OF STATE TRAVEL	3,500	4,732	0	0	0	0
53127	R & M AUTOMOTIVE	10,600	4,077	10,600	10,600	10,600	0
53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	48,500	82,507	44,000	56,000	56,000	0
53129	LEASE PAYMENTS	6,000	0	0	0	0	0
53138	R&M BLDG & STRUCT	50	0	50	50	50	0
53143	AMBROSE/R&M BLDG & STRUC	3,500	1,748	3,500	3,500	3,500	0
53167	TUITION	27,275	24,985	27,275	27,400	27,400	0
53238	SOFTWARE LIC & RENEWAL	0	8,802	17,000	17,000	17,000	0
54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	1,850	2,594	2,250	3,250	3,250	0
54115	MEDICAL, SURGICAL	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	0
54117	PAYMENTS TO MUNICIPALITIES	9,800	8,315	9,800	9,800	9,800	0
	EXPENSES TOTAL	**305,129**	**291,923**	**311,879**	**328,254**	**328,254**	**0**
55109	PUBLIC SAFETY	118,000	118,000	59,000	124,000	124,000	0
	EQUIPMENT TOTAL	**118,000**	**118,000**	**59,000**	**124,000**	**124,000**	**0**
	POLICE DEPARTMENT TOTAL	**6,762,425**	**6,631,297**	**6,695,005**	**6,833,211**	**6,833,211**	**0**

FIRE DEPARTMENT

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	6,640,143	6,916,344	6,995,403	6,995,403	0
Other Expenses	346,828	430,500	490,500	490,500	0
Equipment	8,692	0	0	0	0
Total	6,995,662	7,346,844	7,485,903	7,485,903	0
Staffing					
Managerial	2	2	2	2	
Clerical	1	1	1	1	
Fire Officers	12	12	14	14	
Fire Fighters	36	36	36	36	
Total	51	51	53	53	0

Program Description

The Fire Department operates two stations: Fire Headquarters is located at 32 Mount Vernon Street and the West Side Station is at 45 Lockeland Road. The Department employs a staff of 1 Chief, 1 Administrative Assistant, 1 Deputy Chief, 5 Captains, 9 Lieutenants and 36 Firefighters. Two fire engines, one aerial ladder truck and one ambulance are staffed with a minimum of 9 firefighters on each of 4 duty shifts: a staffing level below the current professional standard. The department is responsible for: Fire Protection - response to fire emergencies, rescue operation, and protection of property. Also required for this operation is maintenance of equipment and training of personnel to adequately respond to emergencies; Fire Prevention - fire inspections of both public and private buildings to ensure compliance with all safety requirements of laws and regulations; Emergency Medical Assistance - staffing, training, and materials for the delivery of quality emergency medical care.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue expanding the role of the recently hired Deputy Chief
- Expanding Health and Wellness initiatives
- Initiate study committee to remove fire department from civil service (ongoing)
- Continue to fill vacancies from civil service list currently 4 anticipated vacancies. (retirements)
- Expand office space at Central Station, explore feasibility of additional clerical position for fire prevention (ongoing)
- Continue advocacy for replacement of obsolete and worn department vehicles.
- Continue Rescue Task Force training and exercises with regional police and fire departments.
- Continue to seek state and federal monies, as well as training resources, to enhance the operation of the fire department and the safety of the public.
- Streamline and refine training program for Paramedics and EMT's to ensure compliance with both national and state standards.

- Host Emergency Management Tabletop exercise to further educate department heads on their roles during emergency operations.
- Advocate for additional day position for EMS Officer

FY2026 ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Held Emergency Operations Drill with the assistance of MEMA.
- Updated the Emergency Operations Center in the Public Safety Building with upgraded internet and phone.
- Expanded the roles of Deputy Chief position.
- Continued Rescue Task Force training with Winchester Police as well as mutual aid communities.
- Initiated feasibility study to decrease the department's carbon footprint and become a greener department with the assistance of the Sustainability Director. (ongoing)
- Hosted free cancer, hearing and ultrasound screenings, promoting health and wellness.
- Updated unserviceable ventilation equipment and cutting tools with funding from firefighter safety equipment grant.
- Continued program to identify and designate structures as high firefighting risk and, in conjunction with building inspector.
- Continued with the successful Student Awareness of Fire Education (S.A.F.E.) and expanded the Senior SAFE program with additional home visits and smoke alarm installations.
- Met with state legislators to try and secure funding for additional equipment.

EXTERNAL FUNDING SOURCES

The Fire Department has been the recipient of several grants from a variety of sources for many years. These grants are not guaranteed on an annual basis and are in some cases highly competitive. Monies received from these sources have reduced the town's budgetary burden for services or equipment that is necessary for the operation of the department. Any loss in grant funding could impact future Fire Department operating and capital budgets.

SAFE Grant **$ 4,100** **Educational Materials**

The Student Awareness Fire Education (SAFE) Grant is received annually to assist in the funding of educational programs for the public, particularly those for school aged and senior citizens.

Senior SAFE Grant **$2,000**

Supplementing the Student Awareness Fire Education Grant is the Senior SAFE grant. These funds support Public Fire and Life Safety programs targeted for our older population.

Emergency Planning Grant $ 5,100 EOC and rescue operations
Federal Emergency Management Agency provided this grant for the purchase of equipment to support operation of the Town EOC and to provide equipment for emergency operations in off road areas.

FEMA FY20 Assistance to Firefighter Grant - $104,081.44
Federal grant which will be used to complete the upgrade of the Self-Contained Breathing Apparatus

State Firefighter Safety Equipment Grant – two years – $42,000.00
State grant to assist fire departments to obtain various FF safety equipment.

Winchester First Responders Fund- $11,800
The charitable fund was created by generous citizens of Winchester to help supplement Winchester's first responder's budgets.

	FIRE DEPARTMENT	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
51101	PERMANENT	5,673,655	5,249,058	5,743,257	5,812,009	5,812,009	0
51145	HOLIDAY	308,005	279,335	306,568	293,730	293,730	0
51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	9,352	4,281	9,352	9,352	9,352	0
51159	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - FIREFIGHTER	178,425	130,445	172,867	173,512	173,512	0
51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON UNION	4,500	2,250	4,500	4,500	4,500	0
51359	OVERTIME	649,433	948,376	648,000	670,500	670,500	0
51363	SICK LEAVE COVERAGE	0	0	0	0	0	0
51901	CLOTHING ALLOWANCE	31,800	26,400	31,800	31,800	31,800	0
	PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**6,855,170**	**6,640,143**	**6,916,344**	**6,995,403**	**6,995,403**	**0**
52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	500	626	5,650	5,650	5,650	0
52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUCTION SUPPLI	400	122	0	0	0	0
52105	COMPUTER SUPPLIES	1,000	177	0	0	0	0
52106	BOOKS AND PERIODICALS	1,000	475	1,000	1,000	1,000	0
52113	CLEANING SUPPLIES	2,600	1,203	0	0	0	0
52115	HOUSEHOLD SUPPLIES	1,800	1,679	0	0	0	0
52116	ELECTRICAL SUPPLIES	750	984	0	0	0	0
52117	FIRE ALARM SUPPLIES	11,000	8,262	11,000	11,000	11,000	0
52123	HARDWARE	300	297	0	0	0	0
52125	PAINTING SUPPLIES	600	595	0	0	0	0
52127	PLUMBING, HEATING & VENTILAT	200	149	0	0	0	0
52138	SUPPLIES, AUTOMOBILE	23,400	25,406	33,500	33,500	33,500	0
52142	TIRES, TUBES & CHAINS	9,400	11,903	0	0	0	0
52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	1,600	1,501	15,000	15,000	15,000	0
52179	MEDICAL & DENTAL	55,700	41,129	55,700	55,700	55,700	0
52180	FOOD & GROCERIES	630	3,141	650	650	650	0
52181	PUBLIC SAFETY SUPPLY	10,600	12,875	0	0	0	0
52184	CLOTHING & UNIFORMS	46,000	40,301	46,000	46,000	46,000	0
52186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	2,300	685	24,350	24,350	24,350	0
53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	1,350	142	0	0	0	0
53107	POSTAGE	300	299	300	300	300	0
53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BUILDINGS	15,000	9,151	13,500	13,500	13,500	0
53115	ADVERTISING	200	0	0	0	0	0
53118	PROF SERVICES	20,000	17,803	0	0	0	0
53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	2,600	2,228	2,600	2,600	2,600	0
53124	CLEAN & SANITARY	1,000	0	0	0	0	0
53127	R & M FIRE AUTOMOTIVE	6,750	37,211	0	0	0	0
53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	3,800	2,438	0	0	0	0
53138	R&M BLDG & STRUCT	3,000	2,540	0	0	0	0
53160	R & M FIRE ALARM	750	0	0	0	0	0
53166	TUITION	48,000	32,552	50,000	110,000	110,000	0
53172	CONTRACTUAL SERVICE	83,300	72,275	96,850	96,850	96,850	0
53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	14,100	15,167	14,100	14,100	14,100	0
53253	REPAIRS & MAINTENANCE	0	0	32,100	32,100	32,100	0
53303	LICENSE REIMBURSEMENT	2,000	823	2,000	2,000	2,000	0
54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	4,200	1,766	4,700	4,700	4,700	0
54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	500	367	0	0	0	0
54115	MEDICAL, SURGICAL	1,200	555	0	0	0	0
54117	PAYMENTS TO MUNICIPALITIES	850	0	0	0	0	0
55103	OFFICE EQUIPMENT	0	0	1,500	1,500	1,500	0
55112	EQUIPMENT	0	0	20,000	20,000	20,000	0
	EXPENSES TOTAL	**378,680**	**346,828**	**430,500**	**490,500**	**490,500**	**0**
55101	FURNITURE AND FIXTURES	500	346	0	0	0	0
55103	OFFICE EQUIPMENT	500	234	0	0	0	0
55109	PUBLIC SAFETY	47,150	1,263	0	0	0	0
55112	EQUIPMENT, NOT OTHERWISE CLA	15,750	6,848	0	0	0	0
	EQUIPMENT TOTAL	**63,900**	**8,692**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**
	FIRE DEPARTMENT TOTAL	**7,297,750**	**6,995,662**	**7,346,844**	**7,485,903**	**7,485,903**	**0**

SEALER OF WEIGHTS & MEASURES

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	9,178	9,408	9,408	9,408	0
Other Expenses	427	2,072	2,072	2,072	0
Total	9,605	11,480	11,480	11,480	0
Staffing					
Managerial					
Clerical					
Professional/Technical					
Total	0	0	0	0	0

Program Description

The purpose of this department is to certify and approve all of the Town's weighing and measuring systems as required under state law. The majority of the work is with scales and gas station meters checking for their accuracy. Oil trucks are also checked periodically and annually.

SEALER OF WEIGHTS & MEASURES			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0124201	51101	PERMANENT	9,178	9,178	9,408	9,408	9,408	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**9,178**	**9,178**	**9,408**	**9,408**	**9,408**	**0**
0124202	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	170	0	170	170	170	
0124202	52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	1,102	0	1,102	1,102	1,102	
0124202	52184	CLOTHING & UNIFORM	0	0	0	0	0	
0124202	53117	AUTO ALLOWANCE	150	177	150	150	150	
0124202	53166	TUITION	350	90	350	350	350	
0124202	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	300	160	300	300	300	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**2,072**	**427**	**2,072**	**2,072**	**2,072**	**0**
		SEALER OR WEIGHTS & MEASURES TOTAL	**11,250**	**9,605**	**11,480**	**11,480**	**11,480**	**0**

SECTION VII

Service Programs – Department of Public Works (4100)

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS (DPW)

Program Costs	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Personal Services	5,815,881	6,110,677	6,249,595	6,249,595	0
Other Expenses	3,458,343	3,563,111	3,657,871	3,657,871	0
Equipment	0	19,500	19,500	19,500	0
Total	9,274,224	9,693,288	9,926,966	9,926,966	0
Staffing					
Managerial	4	4	4	4	
Clerical	3	3	3	3	
Public Works	22	22	22	22	
Professional/Technical	11	12	12	12	
Custodian - Schools	29	30	30	30	
Custodian - Public Works	1	1	1	1	
Total	70	72	72	72	0

Program Description

The Public Works Department maintains and improves public health and safety for the citizens of Winchester through the maintenance, repair and improvement of the Town's infrastructure including municipal and school buildings, streets and sidewalks, parks, water and sewer systems, fleet maintenance and refuse disposal. The sub-programs that provide these services include Administration, Maintenance, Buildings, Garage, Transfer Station, Cemetery and Snow and Ice. The Water and Sewer is budgeted separately as a self-supporting enterprise.

DPW Administration

Program Description

This sub-program of the Public Works budget is responsible for developing and monitoring departmental operating and capital budgets as well as the Town's Energy budget. This sub-program provides support for all D.P.W. divisions including the preparation of payroll, accounts payable and receivable, and preparation of specifications and bid documents for contract administration for school and municipal buildings.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue to work with local volunteer groups and vendors to expand the Town's efforts to divert organics from the waste stream and make ongoing recycling efforts as user friendly as possible at the Transfer Station and Town buildings.
- Continue to review operational expenses across all divisions for opportunities to achieve reduction in expenses.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Negotiated a blend and extend contract with the current solid waste disposal vendor for additional three years.
- Worked with Energy Management Committee in funding window replacement at the Mystic School with federal grant.
- Issued a Request for Proposals and awarded a fixed rate recycling contract in FY26 to WinWaste Innovations for three years with no increase in rates. The prior vendor's rates increased 5% each year.

DPW Maintenance

Program Description

This is the largest (non-Water & Sewer) component of the D.P.W. and annually maintains 98 miles of streets and all municipal and school grounds, including roadway maintenance, repair, surfacing and sidewalk repair. In addition, it includes (1) roadway cleaning, litter control, dead animal pick-up, and accident cleanup; (2) traffic control including line and crosswalk painting, street sign construction, repair and installations, and traffic signal repair; (3) arbor maintenance including street tree removal and trimming, insect control, storm cleanup, and Christmas tree light setup; (4) horticulture including tractor and hand mowing, pruning and planting, fertilizing, insect and litter control, and irrigation system maintenance; (5) play fields including rolling and leveling, fence and barrier maintenance, bleacher assembly and disassembly & repair; (6) ground maintenance of parks and around Town Hall and Library; and (7) major maintenance of school grounds.

FY 2027 Initiatives

- Continue street improvement program utilizing StreetScan software.
- Continue sidewalk repair program including ADA issues.
- Continue tree planting program.

- Continue repairing and replacing street signage as needed.
- Continue working with the Recreation Department to improve maintenance of field space and parks/recreational areas.
- Integrate new personnel into the snow and ice operation.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- With Chapter 90 funds, Newport Paving Corporation resurfaced the following streets: Main St.(Swanton to Lake), Skillings (portion), Lake St @ intersection, Dix Street, Glengarry, Grassmere Avenue, School Street, Pine Street, Curtis Street, Wildwood Street (Church to Fletcher), Cedar Street, Tremont Street, Summer Street, Winter Street, Wendell Street, Kirk Street (Cross to Wendell), Country Lane, Aricia Lane, Vinson Circle
- Cassidy Landscaping & Construction installed curbing and sidewalks on Johnson Road, Wildwood Street and Wendell Street. Installed ADA Ramps and bases for RRFB at 263 Main Street and ADA Ramps and sidewalk at Jenks Center,
- Installed sidewalks on Wedgemere Avenue, Cabot Street, Church Street, Oxford Street, Yale Street, Washington Street, Rumford Street, Irving Street, Elm Street, and Everell Road
- Superior Sealcoat Inc. applied approximately 8,000 gallons of sealcoating to multiple roads throughout Town.
- DPW installed completed sidewalk repairs at Cross Street, Washington Street, Calumet Road, Nelson Street, and Stowell Road.
- DPW repaired several sections of fencing due to storm damage.
- DPW installed asphalt berm as needed throughout Town.
- DPW installed 60 trees as part of tree planting program.

Statistics

	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Roadway Resurfacing	13 streets	11 streets	20 streets	14 streets
Park/Playground Maintenance	51 acres	51 acres	51 acres	51 acres
Sidewalks Repaired	3,000 feet	5,500 feet	4,500 feet	3,000 feet
ADA Ramps Installed	43 each	45 each	33 each	25 each

DPW Buildings

Program Description

This division is responsible for the maintenance and repair of all school and municipal buildings along with custodial services at all schools, Town Hall and the DPW offices.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue to work with the Town Manager and DPW Director on their vision for the direction the department will focus on.
- Wring out new systems at Lynch School.
- McCall School had its major renovation 25 years ago. Building systems are at an age that industry standards consider to be at the end of useful life. Planning and action to address these will be a focus.
- Continue updating the Town's Building condition database.
- Review present skill positions in the department and work with the Management to ensure we have the tools to maintain the intricate systems of our high efficiency buildings.

FY2026 Accomplishments

The Facilities Dept. struggles to fill high skill positions to service and diagnose problems with its ever-growing inventory of high technology building systems. Present staff is spread thin and more costly outside services are required for the upkeep of the buildings. The new Lynch Elementary School has come online and instantly became a jewel in the Town's portfolio of assets, drawing many programs and community groups to vie for time during the after-school hours and non-school days.

- Parkhurst **-** transitioned from swing space back to a state that is ready to receive its next role to serve the community.
- Muraco School – performed a large upgrade project with only a short period of time to plan and execute. This involved asbestos abatement, painting, and new flooring in all classrooms. Change of special use to create a new Cafeteria and Library.
- McCall and Ambrose School **–** roof repairs and replacements.
- Mystic School Building- partial heating system equipment and controls replacement project, select window replacements and flooring work.
- DPW **– o**ffice upgrades.

STATISTICS

Maintenance of 1,105,953 square feet of public buildings.

DPW Garage

Program Description
The Garage maintains over 120 vehicles and/or equipment in the D.P.W fleet, police cruisers, and Town vehicles in other departments. In addition, the Garage is responsible for maintaining the mechanical equipment at the Transfer Station.

FY2027 Initiatives
- Continue to work with operators to achieve optimum maintenance on machines, i.e., greasing
- and cleaning vehicles for increased longevity.
- Continue to maintain Transfer Station conveyer belt.
- Continue to keep mechanics up to date with diagnostic tools and training.
- Continue to replace outdated equipment with new equipment when needed.
- Continue to integrate new personnel in the Garage

FY2026 Accomplishments
- Added two new Snow Fighter Peterbilt trucks to the Snow and Ice fleet
- Added new Vactor Truck to the Water Department fleet
- Added new equipment trailer to the Water Department.
- Two new F-550 Dump trucks added to the fleet.

Statistics

	Vehicles	Construction Equipment
DPW	13	68
Water/Sewer	11	14
Police	21	
Board of Health	1	
Engineering	1	
Building Inspection	1	

DPW Transfer Station

Program Description

The primary purpose of this program is to provide the most economical and convenient way to dispose of trash and to recycle items to secondary markets. Recycling results in savings by reducing the amount of material requiring incineration. The Transfer Station, located off Swanton Street, receives refuse from commercial haulers, local businesses, residents and landscapers. There are three components to the operation: operating the refuse collection building and hauling refuse to Win Waste Innovations in North Andover as of recycling waste ban items as well as supervising the swap shop area, clothing and book collection areas; and managing the yard waste and composting areas producing marketable wood chips and screened or unscreened compost.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue construction of aerobic digester.
- Improve recycling area with grant funding.
- Continue to improve preventative maintenance practices for both waste and recycling compactors.
- Continue spring opening of the swap shop to further divert tons from the waste stream.
- Explore opportunities for grant-funded equipment.
- Investigate ways to increase revenue to keep costs down at the transfer station.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Procured a trommel screen through a combination of Town appropriation and State earmark.
- Continued work with new trommel screen to produce high-quality loam and bark/mulch for the residents.
- Improved area around asphalt, brick and concrete bin to better conform with storm water regulations.
- Received State grant for food waste recycling.
- Constructed the food waste recycling building.

Statistics

	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	FY 2025
Recycle Tonnage	1,219	1,094	1,103	1,431
Yard Waste Tonnage	736	947	914	680
Wood Chips Yards	1,900	2,300	2,225	2,100
Solid Waste Tonnage	9,354	8,699	8,479	8,672

DPW Cemetery

Program Description

Wildwood Cemetery is a municipal cemetery owned by the Town located off Palmer Street. The cemetery is managed and operated by the Department of Public Works. A five-member Cemetery Advisory Committee advises the Board of Selectmen on policy matters relating to the operation and development of the facility. Wildwood Cemetery was conceived and artistically designed as a "rural garden cemetery" for the benefit of Winchester Citizens.

FY 2027 Initiatives

- Get approval from Capital for proposed cremation garden at Winter Pond. Use bid documents and existing plans generated by Grever and Ward to get cost estimates.
- Continue to do more tree pruning with remaining Capital Funds.
- Continue to make building improvements.
- Expand new headstone burial area off of Emerson Ave. to accommodate more double deep graves.
- Finalize new Rules and Regulations revised by the Cemetery Advisory Committee and get Select Board approval.

FY 2026 Accomplishments

- Grever and Ward designed a plan for the new cremation garden.
- Northeast Tree removed 21 trees as the low qualified bidder in the Spring of 2025.
- Installed new concrete walkway entrance to cemetery office by DPW Staff.
- Repaired more sofit to front of garage entrance.
- Finished signage project installing 110 Victorian pathway signs and installed 38 refinished Victorian street signs and posts and 12 new street signs
- Purchased new JCB backhoe.
- Dug and poured 50 foundation orders.
- Better Grounds hired to replace Groundmasters to do the grounds maintenance.

Statistics

	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Interments	150	170	139	145
Sites Purchased	68	73	54	51
Total Income	$358,005	$391,200	$302,215	$312,574

DPW Snow & Ice

Program Description

The function of this program is to maintain roads, streets and sidewalks during snow and ice season and to provide a safe traveling environment for residents and visitors of Winchester. The Snow and Ice budget covers the overtime cost as well as the cost of supplies and materials and equipment repair and rental associated with the removal of snow and ice from the Town's streets and sidewalks.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Continue to maintain improved response time during icing conditions.
- Continue evaluation of routes and resources to appropriately service all routes.
- Continue to maintain safe roadways for general public and safety vehicles.
- Continue to replace outdated equipment with new equipment.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Maintained roads, sidewalks and school grounds during winter that produced 33 inches of snow.
- The DPW performed seven full-scale operations and 14 salter vehicle-only events and 22 school parking lot salting events.

Statistics

	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Plowable Storms	2	4	4	7
Snowfall (inches)	46.5	23	16	33
Road Salt (tons)	3,141	2,460	2,144	3,500
Road Sand (tons)	10	10	10	10
Sand & Salt Incidents	14	9	8	14

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS		FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
51101	PERMANENT	3,535,349	3,604,673	3,622,609	3,707,229	3,707,229	0
51113	CUSTODIANS	1,746,296	1,556,193	1,852,074	1,906,122	1,906,122	0
51155	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - UNION	500	0	500	500	500	0
51160	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - DPW	26,475	29,925	26,475	26,475	26,475	0
51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	20,200	2,175	20,200	20,200	20,200	0
51251	TEMPORARY	30,000	22,752	30,000	30,000	30,000	0
51359	OVERTIME	546,370	587,063	546,369	546,369	546,369	0
51365	OFF DUTY	0	0	0	0	0	0
51901	CLOTHING/BOOT ALLOWANCE	12,450	13,100	12,450	12,700	12,700	0
	PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**5,917,640**	**5,815,881**	**6,110,677**	**6,249,595**	**6,249,595**	**0**
52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	2,400	2,275	2,400	2,400	2,400	0
52103	PRINTING AND REPRODUC SUPPLI	300	0	300	300	300	0
52112	FLAGS	750	0	750	750	750	0
52113	CLEANING SUPPLIES	3,000	3,967	3,000	3,000	3,000	0
52114	CUST SUP N CONS	155,000	231,773	175,000	205,000	205,000	0
52116	ELECTRICAL SUPPLIES	32,643	15,088	32,643	32,643	32,643	0
52123	HARDWARE	15,080	17,938	20,080	20,080	20,080	0
52124	WELDING SUPPLIES	5,000	5,756	5,000	5,000	5,000	0
52125	PAINTING SUPPLIES	8,600	116	8,600	8,600	8,600	0
52126	ATHLETIC RECREATIONAL	3,500	1,470	3,500	3,500	3,500	0
52127	PLUMBING, HEATING & VENTILAT	10,000	782	10,000	10,000	10,000	0
52128	BITUMINOUS PRODUCTS	22,000	23,619	22,000	22,000	22,000	0
52129	MASONRY SUPPLIES	2,000	0	2,000	2,000	2,000	0
52130	SAND, GRAVEL & LOAM	6,500	4,160	6,500	6,500	6,500	0
52131	STONE	500	0	500	500	500	0
52133	READY MIX CONCRETE	9,200	3,322	9,200	9,200	9,200	0
52134	LUMBER AND WOOD PRODUCTS	3,550	2,157	3,550	3,550	3,550	0
52135	IRON CASTINGS	7,500	0	750	750	750	0
52136	AGRICULTURE AND HORTICULTURE	40,500	27,774	40,500	40,500	40,500	0
52137	SUPPLIES, SMALL EQUIPMENT	18,100	15,543	18,100	18,100	18,100	0
52138	SUPPLIES, AUTOMOTIVE	101,600	114,334	100,100	100,100	100,100	0
52142	TIRES, TUBES & CHAINS	20,000	21,292	20,000	20,000	20,000	0
52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	8,000	8,476	8,000	8,000	8,000	0
52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	0	1,188	0	0	0	0
52152	PIPE & FITTINGS	3,500	1,713	5,950	5,950	5,950	0
52176	RECREATIONAL SUPPLIES	4,500	745	4,500	4,500	4,500	0
52181	PUBLIC SAFETY SUPPLY	15,500	14,171	15,500	15,500	15,500	0
52184	CLOTHING & UNIFORMS	25,150	15,472	25,500	25,500	25,500	0
52186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	53,650	50,245	55,960	55,960	55,960	0
52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	5,000	7,278	5,000	5,000	5,000	0
53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	1,100	250	1,100	1,100	1,100	0
53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	5,800	2,439	5,600	5,600	5,600	0
53115	ADVERTISING	3,100	6,874	3,100	3,100	3,100	0
53116	BIND & BK REPAIRS	200	0	200	200	200	0
53118	PROF SERVICES	755,149	658,129	701,299	714,299	714,299	0
53122	TRAVEL - INSIDE MASS	300	0	300	300	300	0
53125	LANDSCAPING	700	0	700	700	700	0
53126	HIRED EQUIPMENT	52,750	56,399	52,750	52,750	52,750	0
53127	R & M AUTOMOTIVE	43,000	35,404	43,000	43,000	43,000	0
53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	8,700	2,783	8,700	8,700	8,700	0
53136	BEACH HOUSE/R&M BLDG & STR	0	0	0	0	0	0
53138	R&M BLDG & STRUCT	530,000	494,483	530,000	540,000	540,000	0
53140	HS/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	53,215	0	0	0	0
53141	LY/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	0	0	0	0	0
53142	MC/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	17,799	0	0	0	0
53143	AMBROSE/R&M BLDG & STRUC	0	18,377	0	0	0	0
53144	LI/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	12,729	0	0	0	0
53145	MU/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	5,624	0	0	0	0
53146	MY/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	11,102	0	0	0	0
53148	VO/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	20,888	0	0	0	0

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
	53164	RECYCLING SERVICES	384,000	378,344	385,000	385,000	385,000	0
	53165	SOLID WASTE DISPOSAL	911,700	795,544	929,430	971,190	971,190	0
	53166	TUITION	3,300	0	3,300	3,300	3,300	0
	53172	CONTRACTUAL SERVICE	116,500	110,724	119,530	119,530	119,530	0
	53218	PUBLIC SAFETY/R&M BLDG & STR	0	2,242	0	0	0	0
	53219	DPW/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	10,393	0	0	0	0
	53220	TOWN HALL/R&M BLDG & STRUCT	0	7,880	0	0	0	0
	53234	LIB/R&M BLDG & STR	0	0	0	0	0	0
	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	88,208	81,862	89,678	89,678	89,678	0
	53240	PH/R&M BLDG & STR	0	20,141	0	0	0	0
	53242	TRTMT PLT/R&M BLDG & STR	0	186	0	0	0	0
	53243	TS&DP/R&M BLDG & STR	0	280	0	0	0	0
	53244	CEM/R&M BLDG & STR	0	12,876	0	0	0	0
	53245	WESTSIDE/R&M BLDG & STR	0	16	0	0	0	0
	53251	CONS LANDSCAPING/MILL POND	10,000	9,520	10,000	10,000	10,000	0
	53252	R&M PLAYGROUND	47,000	4,748	47,000	47,000	47,000	0
	53303	LICENSE REIMBURSEMENT	2,900	3,386	2,900	2,900	2,900	0
	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	1,600	814	1,600	1,600	1,600	0
	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	900	166	900	900	900	0
	54126	CURRENT CHARGES	341	340	341	341	341	0
	55104	COMMUNICATIONS	1,800	1,848	1,800	1,800	1,800	0
	57010	POLICE DETAIL SERVICES	20,000	29,887	20,000	20,000	20,000	0
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**3,572,071**	**3,458,343**	**3,563,111**	**3,657,871**	**3,657,871**	**0**
	55111	LANDSCAPING EQUIPMENT	0	0	19,500	19,500	19,500	0
		EQUIPMENT TOTAL	**0**	**0**	**19,500**	**19,500**	**19,500**	**0**
		DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS TOTAL	**9,489,711**	**9,274,224**	**9,693,288**	**9,926,966**	**9,926,966**	**0**

SNOW AND ICE			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0141711	51359	OVERTIME	310,288	310,288	223,300	223,300	223,300	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**310,288**	**310,288**	**223,300**	**223,300**	**223,300**	**0**
0141712	52123	HARDWARE	1,000	1,338	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0141712	52125	PAINTING SUPPLIES	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
0141712	52130	SAND, GRAVEL & LOAM	16,000	0	16,000	16,000	16,000	
0141712	52138	SUPPLIES, AUTOMOBILE	25,000	71,620	25,000	25,000	25,000	
0141712	52142	TIRES, TUBES & CHAINS	10,000	3,709	10,000	10,000	10,000	
0141712	52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	500	2,080	500	500	500	
0141712	52153	CHEMICALS	347,453	240,728	125,000	125,000	125,000	
0141712	52186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	2,000	6,107	2,000	2,000	2,000	
0141712	53118	PROF SERVICES	1,500	19,761	1,500	1,500	1,500	
0141712	53126	HIRED EQUIPMENT	68,700	121,503	68,700	68,700	68,700	
0141712	53127	R & M AUTOMOTIVE	1,000	5,448	1,000	1,000	1,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**474,153**	**472,294**	**251,700**	**251,700**	**251,700**	**0**
0141713	55111	LANDSCAPING EQUIPMENT	12,698	12,698	25,000	25,000	25,000	
		TOTAL CAPITAL	**12,698**	**12,698**	**25,000**	**25,000**	**25,000**	**0**
		SNOW AND ICE TOTAL	**797,139**	**795,280**	**500,000**	**500,000**	**500,000**	**0**

SECTION VIII

Service Programs – Education (3100)

WINCHESTER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

INCLUSION • SERVICE • INNOVATION

Dr. Frank Hackett, Superintendent of Schools

TO: Christopher Senior, Town Manager

RE: FY27 School Committee Adopted Budget & Next Steps

February 12, 2025

On behalf of the Winchester School Committee, I am pleased to submit the Winchester Public Schools FY27 Budget of $76,270,570, an increase of $5,854,852, or 8.31%, over the FY26 budget. Following a Public Hearing on February 5, 2026, the School Committee unanimously approved this funding level, assuming 5% level services plus $2.3M in strategic additions and essential needs. This budget assumes passage of the operating override vote on March 21, 2026. If the override does not pass, the Committee discussed several potential scenarios, which are presented below.

Background & Budget Development

The FY27 School Committee Budget reflects more than a year of community engagement and strategic planning. During the 2024–2025 school year, we gathered input from nearly 1,000 district families, staff members, and community stakeholders through surveys, public forums, and sessions with Town Meeting Members at all precincts. This feedback provided valuable insight into community priorities, concerns about student achievement and support services, and expectations for Winchester Public Schools' future.

Building from this foundation, the School Committee used its summer 2025 workshops to finalize the strategic priorities at the core of our WPS 2030 strategic plan: strengthening tiered support resources and systems, expanding access to high school courses, completing our literacy implementation, and maintaining comprehensive student services. These efforts were integrated into the Select Board's
State-of-the-Town (SOTT) committee work, which began in parallel over the summer. This collaboration among the School Committee, Select Board, Finance Committee, and other boards and community volunteers provided additional feedback from key stakeholders, resulting in a proposed multi-year funding plan aligned with the WPS 2030 vision.

The budget presented here reflects not only careful financial analysis but also the collective voice of our community and the shared vision articulated through WPS 2030 & SOTT, ensuring that our investments support long-term student success and community goals through the end of this decade.

Budget Framework and Funding Scenarios
The FY27 budget requires multiple scenarios given the upcoming override vote, which is critical to maintaining educational quality, as discussed in SOTT and during budget development. The following outlines the key budget levels we have developed in partnership with the SOTT:

School Committee Adopted Budget (Override Passes):
The override budget (*Table 1*) enables critical investments that have been deferred for years due to budget constraints. These include:

- Full implementation of a new evidence-based literacy curriculum, which will be selected this March from among two programs currently being piloted, with the cost of program materials requested in a separate article (see page 6 below);
- Implementation of a Multi-Tiered-Student Support system (MTSS), inclusive of a progress monitoring and data platform;
- Hiring dedicated elementary mathematics intervention staffing to assist struggling students and provide Tier II supports.
- Expanded course sections at the middle and high school levels to address persistent access issues due to student scheduling conflicts and limited section availability in both core and elective classes;
- Preservation of athletics, arts, and co-curricular activities without significant fee increases;
- Expanded services for students with special needs, including adaptive physical education.

Table 1

SCHOOL COMMITTEE ADOPTED BUDGET (OVERRIDE)		
	FY26 Budget	**FY27 Budget**
Total Personnel	62,024,532	67,205,687
Total Other Expenses	8,391,186	9,064,883
Total Budget	**70,415,718**	**76,270,570**
FY26 to FY27 %Δ		*8.31%*

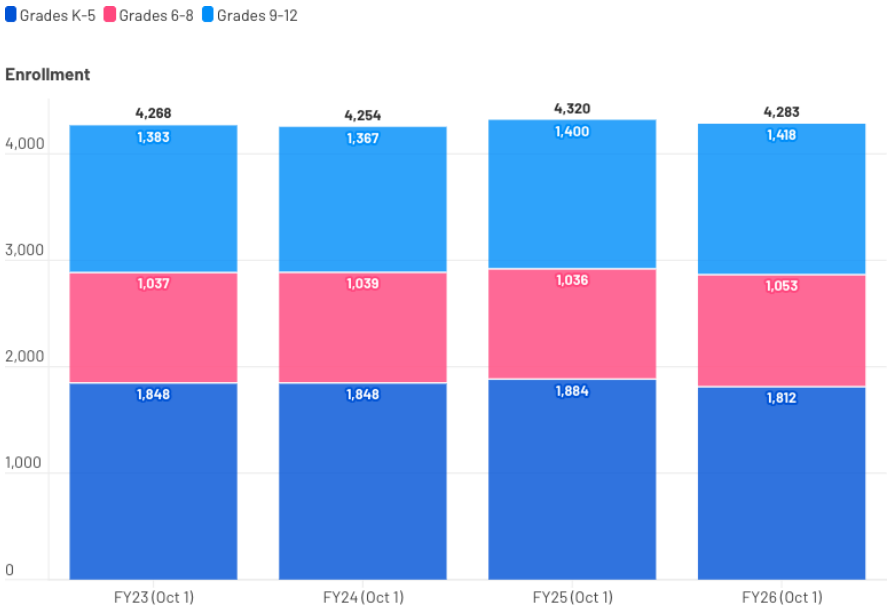
Level Services Budget (6.8%):
This represents the true cost of maintaining current educational programs and services in FY27, developed through a comprehensive bottom-up budget process. Beginning in fall 2025, our business office worked closely with school principals and department directors to review every budget line and cost driver. This process included adjustments for:

- Contractual salary obligations (steps and COLA) for all union and non-union personnel (as of the date of this memo, two units of the WEA are still in negotiations);
- Projected special education tuition, transportation, and paraprofessional costs;
- School-based instructional and programmatic expenditures;
- Unanticipated and unbudgeted expenses related to special education services and transportation that occurred after Town Meeting approval of the FY26 budget that must be carried into FY27;
- Enrollment-driven reductions (Chart 1);
- Estimated replacement costs for retiring staff whose positions are needed for the 2026-2027 school year.

Table 2

WPS LEVEL SERVICES		
FY26 Budget		**FY27 Budget**
Total Budget	**70,415,718**	**75,206,504**
FY26 to FY27 %Δ		*6.80%*
Cumulative Reduction from School Committee Adopted Budget (Override)		***(1,064,066)***

Chart 1 - WPS Enrollment by Grade Span (K-12)



5% Foundational Budget:
Consistent with the SOTT's long-range financial model, as discussed with the Select Board and Finance Committee, WPS developed a 5% foundational budget (Table 3) as the FY27 override baseline.
Reaching this level requires approximately **$1.2 million in reductions** from Level Services. A range of reductions was presented to the School Committee during their budget hearing to meet this threshold. Although not finalized, reductions could include various combinations of the following, based on further discussions by the school committee:

- Eliminating (across all classifications) approximately 12–16 FTE positions
- Reduction in co/extracurricular activities and athletics - along with increases in fees
- Increased class sizes approaching and potentially exceeding contractual guidelines
- Reduction in Tier II support personnel
- No course expansions at the middle and high school levels
- Increase transportation fees and/or reduce services

Table 3

SOTT 5% Model - Foundational Budget		
	FY26 Budget	**FY27 Budget**
Total Budget	**70,415,718**	**73,936,504**
FY26 to FY27 %Δ		*5.00%*
Cumulative Reduction from School Committee Adopted Budget (Override)		**(2,334,066)**

No-Override Scenario (3.81%):
If the override does not pass and the district is limited to 3.81% growth (assuming $4M in town-wide free cash allocation pro rata), we would need to cut an additional **~$838,000** beyond the 5% foundational reductions.

This budget scenario (*Table 4*) would place the district at significant risk of failing to meet federal and state legal obligations and contractual requirements under our collective bargaining agreements, potentially leading to legal and operational challenges. This underscores the critical need for support to mitigate these risks.

Cumulatively, this scenario would result in approximately 25–30 FTE reductions. Beyond the noted range of reductions in the above 5% foundational budget scenario, this budget would not provide sufficient funding to fully implement a new literacy curriculum and could potentially delay the MSBA Muraco project timeline.

Table 4

No-Override Scenario (3.81% Model)		
	FY26 Budget	**FY27 Budget**
Total Budget	**70,415,718**	**73,098,557**
FY26 to FY27 %Δ		*3.81%*
Cumulative Reduction from School Committee Adopted Budget (Override)		**(3,172,013)**

One-Time and Capital Needs

Consistent with guidance from the SOTT, we have identified one-time needs that will be addressed through separate future articles at Town Meeting rather than built into the operating budget:

- FY27 - Spring Town Meeting
  - $878,260 for Literacy Program Implementation costs (*materials, consumables, professional development*)
- Future Town Meetings
  - $250,000 (FY29) and $400,000 (FY30) are projected, respectively, for a mathematics program pilot and implementation costs
  - $1.5M to $1.8M Muraco Elementary School feasibility study (*capital project, eligible for borrowing and reimbursement through the MSBA*)

We will work with your office to present these items appropriately at Town Meeting.

WPS 2030

Separate "One-Time" Funding Articles

	FY27		FY29	FY30
	Town Meeting (Spring 2026)	*Town Meeting (Spring or Fall 2026)*	*Town Meeting (Spring 2028)*	*Town Meeting (Spring 2029)*
Article	**LITERACY** • Professional Development • Curriculum Costs • Curriculum Materials	**MURACO FEASIBILITY** • Potential for feasibility study for renovation or replacement of Muraco Elementary School	**MATHEMATICS** • FY29 Pilot	**MATHEMATICS** • Professional Development • Curriculum Costs • Curriculum Materials
Total Estimated Article	**878,260**	**1,500,000 to 1,800,000**	**250,000**	**400,000**

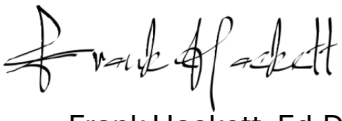
**Costs are estimates + priorities are subject to change*

Next Steps and Community Engagement
Over the coming weeks, we will:

- Continue public budget presentations to the School Committee and the Town's Finance Committee
- Provide detailed backup materials and respond to questions from the community
- Engage the community through public forums, website resources, and school communications
- Assist in any coordination messaging needs with the Town Manager's office regarding the override

Closing
The School Committee strongly believes that the $76,270,570 override budget is essential for Winchester students' educational success and aligns with our community's shared commitment to high-quality public education. This support is crucial for the district's future, and the partnership and goals developed through the SOTT process reinforce our collective purpose.
Please let me know if you need any additional information or analysis. We remain available to support your work with the Select Board and Finance Committee as you finalize the Town's FY27 budget.

Respectfully,



Frank Hackett, Ed.D
Superintendent of
Schools

cc: Karen Bolognese, School Committee Chair
Andrew Marron, Director of Finance and Operations

SECTION X

Undistributed

Capital Appropriations

Non-Appropriated

Energy (1910)

Contributory Retirement (9110)

Workers Compensation (9120)

Unemployment Compensation (9130)

Health Insurance (9140)

Medicare Tax (9150)

Reserve Fund (9430)

General Insurance (9450)

Environmental Remediation (9460)

ENERGY

The Energy budget is a consolidated account that funds all energy cost for municipal and school departments. It includes the cost of heating oil, natural gas, and electricity, as well as gasoline and diesel fuel for Town vehicles.

The Energy Management Committee (EMC), formed in 2006, has worked with town boards and departments to implement energy saving measures. EMC initiatives have resulted in over $7 million in avoided costs cumulative since the Committee's inception. The Town has also created an Energy Revolving Fund to provide financial support for energy conservation projects along with utility incentives and grant funding. Additionally, Winchester is a member of the Green Community program, and as a Green Community we successfully reduced our energy use by our goal is to save an additional 20% in energy usage. In the past, solar arrays have been installed on the roofs of the Vinson-Owen School, DPW, and Winchester High School and recently Lynch Elementary School to reduce our energy expenses at these locations.

During FY26, the following energy projects will be on-going or completed:

- Mystic School window replacement was completed which was funded in part through a grant from the Massachusetts Department of Energy Resources (DOER) and the Energy Revolving Fund.

The new Lynch Elementary School opened in September 2025. The building is all electric and equipped with roof and ground-mounted solar panels to achieve Net Zero status. Since operating costs for the new building are currently unknown, and the onsite solar arrays are not yet in operation, staff has assumed $180,000 in energy costs for the Lynch School in FY26 (costs should drop below $100,000 in FY27 thanks to energy produced by the solar arrays).

		ENERGY	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0119102	52193	GASOLINE - HIGHWAYS & STREET	109,185	115,096	111,600	110,700	110,700	
0119102	52197	FUEL OIL - WESTSIDE STATION	5,110	4,920	5,058	4,454	4,454	
0119102	52199	FUEL OIL - AUX	2,290	1,027	1,765	1,048	1,048	
0119102	52205	FUEL OIL - LYNCH SCHOOL	0	0	0	0	0	
0119102	52208	DIESEL - DPW	91,997	92,295	96,000	98,560	98,560	
0119102	52210	FUEL OIL - CEMETERY	3,531	4,150	3,235	8,672	8,672	
0119102	52211	FUEL OIL - DOG POUND	1,895	2,512	1,724	1,991	1,991	
0119102	52223	FUEL OIL - 160 FOREST ST	1,955	2,084	1,895	1,638	1,638	
0119102	53111	LIGHT/POWER - WRIGHT/LOCKE	0	0	0	0	0	
0119102	53112	LIGHT/PWR TWN BLDS	0	48,000	0	0	0	
0119102	53118	PROF SERVICES	35,000	34,119	35,000	35,000	35,000	
0119102	53179	LIGHT/POWER - LIBRARY	54,858	43,153	55,900	50,000	50,000	
0119102	53180	LIGHT/POWER - WEST SIDE STAT	5,387	4,629	7,358	4,721	4,721	
0119102	53181	LIGHT/POWER - PUBLIC SAFE BL	58,554	46,736	59,630	47,671	47,671	
0119102	53182	LIGHT/POWER - AUX	2,060	989	1,930	1,159	1,159	
0119102	53183	LIGHT/POWER - TRANSER STATIO	29,385	46,513	27,500	47,443	47,443	
0119102	53184	LIGHT/POWER - GROUNDS	15,770	7,923	14,000	10,650	10,650	
0119102	53185	LIGHT/POWER - DPW COMPLEX	31,806	23,915	38,020	24,393	24,393	
0119102	53186	LIGHT/POWER - STREET LIGHTS	51,519	42,718	52,940	43,572	43,572	
0119102	53187	LIGHT/POWER - HIGH SCHOOL	395,781	381,311	411,779	388,937	388,937	
0119102	53188	LIGHT/POWER - MCCALL SCHOOL	211,052	199,383	220,449	203,371	203,371	
0119102	53189	LIGHT/POWER - AMBROSE SCHOOL	82,422	44,345	84,210	56,000	56,000	
0119102	53190	LIGHT/POWER - LINCOLN SCHOOL	87,087	75,761	92,511	78,296	78,296	
0119102	53191	LIGHT/POWER - LYNCH SCHOOL	12,000	45,505	80,000	185,000	75,000	
0119102	53192	LIGHT/POWER - MURACO SCHOOL	31,355	64,248	55,851	65,533	65,533	
0119102	53193	LIGHT/POWER - VINSON OWEN	85,565	81,477	91,204	83,106	83,106	
0119102	53194	LIGHT/POWER - STREET DRAINS	4,600	3,981	4,900	4,505	4,505	
0119102	53195	LIGHT/POWER - TRAFFIC LIGHTS	14,173	42,129	15,000	42,971	42,971	
0119102	53196	LIGHT/POWER - SCALE HOUSE	1,500	0	1,500	1,800	1,800	
0119102	53197	LIGHT/POWER - CEMETERY	2,021	1,592	2,062	1,624	1,624	
0119102	53198	LIGHT/POWER - MYSTIC	9,941	10,264	11,480	7,548	7,548	
0119102	53199	LIGHT/POWER - SANBORN HOUSE	144	120	150	150	150	
0119102	53200	LIGHT/POWER - TOWN HALL	55,775	64,191	59,580	65,796	65,796	
0119102	53201	LIGHT/POWER - WATERFIELD STA	1,170	364	1,230	500	500	
0119102	53202	LIGHT/POWER - WEDGEMERE STAT	4,800	3,850	2,740	3,947	3,947	
0119102	53203	LIGHT/POWER - PARK GARAGE	2,263	1,184	900	1,214	1,214	
0119102	53204	LIGHT/POWER - DOG POUND	1,200	538	600	600	600	
0119102	TBD	LIGHT/POWER WEDGE POND	0	0	0	6,000	6,000	
0119102	53205	NATURAL GAS - DPW COMPLEX	28,372	38,324	34,500	35,000	35,000	
0119102	53206	NATURAL GAS - PARK GARAGE	325	318	325	325	325	
0119102	53207	NATURAL GAS - MYSTIC	36,362	21,053	37,403	33,549	33,549	
0119102	53208	NATURAL GAS - LIBRARY BLDG	12,922	15,076	13,500	12,879	12,879	
0119102	53209	NATURAL GAS - TOWN HALL	17,040	18,883	18,000	18,000	18,000	
0119102	53210	NATURAL GAS - HIGH SCHOOL	69,580	69,273	72,000	69,642	69,642	
0119102	53211	NATURAL GAS - MCCALL SCHOOL	114,662	109,182	120,000	111,300	111,300	
0119102	53212	NATURAL GAS - AMBROSE SCHOOL	38,350	50,500	39,632	36,888	36,888	
0119102	53213	NATURAL GAS - LINCOLN SCHOOL	43,226	40,505	47,300	41,976	41,976	
0119102	53214	NATURAL GAS - LYNCH SCHOOL	0	0	0	0	0	
0119102	53215	NATURAL GAS - MURACO SCHOOL	47,514	54,933	51,600	55,650	55,650	
0119102	53216	NATURAL GAS - PUBLIC SAFETY	22,213	23,628	22,373	24,100	24,100	
0119102	53217	NATURAL GAS - 263 MAIN STREET	0	14,294	0	0	0	
0119102	53226	LIGHT/POWER - PARKHUST SCHOO	115,000	63,448	25,000	30,000	30,000	
0119102	53227	NATURAL GAS - VINSON-OWEN SC	30,360	35,276	32,207	35,985	35,985	
0119102	53228	LIGHT/POWER-SUSSEX/GROVE	135	135	150	135	135	
0119102	53229	NATURAL GAS - PARKHURST SCHO	40,825	38,910	36,000	34,026	34,026	
0119102	53231	LIGHT/POWER-SCHOOL ATHLETICS	27,408	13,971	25,000	25,500	25,500	
0119102	53235	LIGHT/POWER-MCDONALD FIELD	308	235	315	315	315	
0119102	53247	LIGHT/POWER-LARAWAY EV CHARGEF	2,008	0	2,500	2,500	2,500	
0119102	53248	LIGHT/POWER - 160 FOREST ST.	500	39	350	500	500	
0119102	53250	R&M ELECTRIC CHARGERS	6,000	4,900	6,000	6,000	6,000	
0119102	55104	COMMUNICATIONS	600	600	600	700	700	
		ENERGY TOTAL	**2,156,861**	**2,154,504**	**2,234,456**	**2,263,541**	**2,153,541**	

PERSONNEL BENEFITS

The Personnel Benefits budget includes the cost of benefits associated with municipal and School Department employees. This category includes pensions (Contributory and Noncontributory), Workers Compensation, unemployment Compensation, Federal Insurance Contributions Act (FICA) and Medicare tax, and health insurance. Additional information regarding each category is provided below.

Contributory Retirement

The Winchester Contributory Retirement Board (the Board) was established in accordance with Massachusetts General Law Chapter 32 Retirement Systems and Pensions. The Board is made up of the Comptroller (ex-officio), an appointee of the Select Board, two representatives elected by the employees and retirees in the Winchester Contributory Retirement System (WCRS), and a member who is not an employee, a retiree or Town official, chosen by the other four Board members. The Board administers the statewide retirement program for all municipal employees and certain education employees. There are currently 304 retirees (including beneficiaries and survivors) in the WCRS.

The annual required payment into the WCRS is determined by the funding schedule prepared as part of an actuarial valuation performed by the Commonwealth of Massachusetts' Public Employee Retirement Administration Commission. The most recent actuarial valuation as of January 1, 2025 assumes an unfunded liability of $9,684,507. The Town's FY27 appropriation is $7,822,682 and in FY28 the Town plans to pay off the final amortization of the unfunded liability. This was extended from FY27 to FY28 due to the Board and Town Meeting approving a Cost of Living base increase from $14,000 to $16,000 in FY26, effective July 1, 2026.

CONTRIBUTORY RETIREMENT			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0191102	54117	PAYMENTS TO MUNICIPALITIES	7,098,270	7,098,270	7,462,210	7,822,682	7,822,682	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**7,098,270**	**7,098,270**	**7,462,210**	**7,822,682**	**7,822,682**	**0**
		CONTRIBUTORY RETIREMENT TOTAL	**7,098,270**	**7,098,270**	**7,462,210**	**7,822,682**	**7,822,682**	**0**

Worker's Compensation/Police & Fire Injured on Duty (IOD)

The Town self-insures its Worker's Compensation and Police/Fire IOD liability. The Worker's Compensation/IOD budget supports pay-as-you-go claim payments made in accordance with Massachusetts General Law (MGL) Chapter 152 as well as MGL Chapter 111f (medical costs only) which include the following:

- Administration costs for third party claims administration;
- Legal costs associated with claims requiring legal advice and representation;
- Salaries for job related time loss (except for Police & Fire whose full salaries are paid out of their respective departmental budget); and
- Medical and other costs related injuries sustained on the job.

WORKERS COMPENSATION			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0191202	53118	PROFESSIONAL SERVICES	21,000	20,952	25,000	25,000	25,000	
0191202	54200	W/C - INDEM/MEDICAL/OTHER	164,000	215,223	225,000	225,000	225,000	
0191202	54201	IOD - MEDICAL & OTHER	45,000	86,196	60,000	110,000	110,000	
0191202	54202	P/F RETIREE - MEDICAL & OTHER	120,000	0	80,000	80,000	80,000	
0191202	54106	INSURANCE/SURETY	0	0	0	100,000	0	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**350,000**	**322,371**	**390,000**	**540,000**	**440,000**	**0**
		WORKERS COMPENSATION TOTAL	**350,000**	**322,371**	**390,000**	**540,000**	**440,000**	**0**

Unemployment Compensation

In 1976, unemployment compensation was extended by the Federal Government to State and local government workers. On January 1, 1978, government units in Massachusetts became liable for the costs of these benefits. Unlike private employers, public employers can choose between two methods of payment (participation) of unemployment compensation costs: either through a "tax" of 1% of gross payroll (which could increase in future years) or reimbursement of actual costs. Winchester has chosen to follow the reimbursement method. As a result, the Town is billed each month by the Department of Unemployment Assistance for any claims attributable to the Town.

UNEMPLOYMENT			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0191302	53118	PROFESSIONAL SERVICES	2,000	2,000	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0191302	54117	PAYMENTS TO MUNICIPALITIES	88,000	82,715	95,000	95,000	95,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**90,000**	**84,715**	**100,000**	**100,000**	**100,000**	**0**
		UNEMPLOYMENT TOTAL	**90,000**	**84,715**	**100,000**	**100,000**	**100,000**	**0**

Health Insurance

Effective July 1, 2022, the Town changed health insurance providers from Harvard Pilgrim Healthcare (HPHC) to Blue Cross/Blue Shield (BCBS) offered through the Massachusetts Interlocal Insurance Agency (MIIA). This change was finalized after the FY23 budget was approved at Spring 2022 Town Meeting, so the FY23 budget carried the higher premium costs assuming a renewal with HPHC. The change in health insurance programs resulted in the turnback of $1,212,230.42 in the FY23 health insurance budget, which closed to Free Cash on June 30, 2023.

For FY25, the Town implemented several measures to reduce our active employee renewal rate from 8.25% to 5.25%. These included implementation of a Medicare Buy-in program for approximately 25 existing retirees over age 65 who were on the Town's HMP and PPO plans and a switch of dental providers to MIIA/BCBS.

Discussions for the FY26 health insurance budget began in October 2024. At that time the Town was notified of significant increases to the retiree Medicare supplemental plans, which renew on January 1st, and to expect a 10% rate increase on our active employee renewals effective July 1, 2025. Based on this guidance, senior management used the 10% renewal number for the purposes of preliminary budget discussions. On February 3rd, the Town learned that our actual proposed FY26 renewal rate was significantly higher at 18.92%,

resulting in an overall health insurance budget increase of 20.1% over FY25. Staff are working with our health insurance consultant to evaluate ways to reduce this impact; however, no changes will be in place by the deadline for submission of the Town Manager's budget on February 15th. Staff will work with the Finance Committee over the coming months to convey any budget adjustments ahead of Spring Town Meeting.

		HEALTH INSURANCE	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0191402	52179	HRA - NON-UNION	10,000	650	5,000	5,000	5,000	
0191402	53118	PROFESSIONAL SERVICES	25,000	19,895	25,000	25,000	25,000	
0191402	541092	HEALTH INSURANCE/TOWN-ACTIVE	3,741,619	3,336,421	3,927,176	4,491,018	4,467,587	
0191402	541093	HEALTH INSURANCE/TOWN-RETIREES	1,273,946	1,277,814	1,478,565	1,719,566	1,716,555	
0191402	541094	HEALTH INSURANCE/SCHOOL-ACTIVE	6,411,332	6,765,594	7,928,971	9,318,650	9,270,031	
0191402	541095	HEALTH INSURANCE/SCHOOL-RETIREES	1,736,433	1,742,616	1,963,853	2,385,872	2,382,420	
0191402	54111	GROUP INSURANCE PREMIUM/LIFE	30,000	25,354	30,000	30,000	30,000	
0191402	54126	MEDICARE PENALTIES	155,000	22,414	27,200	26,000	26,000	
0191402	54131	MEDICARE PART B REIMBURSEMENTS	645,220	622,552	683,951	771,626	771,626	
0191402	54134	CMS BUY-IN TOWN RETIREES	0	45,586	46,000	45,000	45,000	
0191402	54135	CMS BUY-IN SCHOOL RETIREES	0	114,865	115,000	117,000	117,000	
0191402	58104	IRS PCORI & OTHER FEES	17,000	2,151	10,000	10,000	10,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**14,045,550**	**13,975,912**	**16,240,716**	**18,944,732**	**18,866,219**	**0**
		HEALTH INSURANCE TOTAL	**14,045,550**	**13,975,912**	**16,240,716**	**18,944,732**	**18,866,219**	**0**

FICA & Medicare Tax

The Town is required to match the 1.45% Federal Medicare premium paid by Town employees.

		MEDICARE	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0191502	54109	GROUP INSURANCE PREMIUM	1,254,250	1,248,921	1,306,463	1,550,000	1,500,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**1,254,250**	**1,248,921**	**1,306,463**	**1,550,000**	**1,500,000**	**0**
		MEDICARE TOTAL	**1,254,250**	**1,248,921**	**1,306,463**	**1,550,000**	**1,500,000**	**0**

MISCELLANEOUS

Reserve Fund

The Reserve Fund is, in effect, a contingency fund under the jurisdiction of the Finance Committee to provide for extraordinary and unforeseen expenses of various Town departments during the fiscal year. Direct expenditures from this Fund are not made; rather, transfers are made to budgetary accounts. State law permits an appropriation of not more than 5% of the tax levy. For FY27, $400,000 is proposed to be allocated to the Reserve Fund, which is unchanged from the prior year.

General Insurance

Appropriations under this budget are for property, general liability, auto, public officials, law enforcement, school board, non-statutory employee bonding, flood insurance and numerous other types of policies. The Town contracts with a non-profit pool of municipalities managed by the Massachusetts Interlocal Insurance Association (MIIA) for most of its insurance plans.

GENERAL INSURANCE			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0194502	54106	INSURANCE/SURETY	693,000	605,103	765,000	850,000	810,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**693,000**	**605,103**	**765,000**	**850,000**	**810,000**	**0**
		GENERAL INSURANCE TOTAL	**693,000**	**605,103**	**765,000**	**850,000**	**810,000**	**0**

Environmental Remediation

This account covers the cost of environmental testing, professional services, and other environmental mitigation services as may be necessary and as mandated by the Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection (MassDEP).

ENVIRONMENTAL REMEDIATION SERVICES			FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
0194602	53118	PROFESSIONAL SERVICES	54,600	54,600	74,000	70,000	70,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**54,600**	**54,600**	**74,000**	**70,000**	**70,000**	**0**
		ENVIRONMENATL REMEDIATION TOTAL	**54,600**	**54,600**	**74,000**	**70,000**	**70,000**	**0**

CAPITAL FUND TRANSFERS

Capital and Building Stabilization Funds

Funds Pursuant to the Acts of 2002 Chapter 69 the Town established the Building and Capital Stabilization Funds. The Town approved the funding of these stabilization funds with a Proposition 2 ½ override (referendum vote). The original appropriation to establish the Building Stabilization Fund started at $1,850,000 and the original appropriation to establish the Capital Stabilization Fund started at $800,000. These were both increased in FY20 with an override of $400,000 and $1,600,000, respectively. The voters approved an additional $400,000 increase to the Capital Stabilization Fund in January 2023. This increase became becom effective July 1, 2023. Annual appropriations are increased by 2 ½ - percent annually.

NON-APPROPRIATED CHARGES

MBTA

The MBTA provides rapid transit and other mass transit services to 175 cities and towns including Winchester. Prior to the 1999 enactment of the reform package that overhauled the budgeting and assessment procedures for the MBTA (commonly referred to as “forward funding”), only 78 communities were assessed, totaling $145 million and increasing 2½% annually. For purposes of determining each community’s assessment, the expenses are broken down into two categories: Local and express service. Express service, which basically involves rapid transit service, is assessed 75% by the commuter count (the number of people who live in the town but work elsewhere), and 25% by the number of people boarding in the community. The boarding count is taken for a one-week period each spring. The local service is assessed 50% by the total deficit divided by the route miles in a community. The MBTA is required by law to notify the State Treasurer of the amount of the Net Assessable Cost of Service to be assessed to the municipalities within the district.

Registry of Motor Vehicles
Non-Renewal Surcharge If after proper notices, a motorist fails to pay a parking fine, motor vehicle excise tax, or a charge for abandonment of a motor vehicle, the Town notifies the Registrar of Motor Vehicles (RMV) not to renew the license and registration of that motorist. To cover the RMV's administrative costs of entering the necessary information into its computer system, the RMV assesses the Town a fee of $20 for each notification it receives. This fee, which comes through as a charge on the Cherry Sheet, is recovered by the Town by adding this amount and other penalties to the original fine print.

Metropolitan Area Planning Council
The Metropolitan Area Planning Council (MAPC) is a regional planning agency representing 101 cities and towns in the metropolitan Boston area. Created by an act of the Legislature in 1963, it serves as an independent public body of the Commonwealth with which state and local officials can address issues of regional importance. Air Pollution Control District General Laws Chapter 11, Section 142B, requires that communities be assessed for a portion of the costs incurred by the State Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) to monitor air pollution levels and enforce air quality standards at industrial, commercial, and institutional facilities. Expenditures made for such purposes are assessed against the metropolitan communities, one-half in proportion to the equalized valuations and one-half by the population of each community.

Cherry Sheet Offsets
Included in the estimated amount of aid to be received from the State are grant funds for the library. These funds are reserved for direct expenditure by the departments and are not considered to be general available revenues. Consequently, as part of the tax rate preparation process, whatever amount is included within the State aid estimates is also included in the non-appropriated expense section as offsetting debits. The Town receives one grant annually for the public library. Tax Levy Overlay State law requires that the Assessors put aside funds from each tax levy in a reserve that is called Overlay (also known as Allowance for Abatements). This account is established in anticipation that a certain percentage of the tax levy may end up being abated. Individual Undistributed IX-9 tax abatements are paid out of this fund. The amount of the overlay account, the final value of which is determined by the Assessors, is added to the tax rate without appropriation.

SECTION X

Funded Debt (7100 & 7120)

FUNDED DEBT

GENERAL FUND FY27 DEBT SERVICE BUDGET - SUMMARY BY FUNDING SOURCE			
Proposition 2½ Excluded (Tax Levy)	5,774,737.00	5,158,371.82	10,933,108.82
Estimates:			
GOB - Lynch School Construction	265,000.00	340,277.78	605,277.78
BAN - Lynch School Construction	-	299,166.67	299,166.67
BAN - Muraco Culvert	225,000.00	388,299.07	613,299.07
Subtotal Proposition 2½ Excluded (Tax Levy)	**6,264,737.00**	**6,186,115.34**	**12,450,852.34**
Building Stabilization Fund	**644,110.00**	**94,065.10**	**738,175.10**
Capital Stabilization Fund	**504,910.00**	**198,767.60**	**703,677.60**
General Fund (within Prop 2 1/2)	266,243.00	313,649.43	579,892.43
Estimates:			
BAN - Washington/Swanton Street Property	-	62,437.50	62,437.50
Subtotal General Fund (within Prop 2 1/2)	**266,243.00**	**376,086.93**	**642,329.93**
Total General Fund FY27 Debt Service Budget	**7,680,000.00**	**6,855,034.97**	**14,535,034.97**

GENERAL FUND FY27 DEBT SERVICE BUDGET - DETAIL BY FUNDING SOURCE

	Principal	Interest	Total
Prop 2 1/2 Excluded (Tax levy)			
July 1 2014 - Vinson-Owen School Construction (OE)	88,000.00	23,155.00	111,155.00
July 1 2015 - Vinson-Owen School Construction (E)	10,000.00	3,700.00	13,700.00
June 27, 2018 - Vinson-Owen School (OE)	10,000.00	8,912.50	18,912.50
January 27, 2022 - Cur Ref April 28, 2011 Vinson-Owen School (OE)	585,980.00	195,844.10	781,824.10
	693,980.00	231,611.60	925,591.60
July 1 2014 - High School Feasibility Study (OE)	42,000.00	11,051.25	53,051.25
July 1 2015 - High School Construction I (E)	150,000.00	98,587.50	248,587.50
July 1 2015 - High School Construction II (E)	930,000.00	660,137.50	1,590,137.50
July 1 2015 - High School Construction III (E)	1,015,000.00	760,550.00	1,775,550.00
October 27 2016 - High School Construction (OE)	570,000.00	509,993.76	1,079,993.76
June 24, 2021 High School (OE)	75,000.00	35,250.00	110,250.00
	2,782,000.00	2,075,570.01	4,857,570.01
October 29 2015 - WLF - Land Acquisition (IE)	168,757.00	57,166.43	225,923.43
June 27, 2018 - Aberjona River Culvert (IE)	215,000.00	185,525.00	400,525.00
June 27, 2018 - Skillings Field Construction & Remediation (OE)	130,000.00	110,931.26	240,931.26
June 27, 2018 - Skillings Field Design & Construction (IE)	160,000.00	44,640.00	204,640.00
June 27, 2018 - McCall Middle School Phase II (IE)	160,000.00	138,408.76	298,408.76
August 22, 2019 - McCall Middle School Phase II (IE)	180,000.00	123,368.76	303,368.76
	340,000.00	261,777.52	601,777.52
June 24, 2021 Muraco School Repairs (IE)	205,000.00	51,250.00	256,250.00
March 29, 2023 - Lynch School Feasibility Study (OE)	20,000.00	45,050.00	65,050.00
March 29, 2023 - Lynch Swing Space - Parkhurst School Planning (OE)	5,000.00	6,550.00	11,550.00
March 29, 2023 - Lynch Elementary School Construction (OE)	515,000.00	1,138,800.00	1,653,800.00
March 27, 2025 - Lynch Elementary School (OE)	540,000.00	949,500.00	1,489,500.00
	1,080,000.00	2,139,900.00	3,219,900.00
Subtotal before estimates	5,774,737.00	5,158,371.82	10,933,108.82
Estimates:			
GOB - Lynch School Construction ($10,000,000)	265,000.00	340,277.78	605,277.78
BAN - Lynch School Construction ($10,000,000)	-	299,166.67	299,166.67
BAN - Muraco Culvert ($9,734,517 - paydown required)	225,000.00	388,299.07	613,299.07
Total Prop 2 1/2 Excluded (Tax Levy)	**6,264,737.00**	**6,186,115.34**	**12,450,852.34**
Building Stabilization			
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 2008 McCall Middle Sch Design (I)	24,000.00	2,200.00	26,200.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 2008 McCall Middle Sch Addition(I)	253,650.00	38,142.50	291,792.50
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 2008 Building Remodel & Plans (I)	4,350.00	307.50	4,657.50
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 2008 Public Safety Buildoing (I)	65,000.00	8,250.00	73,250.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 08 Town Hall/Veterens Memorial (I)	90,000.00	12,250.00	102,250.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref May 1, 2009 Public Safety Building (I)	70,000.00	10,500.00	80,500.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref May 1, 2009 DPW Complex (I)	45,000.00	6,750.00	51,750.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref May 1, 2009 Fire Alarms/Corridor/ADA (I)	40,000.00	6,000.00	46,000.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref April 15, 2010 Muraco School HVAC (I)	-	-	-
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref April 15, 2010 DPW Repairs (I)	8,000.00	1,200.00	9,200.00
January 27, 2022 - Cur Ref April 28, 2011 Lynch School Roof Repairs (I)	44,110.00	8,465.10	52,575.10
Total Building Stabilization	**644,110.00**	**94,065.10**	**738,175.10**

Capital Stabilization Fund			
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 2008 Transfer Station/Landfill (O)	15,000.00	1,900.00	16,900.00
June 25, 2020 - Lake Street Bridge Replacement (I)	55,000.00	31,614.16	86,614.16
June 25, 2020 - Waterfield Road Bridge Replacement (I)	40,000.00	20,497.50	60,497.50
January 27, 2022 - Cur Ref April 28, 2011 Flood Mitigation (I)	174,910.00	36,690.80	211,600.80
March 29, 2023 - Transfer Station II-b (O)	170,000.00	-	170,000.00
March 27 2025 - Lake Street Bridge Replacement (I)	40,000.00	23,400.00	63,400.00
March 27 2025 - Additional Lake Street Bridge Replacement (I)	10,000.00	4,450.00	14,450.00
BAN issued 7/18/25:			
Lynch Elementary School Traffic Improvements	-	80,215.14	80,215.14
Total Capital Stabilization Fund	**504,910.00**	**198,767.60**	**703,677.60**
General Fund (within Prop 2 1/2)			
October 29 2015 - Land Acquisition (I)	1,243.00	421.07	1,664.07
June 27, 2018 - McCall Middle School Phase I (I)	35,000.00	31,510.00	66,510.00
June 27, 2018 - McCall Middle School Expansion (I)	5,000.00	2,247.50	7,247.50
June 27, 2018 - Skillings Field Athletic Lighting (I)	20,000.00	6,625.00	26,625.00
June 25, 2020 - Swanton Street Bridge Improvements 1 (I)	105,000.00	58,796.10	163,796.10
June 25, 2020 - Swanton Street Bridge Improvements 2 (I)	10,000.00	4,949.76	14,949.76
March 29, 2023 - Transfer Station Engineering I (O)	5,000.00	4,950.00	9,950.00
March 29, 2023 - Transfer Station Engineering II (O)	10,000.00	2,500.00	12,500.00
March 29, 2023 - Transfer Station I (O)	65,000.00	140,150.00	205,150.00
March 29, 2023 - Transfer Station II-a (O)	10,000.00	61,500.00	71,500.00
Subtotal before estimates	266,243.00	313,649.43	579,892.43
Estimates:			
Washington St. Affordable Housing Property Acquisition (Series A Taxable) ($4,050,000)	-	62,437.50	62,437.50
Total General Fund (within Prop 2 1/2)	**266,243.00**	**376,086.93**	**642,329.93**
Total General Fund FY27 Debt Service Budget	**7,680,000.00**	**6,855,034.97**	**14,535,034.97**

SECTION XI

Enterprise Funds

Water and Sewer Enterprise

Recreation Enterprise

WATER AND SEWER ENTERPRISE FUND

Staffing	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	2	2	2	2	
Public Works	13	13	13	13	
Professional/Technical	3	3	3	3	
Total	19	19	19	19	0

Program Description

The Water and Sewer Department, established as a formal enterprise entity in FY2003, operates as a division within the Public Works Department. This division is dedicated to maintaining and enhancing the Town's water storage, treatment, and distribution systems, as well as managing eight sewer pumping stations, the sewer collection network, and the municipal drainage infrastructure.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Rehabilitating the 10” sewer main on Belknap Terrace easement.
- Advancing the Cure-In-Place Pipe (CIPP) lining project on Cambridge Street to strengthen the water main and improve water quality in the area.
- Advancing the Lead Service Replacement Program.
- Coordinating the replacement of the aging Pressure Reducing Valve (PRV) on Wildwood to maintain reliable water pressure and prevent service disruptions.
- Continuing our partnership with Weston & Sampson on the Infiltration/Inflow Reduction Program.
- Finalizing the Water Meter Pilot Program to guide future town-wide implementation.
- Cleaning and restoring the 1-million-gallon storage tank at the water treatment plant.
- Working alongside contractors to replace the Woodside Road sewer lift station, modernizing critical infrastructure.

FY2026 Accomplishments

- Collaborated with Weston & Sampson to complete the permanent Wendell Street Pumping Station.
- Coordinated with Weston & Sampson on the design and planning for the Woodside Road Sewer Lift Station Replacement Project.
- Engaged with consultants on a pilot program to identify the most suitable water meter solution for the town and its residents.
- Replaced 29 water services and completed 16 service repairs.
- Addressed and repaired 13 water main leaks.
- Installed 6 new fire hydrants and performed repairs on 3 existing hydrants.
- Installed 9 new shut-off gate valves.

Statistics				
Water Supply	**2022**	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
Rainfall (Inches)	37.08	64.58	45.01	40.89
Town Reservoir	339 MG	359 MG	358 MG	310 MG
MWRA Direct	520 MG	407 MG	481 MG	515 MG
Total	859 MG	766 MG	839 MG	825 MG

- Conducted 7 repairs on sewer infrastructure.
- Identified and repaired 35 manhole and catch basin structures.
- Performed 70 gas-mark outs and 111 contractor mark-outs.

FY27 WATER & SEWER ENTERPRISE FUND BUDGET - SUMMARY

Estimated Revenue & Other Sources:	
Water & Sewer Receipts	
Usage charges	8,272,160
Liens/interest	176,000
Water repairs	18,000
Sprinkler fee	17,000
Connection fees	2,000
Service charge	950,600
Other miscellaneous	2,000
Interest	100,000
Total Water & Sewer Receipts	9,537,760
Chapter 110 Tax Levy	5,907,469
Retained Earnings	81,621
Total Estimated Revenue & Other Sources	15,526,850
Appropriations & Indirect Costs:	
Appropriations	
Personal Services	
Sewer Operations	425,991
Water Operations	1,380,628
Total Salaries	1,806,619
Expenses	
Sewer Operations	2,862,558
Water Operations	2,103,626
Debt Service	2,194,616
MWRA Capital Assessment	4,638,778
Total Expenses	11,799,578
Total Appropriations	13,606,197
Indirect Costs	
Shared employees & related fringe benefits	1,011,989
Pension	330,645
Health insurance	345,938
Shared professional & other (audit, legal, energy, insurance)	125,812
Other benefits (Medicare, workers comp, unemployment, OPEB)	106,269
Total Indirect Costs	1,920,653
Total Appropriations & Indirect Costs	15,526,850
Surplus (Deficit)	-

		SEWER OPERATIONS	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
9000445	51101	PERMANENT	343,384	347,828	332,183	372,460	372,460	
9000445	51359	OVERTIME	52,531	73,197	52,531	52,531	52,531	
9000445	51901	CLOTHING/BOOT ALLOWANCE	1,000	800	1,000	1,000	1,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**396,915**	**421,824**	**385,714**	**425,991**	**425,991**	**0**
9000445	52116	ELECTRICAL SUPPLIES	4,000	5,985	4,000	4,000	4,000	
9000445	52123	HARDWARE	500	0	500	500	500	
9000445	52125	PAINTING SUPPLIES	200	0	200	200	200	
9000445	52127	PLUMBING, HEATING & VENTILAT	200	0	200	200	200	
9000445	52128	BITUMINOUS PRODUCTS	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000445	52129	MASONRY SUPPLIES	500	0	500	500	500	
9000445	52130	SAND, GRAVEL & LOAM	500	0	500	500	500	
9000445	52137	SUPPLIES, SMALL EQUIPMENT	12,500	11,577	12,500	12,500	12,500	
9000445	52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	2,000	0	2,000	2,000	2,000	
9000445	52152	PIPE & FITTINGS	10,000	9,845	10,000	10,000	10,000	
9000445	52153	CHEMICALS	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000445	52181	PUBLIC SAFETY SUPPLY	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000445	52184	CLOTHING & UNIFORMS	4,200	1,568	4,200	4,200	4,200	
9000445	52186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	12,500	12,348	12,500	12,500	12,500	
9000445	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	1,500	590	1,500	1,500	1,500	
9000445	53112	LIGHT/PWR TWN BLDS	16,000	10,479	16,000	16,000	16,000	
9000445	53118	PROF SERVICES	35,000	35,559	35,000	35,000	35,000	
9000445	53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	300	0	300	300	300	
9000445	53138	R&M BLDG & STRUCT	3,000	0	3,000	3,000	3,000	
9000445	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	500	500	500	500	500	
9000445	54104	MWRA ASSESSMENT	2,248,093	2,023,285	2,478,819	2,626,158	2,626,158	
9000445	54117	PAYMENTS TO MUNICIPALITIES	130,000	123,561	130,000	130,000	130,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**2,484,493**	**2,235,296**	**2,715,219**	**2,862,558**	**2,862,558**	**0**
		TOTAL SEWER	**2,881,408**	**2,657,121**	**3,100,933**	**3,288,549**	**3,288,549**	**0**

		WATER OPERATIONS	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
9000446	51101	PERMANENT	1,156,298	952,195	1,178,182	1,224,298	1,224,298	
9000446	51155	SICKLV BUYBACK - NAGE	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000446	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	5,000	2,456	500	5,000	5,000	
9000446	51251	TEMPORARY	18,000	18,560	18,000	18,000	18,000	
9000446	51359	OVERTIME	129,830	152,845	129,830	129,830	129,830	
9000446	51901	CLOTHING/BOOT ALLOWANCE	2,500	1,600	2,500	2,500	2,500	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**1,312,628**	**1,127,656**	**1,330,012**	**1,380,628**	**1,380,628**	**0**
9000446	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	1,500	123	1,500	1,500	1,500	
9000446	52113	CLEANING SUPPLIES	400	0	400	400	400	
9000446	52116	ELECTRICAL SUPPLIES	1,200	0	1,200	1,200	1,200	
9000446	52123	HARDWARE	1,400	0	1,400	1,400	1,400	
9000446	52125	PAINTING SUPPLIES	0	0	700	700	700	
9000446	52128	BITUMINOUS PRODUCTS	6,000	5,519	6,000	6,000	6,000	
9000446	52130	SAND, GRAVEL & LOAM	5,000	4,317	5,000	5,000	5,000	
9000446	52131	STONE	5,000	6,346	5,000	5,000	5,000	
9000446	52133	READY MIX CONCRETE	5,000	671	5,000	5,000	5,000	
9000446	52134	LUMBER AND WOOD PRODUCTS	1,000	792	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000446	52135	IRON CASTINGS	6,000	5,595	6,000	6,000	6,000	
9000446	52136	AGRICULTURE AND HORTICULTURE	100	0	100	100	100	
9000446	52137	SUPPLIES, SMALL EQUIPMENT	20,000	12,064	20,000	20,000	20,000	
9000446	52143	SMALL TOOLS & IMPLMT	3,000	240	3,000	3,000	3,000	
9000446	52153	CHEMICALS	60,000	40,917	60,000	60,000	60,000	
9000446	52154	METERS & PARTS	75,000	39,398	75,000	75,000	75,000	
9000446	52155	PIPE & FITTINGS	30,000	31,916	30,000	30,000	30,000	
9000446	52181	PUBLIC SAFETY SUPPLY	12,000	10,010	12,000	12,000	12,000	
9000446	52184	CLOTHING & UNIFORMS	3,000	3,251	3,000	3,000	3,000	
9000446	52186	SUPPLIES & MATERIALS	17,000	41,681	17,000	17,000	17,000	
9000446	52250	EQUIPMENT LEASES/RENTALS	0	1,188	2,200	2,200	2,200	
9000446	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	12,000	4,969	12,000	12,000	12,000	
9000446	53107	POSTAGE	11,000	15,671	11,000	11,000	11,000	
9000446	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	12,000	8,938	1,200	1,200	1,200	
9000446	53112	LIGHT/PWR TWN BLDS	75,000	67,441	75,000	75,000	75,000	
9000446	53115	ADVERTISING	500	1,411	500	500	500	
9000446	53118	PROF SERVICES	140,000	187,237	140,000	140,000	140,000	
9000446	53128	COM R&M TOOLS & EQUIPMENT	500	0	500	500	500	
9000446	53138	R&M BLDG & STRUCT	1,000	0	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000446	53158	R&M CARBON FILTER REPLACEMENT	0	0	0	0	0	
9000446	53159	R & M WATER	260,000	236,149	260,000	360,000	360,000	
9000446	53166	TUITION	6,000	7,400	6,000	6,000	6,000	
9000446	53223	NATURAL GAS - WATER TREATMEN	13,774	26,985	14,775	14,775	14,775	
9000446	53238	ANNUAL S/W RENEWALS & SUBSCRIP	2,380	1,950	2,380	2,380	2,380	
9000446	53303	LICENSE REIMBURSEMENT	1,000	1,547	1,000	1,000	1,000	
9000446	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	500	685	500	500	500	
9000446	54102	RENTALS AND STORAGE	2,200	0	0	0	0	
9000446	54104	MWRA ASSESSMENT	921,231	829,108	1,096,287	1,193,071	1,193,071	
9000446	54117	PAYMENTS TO MUNICIPALITIES	0	0	0	0	0	
9000446	55104	COMMUNICATIONS	0	4,128	4,200	4,200	4,200	
9000446	57010	POLICE DETAIL SERVICES	25,000	29,080	25,000	25,000	25,000	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**1,736,685**	**1,626,727**	**1,906,842**	**2,103,626**	**2,103,626**	**0**
		TOTAL WATER	**3,049,313**	**2,754,382**	**3,236,854**	**3,484,254**	**3,484,254**	**0**

		DEBT & MWRA CAPITAL ASSESSMENT	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
9000448	54104	MWRA ASSESSMENT	4,249,948	4,249,948	4,552,338	4,638,778	4,638,778	
9000448	54123	DEBT SERVICE PRINCIPAL	1,361,150	1,361,150	1,501,633	1,539,546	1,539,546	
9000448	54125	DEBT SERVICE INTEREST	444,443	444,443	664,708	655,070	655,070	
		TOTAL DEBT & MWRA CAPITAL ASSESSMENT	**6,055,541**	**6,055,541**	**6,718,679**	**6,833,394**	**6,833,394**	**0**
		TOTAL WATER & SEWER APPROPRIATIONS	**11,986,262**	**11,467,044**	**13,056,466**	**13,606,197**	**13,606,197**	**0**

WATER & SEWER ENTERPRISE FUND FY27 DEBT SERVICE

	Principal	Interest	Total
July 1 2014 - Drainage Improvements (I)	15,000.00	3,946.88	18,946.88
July 1 2014 - Sewer System Repairs (I)	15,000.00	3,778.13	18,778.13
July 1 2015 - South Reservoir Dam Improvements I (O)	65,000.00	24,050.00	89,050.00
July 1 2015 - South Reservoir Dam Improvements II (O)	15,000.00	5,550.00	20,550.00
August 22 2016 - MWRA Sewer (I)	2,177.50	-	2,177.50
February 27, 2017 - MWRA Water (O)	60,000.00	-	60,000.00
August 14, 2017 - MWRA Sewer (I)	16,197.50	-	16,197.50
June 11, 2018 - MWRA Water (O)	67,500.00	-	67,500.00
August 19, 2019 - MWRA Sewer (I)	21,750.00	-	21,750.00
August 22, 2019 - Drainage/Storm Water Improvements (I)	170,000.00	67,456.26	237,456.26
June 1, 2020 - MWRA Water (I)	60,000.00	-	60,000.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref July 1, 2006 Drainage 2 (I)	90,000.00	4,500.00	94,500.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref May 1, 2009 Phase III Drainage (I)	30,000.00	4,500.00	34,500.00
June 25, 2020 - Cur Ref April 15, 2010 Drainage (I)	75,000.00	11,250.00	86,250.00
June 25, 2020 - Dam Improvements (I)	15,000.00	6,935.00	21,935.00
August 10, 2020 Sewer (I)	21,750.00	-	21,750.00
August 10, 2020 Water (I)	60,000.00	-	60,000.00
June 24, 2021 Inflow & Infiltration Study Engineering (O)	270,000.00	126,600.00	396,600.00
August 22, 2022 MWRA Water (I)	60,000.00	-	60,000.00
March 29, 2023 - Saw Mill Brook Drainage & Reservoir Spillway (I)	15,000.00	15,250.00	30,250.00
February 24 2025 MWRA Sewer (I)	109,000.00	-	109,000.00
March 27 2025 - Arbor Ln & Wendell St Pumping Station (O)	60,000.00	46,950.00	106,950.00
March 27 2025 - South Reservoir Dam Feasibility (I)	5,000.00	2,800.00	7,800.00
March 27 2025 - South Reservoir Dam Engineering (I)	20,000.00	18,400.00	38,400.00
March 27 2025 - Vactor Truck (I)	70,000.00	24,000.00	94,000.00
May 19 2025 MWRA Water (I)	21,400.00	-	21,400.00
June 9 2025 MWRA Water (I)	60,000.00	-	60,000.00
BANs issued 7/18/25:			
Woodside Road Pumping Station Engineering $150,000	-	4,812.91	4,812.91
South Reservoir Dam Improvements $6,000,000	-	192,516.34	192,516.34
Woodside Road Pumping Station Remodeling $1,500,000	-	48,129.08	48,129.08
Cambridge Street Water System Improvements $800,000	-	25,668.85	25,668.85
Subtotal before estimates	1,489,775.00	637,093.45	2,126,868.45
Estimates:			
GOB - Arbor Lane & Wendell Street Area Pumping Station	18,846.00	9,998.93	28,844.93
BAN - Cambridge St. Area Water Quality Investigation Design & Eng (Series B) $200,000	-	7,977.78	7,977.78
Total Water & Sewer	**1,508,621.00**	**655,070.16**	**2,163,691.16**

RECREATION DEPARTMENT

Staffing	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Request	FY27 Manager	FY27 FinCom
Managerial	1	1	1	1	
Clerical	2	2	2	2	
Professional/Technical	2	3	4	4	
Total	5	6	7	7	0

Program Description

The Winchester Recreation Department designs unique year-round and seasonal recreational programs offered to all Winchester residents. Led by qualified instructors, our programs offer participants affordable opportunities for a wide variety of passive and active recreation, wellness, and leisure activities and oversight and coordination of the use and permitting of all the towns fields, courts, and recreational areas.

The Recreation Department operates as an Enterprise Fund. Programs are self-supported by setting user fees to cover all departmental expenses including indirect costs to other town departments that support the department. The recreation department's operating budget funds all recreation expenses: staff, supplies and materials, professional services needed to run the department such as cleaning of buildings, maintenance to facilities and recreational areas, snow removal, burglar alarms and pest control. Surplus revenues generated through the enterprise fund are logged into a retained earnings account that can fund capital improvement projects, COLA increases, new recreation initiatives, budget shortfalls or budget growth. Retained earnings expenditure can only be approved by an affirmative vote at Annual Town Meetings.

An additional responsibility of the department is the management and scheduling of athletic fields, court and open space rentals and reservations through two separate revolving accounts, the Synthetic Field Account and the Grass Field Account. These accounts are governed by town by laws and expenditure from the accounts must specifically be listed in the bylaws. Expenditures are voted on and approved by the Field Management Committee and must be signed off on by the Town Managers office for final approval. The goal of these accounts is to reinvest funds back into fields, parks and sport courts for general maintenance, improvements, and upkeep.

FY2027 Initiatives

- Grow Packer Ellis Tennis Program by adding programs, events and tournaments through recruiting and utilizing Recreation Staff.
- Continue collaboration with other town departments, WCCP, boards, and citizen groups on new initiatives that will improve recreational opportunities, facilities, and grounds.
- Continue addressing facility needs at recreation department-controlled facilities - improving the building and grounds utilizing grants, fundraising, collaboration with

private groups and individuals and working within the Capital Expenditures Committee.

- Working with the School Department to address the need for additional afterschool recreation department led program options in each school to enhance equity in opportunities and offerings.
- Seek to expand adult offerings through local partnerships with in-town businesses and building collaborations with organizations such as Rotary and The Chamber of Commerce.
- Create policies, procedures and recreational programming for the new sand volleyball courts at the Borggaard Beach area and continue working with The Friends of Wedge Pond on the rejuvenation plan for the recreational area by reimagining the space.
- Seek out additional summer programming options for MS youth and pre-teen participants.
- Add adult sport leagues mirroring the success of the adult softball league.
- Explore additional program facilities through partnerships.

FY2026 Accomplishments

Entering FY26 the Recreation Department ended FY25 by growing the retained earnings fund to $994,830 from $1,195,000 after deducting indirect costs, recreation expenses and all departmental overhead. The Department continued to grow programming by expanding existing offerings and adding new programs, specifically targeting new adult, middle school, sports and summer offerings

The department continues to secure grant money that has offset costs and allows the department to update the recreational facility, offset capital requests and add much needed new equipment and supplies. The department has grown sponsorship revenue for Concerts at the Common and at Packer Ellis Tennis Facility that defray the cost of operating both.

- EEC C3 grant- Applied and secured a 12-month grant that will total $166,800 for FY 26.

Capital Project Updates

- Ginn Field Light replacement completed
- Design and Engineering: Packer Ellis Tennis Court improvements conceptual design completed
- Town-wide park and playground fencing repairs (funding from Capital and WCCP)- expected completion early Summer 2026
- New bathroom doors and auto locks at McDonald and Ginn fields: Expected completion Summer 2026
- Playground updates Mystic School Recreation Department by Fall of 2026
- Addition of safety netting and new fencing McDonald Playground and Fencing at Leonard Playground as part of the playground projects and state earmark funds.

    - Purchase of new rec vehicle using Recreation retained earnings via Capital expected for Spring of 2026

- Other funded Projects
    - Borgaard Volleyball Courts expected completion Spring 2026- funding through private donations
    - Collaborated with Friends of Winchester Recreation on engineering and permitting of Ginn Pickleball courts through WCCP money- expected completion Spring 2026.
    - Leonard Basketball Court renovation- expected completion summer 2026.

Funded Facility Projects at Mystic through grant expenditures

- New flooring including abatement in two classrooms
- Engineering for temporary facility shoring

Scholarships: Funded over $24,000 in financial aid toward recreation programs and recreation child care.

$2,540 – From donations toward Neighbors Helping Neighbors Fund
$6,267.50 – From ENKA private scholarships
$15,483.50 –From Recreation operating revenue (unfunded aid)

FY27 RECREATION ENTERPRISE FUND BUDGET - SUMMARY

Estimated Revenue & Other Sources:	
Recreation Receipts	
Kid Connection	335,835
WRAP	840,800
Lynch	-
Full Day Summer Adventures/Sports Adv	125,500
Half Day Summer Adventures	94,800
Rec Contract Programs	582,000
Rec Staffed Programs	167,287
Packer Ellis Tennis	221,500
Special Events	10,500
Borreggard Beach	10,630
Trips	70,625
Adult Progamming	39,400
Rec Basketball	101,550
Wrestling	8,700
Summer Speed Strength and Conditioning	114,750
Summer Sports Adventures	42,210
Flag Fooball	59,400
Miscellaneous	8,096
Interest	35,000
Total Recreation Receipts	2,868,583
General Fund Subsidy	175,000
Retained Earnings	-
Total Estimated Revenue & Other Sources	**3,043,583**
Appropriations & Indirect Costs:	
Appropriations	
Personal Services	1,638,340
Expenses	993,220
Total Appropriations	2,631,560
Indirect Costs	
Shared employees & related fringe benefits	87,335
Pension	112,050
Health insurance	125,550
Shared professional & other (audit, legal, energy, insurance)	44,425
Other benefits (Medicare, workers comp, unemployment, OPEB)	42,663
Total Indirect Costs	412,023
Total Appropriations & Indirect Costs	**3,043,583**
Surplus (Deficit)	-

		RECREATION	FY25 BUDGET	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 BUDGET	FY27 REQUEST	FY27 MANAGER	FY27 FINCOM
9010	51101	PERMANENT	576,116	575,310	609,115	630,845	630,845	
9010	51161	SICK LEAVE BUYBACK - NON-UNION	2,250	1,714	2,250	2,250	2,250	
9010	51251	TEMPORARY	942,240	796,677	1,008,490	1,003,246	1,003,246	
9010	51359	OVERTIME	3,588	1,417	3,588	2,000	2,000	
		PERSONAL SERVICES TOTAL	**1,524,194**	**1,375,118**	**1,623,443**	**1,638,340**	**1,638,340**	**0**
9010	52101	OFFICE SUPPLIES	2,200	1,294	2,200	2,200	2,200	
9010	52176	RECREATIONAL SUPPLIES	22,116	12,598	27,639	31,160	31,160	
9010	52180	FOOD & GROCERIES	5,550	4,002	7,600	9,750	9,750	
9010	52184	CLOTHING AND UNIFORMS	18,218	16,798	24,762	40,380	40,380	
9010	52186	SUPPLIES AND MATERIALS	5,300	1,058	4,450	3,000	3,000	
9010	53101	PRINTING & STATIONERY	5,000	3,469	5,000	5,000	5,000	
9010	53107	POSTAGE	1,000	0	1,000	500	500	
9010	53110	TELEPHONE TOWN BLDGS	4,000	3,877	4,000	4,300	4,300	
9010	53115	ADVERTISING	1,500	100	1,500	1,500	1,500	
9010	53118	PROF. SERVICES	565,804	466,544	626,428	731,220	731,220	
9010	53146	PROF SVC - MAINTENACE MYSTIC	37,000	33,305	37,000	41,000	41,000	
9010	53162	TRANSPORTATION	19,200	12,725	17,860	33,800	33,800	
9010	54101	DUES AND MEMBERSHIPS	2,480	2,445	2,500	3,595	3,595	
9010	54129	BANK SERVICE CHARGES	74,025	59,412	80,260	85,890	85,815	
		EXPENSES TOTAL	**763,393**	**617,627**	**842,199**	**993,295**	**993,220**	**0**
9010	59700	Transfer Out - Indirect Costs	448,777	448,777	418,923	412,024	412,023	
		TOTAL RECREATION APPROPRIATIONS	**2,736,364**	**2,441,522**	**2,884,565**	**3,043,659**	**3,043,583**	**0**

SECTION XII

Capital Planning Committee Report

October 9, 2025

To: Town Meeting

RE: Capital Planning Report

From: Roger McPeek, Chair, and Members of the Capital Planning Committee

CC: Select Board
Interim Town Manager
Finance Committee
Town Moderator

An Unusual Year
At first glance, the number of proposed projects may suggest a banner year for the Town. However, the reality is more nuanced. Many of this year's proposals are lower-cost projects such as improvements to Mystic Playground, replacement of police Tasers and town voting machines, as well as restroom door upgrades at athletic fields.

Unable to fund Town Hall HVAC
Despite the volume of projects, we are unable to fund our top-ranked building project: the Town Hall HVAC system. Estimated at $8.5 million, this project will require funding from a source other than the Building Stabilization Fund (BSF). Town Hall has not undergone a significant renovation in over 35 years. The Committee strongly believes that this project—plus other high-cost, near-term Town Hall needs—should be bundled into a comprehensive renovation package. Coordinating these projects together would minimize both staff disruption (relocation will be required) and overall costs.

Planning for Symmes Corner
The Committee is proposing to begin a multi-year design and permitting process for the reconfiguration of Symmes Corner. The total cost for design and permitting is estimated at $600,000, with $300,000 requested at this Town Meeting to reach the 25% design point. While construction is expected to exceed $5 million—an amount we currently do not have—MassDOT has indicated it will fully fund the construction phase if the Town completes design and permitting.

Fire Equipment Reserve
We remain concerned about the upcoming need to replace two major Fire Department vehicles over the next two years. In anticipation of these costs—estimated at $2.5 million—we are proposing an additional $500,000 be reserved in the Capital Stabilization Fund (CSF), bringing the total reserved to $1 million. With lead times of 12–24 months for fire apparatus, the Committee believes we cannot defer these purchases.

Carriage House Decision
After more than a decade of discussion, the School Committee, Select Board, and Capital Planning Committee now recommend demolition of the Carriage House. Town Meeting previously rejected renovation of the Carriage House for school administrative use. The building contains asbestos and mold, and renovation costs would be in the millions of dollars. While a difficult decision, we believe demolition and future repurposing of the site is in the Town's best interests. We will bring this project to Spring Town Meeting with the School Committee and Select Board as co-sponsors.

CPA Coordination and Opportunities
This year marks the first availability of Community Preservation Act (CPA) funds under the direction of the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation (WCCP). The CPC partnered with the WCCP on the Lincoln Chiller and Recreation Fencing/Backstop projects. CPC funded two projects, Mystic Playground and Restrooms at athletic fields, which had also applied for WCCP funding. Likewise, the WCCP funded two projects that also applied for CPC funding: Ginn Field restoration and design/engineering for Ginn pickleball courts. However, as the WCCP was establishing itself this summer, coordination between committees was limited. We expect that there will be stronger collaboration in future cycles.

Roads and Sidewalks
Chapter 90 state funding and CSF funds totaling about $1M are used together annually to keep our roads and sidewalks maintained.

However, unforeseen work on the Shore Road culvert project added $312,000 in costs. To keep the project on schedule during this construction cycle, the Town Manager chose to use Chapter 90 funds to cover that amount.

Given the Town's strong Free Cash position much of which was driven by automobile excise tax receipts, CPC is now asking Town Meeting to approve an additional allocation of $300,000 in Free Cash for the Roads and Sidewalks project, in addition to the proposed $350,000 contribution from the CSF.

Everett Avenue Culvert
The Everett Avenue culvert project was delayed last year due to design and easement issues. While design is complete, not all abutters have agreed to the proposed easements and have raised broader concerns regarding drainage in the area of the culvert. As a result, the Select Board and Management believe a review of conditions in the area of the culvert are warranted and that further consultation with the abutters regarding easements is required. Accordingly, this project will be further delayed.

The Song Remains the Same
(With apologies to Led Zeppelin)

The CPC has completed its evaluation of capital project requests for the next five years, and the outlook remains challenging. Projections now include approximately **$43 million in building projects** and **$51 million in other capital needs**, in current dollars. Without new funding sources, we face a shortfall of approximately **$22 million in building projects (BSF)** and **$32 million in other capital projects (CSF)**. It should be noted that these are the projects/needs that the CPC is currently aware of.

These amounts are the "known knowns." The town also needs to be aware of the "known unknowns." That is to say, sometimes (most years) stuff just breaks, and the Town needs to be prepared for when that happens. In the past we have had pieces of heavy equipment fail beyond the point of reasonable economic repair and building systems such as boilers or a/c systems fail unexpectedly that have required repair or replacement in the hundreds of thousands of dollars. When that happens, scheduled projects get delayed in order to fund these emergent repairs, our costs increase, and our backlog grows.

While we will make progress this year, we began this cycle with **nearly $15 million in building project requests** and **$4.6 million in other capital requests**. Notably, the Town already has complete or nearly complete, designs for multiple building projects. These were deferred—not for lack of merit—but due to prioritization and funding constraints.

In addition to previously mentioned Fire Department vehicle needs, the anticipated costs of these and other essential projects will strain the Stabilization Funds in coming years.

The current Stabilization Funds alone are insufficient to address capital needs of this scale. Additional funding—whether through overrides, Free Cash, responsible bonding, or debt exclusions—will be necessary. The Committee will continue to work closely with the Select Board and the State of the Town committee to explore and secure additional appropriate funding sources.

Finally, we wish to extend our sincere thanks to Department Heads, the Select Board, and especially **Mark Twogood, Assistant Town Manager (now retired)**, and **Margaret White, Special Projects Manager (now retired)**, and **Stacie Ward, Town Comptroller (with us for now)**, for their dedication and diligence in preparing the FY27 Capital Plan.

Respectfully,

Roger McPeek, Chair Capital Planning Committee
Brian Vernaglia, Vice Chair
Stefanie Mnayarji, Member
Helen S. Philliou, Member
Enzo Rascionato, Member
Richard Rohan, Member
Gerry Sheehan, Member

This year the CPC anticipates the use of the following funds for the FY 26 Capital Projects:

Capital Stabilization Funds	$2,345,000
Building Stabilization Funds	$3,650,000
Recreation Enterprise Funds	$53,000
Water Sewer Borrowing	$1,837,000 *
Water Sewer Retained Earnings	$475,000
Free Cash –	$300,000
Total:	**$8,660,000**

*Much of this borrowing is in the form of a MWRA loan/grant

This year alone there were nearly $20 million in Capital Stabilization Fund, Building Stabilization Fund and Water Sewer requests. The table below summarizes the FY 27-31 request totals.

Capital Planning Five Year Summary Table

Department	**FY 27**	**FY 28-31***	**5-Year Total**
ADA	$125,000	$500,000	$625,000**
DPW Buildings	$10,675,000	$19,290,000	$29,965,000
DPW Cemetery	$70,000	$280,000	$350,000
DPW Roads & Sidewalks	$550,000	$2,200,000	$2,750,000
DPW Vehicle/Equipment	$200,000	$1,965,000	$2,165,000
DPW Water & Sewer	$2,175,000	$4,495,000	$6,670,000
Engineering Regulatory	$200,000	$4,900,000	$5,100,000
Engineering Water Quality	$75,000	$800,000	$875,000
Engineering Transportation	$630,000	$26,250,000	$26,880,000
Fire Department	$0	$3,800,000	$3,800,000
Police Department	$124,000	$420,000	$544,000
Recreation	$545,000	$10,485,000	$11,030,000
Schools	$4,340,000	$9,800,000	$14,140,000
Town Manager (other)	$200,000	$70,000	$270,000
Totals:	**$19,909,000**	**$85,255,000**	**$105,164,000**

*FY 28-31 are estimated amounts

** The Transition Plan is currently being reviewed, and CPC expects the 5-year total to increase

The Five-Year Total is more than $105 million

The Building Stabilization Fund (BSF) is used for building maintenance, repairs and new construction. The Capital Stabilization Fund (CSF) is used for fields and playgrounds, roads and sidewalks, equipment, flood mitigation and bridge repair. After the funds available for the FY 27 capital budget were allocated, there remain unfunded projects which include, in no particular order:

- Town Hall HVAC Replacement Project
- Town Hall Window Replacement
- Lincoln School Sitework/Flatwork
- Multiple Vehicle Replacements
- Town and Schools Fiber Optic Network Review
- Town Clerk Space Needs Study
- Winter Pond Water Quality Improvements
- Wedge Pond Water Quality Improvements
- Ridge Street at Lockland Road Intersection Study
- Westland Road at Wildwood Street Intersection Improvement
- Traffic Calming Projects

Fall Town Meeting - FY27 CPC Recommended Projects

Building Projects

Building Stabilization Fund

1. Lincoln School Chiller Final Design/Construction (lower level)	$2,150,000[1]
Sub-Total Building Stabilization Fund Projects	**$2,150,000**

Capital Projects

Capital Stabilization Fund

1. Everett Avenue Culvert	~~$600,000~~ deferred
2. Removal underground fuel tanks (Library & Public Safety)	$100,000
3. Repairs to Ambrose School Pedestrian Walkway	$50,000
4. Symmes Corner Traffic Improvement Design	$300,000
5. Kenwin Road Traffic Calming Engineering/Construction	$150,000
6. DPW Facilities Aerial Lift Vehicle	$100,000
7. Highway/Cemetery Backhoe	$140,000[2]
8. Implementation of Risk Assessment Plan	$75,000
9. DPW Highway, Dump Truck	$100,000
10. Mystic School Playground Upgrades	$50,000
11. Voting Machines Replacement	$40,000
12. Bathroom Door Repair/Replace/Lock Sys. Ginn & McDonald	$36,000
13. Police Department Taser Replacement	$49,000
14. Health Department Vehicle	$50,000
15. Backstop & Fence Repair/Replacement – Parks & Fields	$60,000[3]
16. Roads & Sidewalks	$650,000[4]
Total Capital Stabilization Fund Projects Fall Town Meeting	**$1,950,000**

Recreation Enterprise

Retained Earnings

1. Recreation Department Vehicle	$53,000
Total Recreation Enterprise Projects Fall Town Meeting	**$53,000**

Water & Sewer Enterprise

Retained Earnings/Repurposing of Unexpended Bond Proceeds

1. Computer Programming at Water Treatment Plant	$75,000
2. Water Treatment Plant Contact Tank Cleaning/Repair	$200,000

Borrowing

1. I & I East Side Sewer Rehabilitation Project (MWRA)	$1,237,000
2. Wildwood Street Pressure Reducing Valve	$600,000
Total Water & Sewer Fall Town Meeting	**$2,112,000**
TOTAL FALL CPC RECOMMENDATIONS	**$6,315,000**

[1]$50,000 in funding is anticipated in CPA funds via the WCCP for a total project cost of $2.2M [2] $70,000 in funding is coming from the Cemetery Perpetual Care fund and $70,000 from CSF [3]$51,000 in funding is anticipated in CPA funds via the WCCP for a total project cost of $111K [4]$300,000 is requested to be allocated from Free Cash

Spring Town Meeting – FY27 CPC Recommended Projects

<u>Building Projects</u>

Building Stabilization Fund	
1. Town Hall Roof & Bell Tower [1]	$1,500,000
Sub-Total Building Stabilization Fund Projects	
	$1,500,0
00 <u>Capital Projects</u>	
Capital Stabilization Fund	
1. ADA Transition Plan	$125,000
2. Carriage House Abatement/Demolition	$300,000
Total Capital Stabilization Fund Projects	
	$425,00
0 <u>Water & Sewer Enterprise</u>	
Retained Earnings	
1. MS4 Permitting	$200,000
Total Water & Sewer Retained Earnings	**$200,000**
TOTAL SPRING CPC RECOMMENDATIONS	**$2,125,000**

[1]It is anticipated that this appropriation will be funded with unexpended bond proceeds/capital account closeouts.

FY 27 Project Descriptions – Fall Funding

BUILDING STABILIZATION FUND

Lincoln Elementary School Chiller Final Design/Construction ($2.2M)
This appropriation will fund the completion of the plans and specifications for the chiller replacement project at the Lincoln Elementary School. The existing chiller and rooftop HVAC unit have both failed and are in need of complete replacement given the age of the equipment, availability of parts and environmental concerns. Both units will be placed on the roof. The chiller will be replaced with a new air-source heat pump and HVAC unit. The CSF will fund
$2,150,000 of this $2,200,000 project with $50K in funds being provided by CPA funding

CAPITAL STABILIZATION FUNDS

Everett Avenue Culvert ($600K)
This project has been deferred to allow for additional study of drainage flow issues in the area of the culvert and further consultations with abutters.

Removal of Underground Fuel Tanks at the Winchester Public Library and the Public Safety Building ($100K) This appropriation will fund the removal of underground fuel storage tanks located at the Public Library and the Public Safety Building. Both tanks are now obsolete as both buildings operate on natural gas and are therefore required to be removed per code. The funding request includes Licensed Site Professional services, tank cleaning, removal and disposal, removal of internal piping and site and landscape restoration.

Repairs to Ambrose School Pedestrian Walkway ($50K)
This appropriation will fund the complete replacement of the deteriorated concrete pavers along the main entrance sidewalk at the Ambrose Elementary School. The existing pavers are crumbling and are creating significant trip hazards for students, parents, teachers and visitors. The pavers will be replaced with pour-in-place concrete.

Symmes Corner Traffic Calming/Construction ($300K)
This appropriation will fund 25% design for improvements to the Symmes Corner rotary. CPC anticipates an additional
$300K in design work funding will be needed in the future to complete design and permitting. The town has applied to the State Transportation Improvement Program (TIP) and believes it will get full funding for construction, once design is complete. This project ranked as a high priority in the Towns Transportation Plan in part due to its high crash history and public comment. The request to fund 100% design will follow in future years.

Kenwin Road Traffic Calming Engineering/Construction ($150K)
This appropriation will fund traffic calming improvements to Kenwin Road. Kenwin connects Highland Avenue, Washington Street and Cross Street. The improvements include the installation of three chicanes along the street to reduce traffic speeds, as well as the installation of a new crosswalk and Rapid Flashing Beacon across Highland Avenue.

DPW Facilities Aerial Lift Vehicle ($100K)
This appropriation will fund a new F550 one-ton chassis to be outfitted with a utility body and an aerial lift (bucket lift). The current vehicle is 17 years old and can no longer handle the weight of the current lift making it unstable and no longer safe to utilize.

Highway/Cemetery Backhoe ($140K)
This appropriation will fund the replacement of the cemetery backhoe. This backhoe is specifically designed for the use within a cemetery but can also be utilized by the Highway Department. The design is for a lighter machine that disperses the weight of the machine to be able to move between graves without causing damage. The machine is also narrower than a typical backhoe and has a stabilizer design that does not extend horizontally allowing it to be able to dig between gravestones. The current machine was purchased in 2008 and has logged 6,100 hours of service. The cost to recondition the machine would be above $80,000.

Implementation of Risk Assessment Plan ($75K)
This is an ongoing program of improvements to town properties improving security. Funds will be spent on providing upgraded security for the Recreation building to include camera systems, door entry systems, and improved lighting. These systems can be integrated with existing Town (Schools) systems if needed or desired.

DPW Highway, Dump Truck ($100K)
This appropriation will fund the purchase of a new F550 one-ton dump truck or equivalent for use by the Highway Department for groundwork as well as snow and ice operations. This vehicle replaces a 2012 F450 one-tone dump truck which has reached the point where it requires costly regular maintenance. The new vehicle will be outfitted with a plow but will mostly be used for transporting brush, stumps, trees and gravel to and from various projects.

Mystic School Playground Updates ($50K)
This appropriation will fund the installation of 2 shade structures and an outdoor ADA compliant drinking fountain and water bottle filling station at the Mystic Playground. Shade structures will provide necessary sun protection for children and families, reducing heat exposure and increasing comfort during summer months. Water bottle filling stations will encourage hydration and reduce the use of disposable plastic bottles, aligning with both public health and environmental sustainability goals. These improvements are intended to enhance the overall usability of Mystic Playground and support year-round recreational programs and activities, special events and public use. This project was eligible for CPA funding.

Voting Machines Replacement ($40K)
This appropriation will fund the replacement of the current voting machines which were purchased in 2015. Their age has been requiring increased repairs. The State is looking to consolidate the types of machines being used and is offering Municipalities a $12,000 discount on the newer models.

Bathroom Door Repair/Replace/Lock System Ginn & McDonald Fields ($36K)
This appropriation will fund the repair and replacement of bathroom doors at the Ginn Field and McDonald Field facilities, along with the installation of new timed door locks. Both fields are heavily used for youth sports, recreation programming, and community events, and restroom accessibility is essential to maintaining safe and functional public spaces. The addition of timing locks will align restroom access with park operating hours, ensuring facilities are available when the parks are open while reducing vandalism and misuse that has resulted from leaving doors unlocked due to limited staffing. Collectively, these improvements will address safety concerns, improve accessibility and security, and ensure that the facilities remain reliable and well maintained for the community. This project was eligible for CPA funding.

Police Department Taser Replacement ($49K)
This appropriation will fund the replacement of the original 2016 tasers for the Police Department. Funds will cover hardware costs for the tasers, holsters, training cartridges, batteries, charging systems and live carry cartridges. Tasers are one of three less than lethal options on our police officers' duty belts and are a de-escalation tool.

Health Department Vehicle ($50K)
This appropriation will fund a new electric vehicle for the Health Department. This vehicle will replace the current 2016 Ford Focus electric vehicle. The current vehicle has reached the end of its useful life, and its driving range has decreased to a point of making it unusable and we have been advised that it is uneconomic to repair. The Town will pursue applicable state and federal grant reimbursements that may reduce the net cost of acquisition.

Backstop & Fence Repair/Replacement ($111K)
This appropriation will fund the repair or replacement of fencing and backstops at multiple locations including dugouts and backstop replacement at West Side A Field, backstop and fence repair at Ciarcia Turf Field and McDonald Field, back stop repair at Ginn River and Ginn Track Fields, backstop repairs at Mullen Field, new fence installation at Leonard Playground and McDonald Playground. The CSF will fund $61K of this $111,000 project with $50K in funds being provided by CPA funding.

Roads and Sidewalks ($650K)
This appropriation will fund the annual allocation for roads and sidewalk repairs, and CPC is recommending both CSF funding and a Free Cash allocation.

RECREATION ENTERPRISE

Recreation Department Vehicle ($53K)
This appropriation will fund the replacement of an aging retired police Ford Interceptor gas vehicle in the Recreation Department with a hybrid Ford F150 model. The vehicle will be used daily to support departmental operations, including program transportation, park and facility checks, event set up, and delivery of supplies and equipment essential to the seasonal programming for the recreation department. Recreation programming takes place in many different locations throughout Winchester. Transitioning to a hybrid vehicle will reduce fuel consumption, lower emissions, and support the Town's broader sustainability and climate action initiatives, while also providing a reliable and cost-effective means of meeting operational needs. Funding for this vehicle will come from the Recreation Enterprise Retained Earnings Account. The Recreation Department will work closely with the Town's Sustainability Director to pursue applicable state and federal grant reimbursements that may reduce the net cost of acquisition.

WATER & SEWER ENTERPRISE FUND – RETAINED EARNINGS OF UNEXPENDED BOND PROCEEDS

Computer Programming at Water Treatment Plant ($75K)
This appropriation will fund the replacement of computers and computer software used for the operation of the Water Treatment Plant. The software is now outdated, and the support of this version will be ending soon. New software is required for the continual operation and for a more robust security of the operation. This project was previously voted for funding by Town Meeting, but a lack of retained earnings last year saw the program slip into this year and must be revoted.

Water Treatment Plant Contact Tank Cleaning/Repair ($200K)
This appropriation will fund essential maintenance and upgrades to the Water Treatment Plant's 1-million-gallon Clear Well Tank to ensure continued compliance with Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) standards and to maintain the safety and quality of our community's drinking water. As the final storage stage in the treatment process, the Clear Well holds filtered water, allowing disinfectants sufficient time to inactivate remaining pathogens. Over time, biofilm and sediments have accumulated inside the tank, necessitating a thorough draining and cleaning. Additionally, the tank's exterior requires minor restoration to address weathering and preserve structural integrity. Specific compliance-related issues, identified during recent inspections, will also be corrected to meet DEP regulations. The project scope includes draining and cleaning the tank to remove biofilm and sediment, performing exterior repairs, and implementing required compliance upgrades.

WATER & SEWER ENTERPRISE FUND – BORROWING

I&I East Side Sewer Rehabilitation Project ($1.237M)
This appropriation will fund the engineering investigation, design, and construction of the phase 2 of the East Side Sanitary Sewer I&I project. This project is part of an ongoing program to help to mitigate infiltration and inflow into the towns sewer system, reducing treatment costs, improve environmental sustainability, and ensure resilient infrastructure for the community. This project is funded in significant part by the MWRA.

Wildwood Street Pressure Reducing Valves ($600K)
This appropriation will fund the replacement of the Pressure Reducing Valves located on Wildwood Road. The existing valves have failed and/or exceeded their anticipated service life. This project includes engineering services for the redesign of the valves and the addition of isolation shut-off valves and repairs to the existing vault as well as the replacement and repair work.

Capital Planning Process

The process for evaluating capital project requests begins in June of every year and culminates at Fall Town Meeting. All elected and appointed Boards, Committees and school and municipal departments are requested to submit next FY requests and projected 5 year needs in order to create a comprehensive five-year needs assessment for the Town. This year participation includes School Committee, Select Board, Town Manager, Energy Management Committee, Disabilities Access Commission, and virtually all municipal department heads. These requests are processed by Town staff, reviewed by Town management, and submitted to the CPC for evaluation and prioritization.

The CPC consists of the following members per the Town's charter. Two members appointed by the Finance Committee, one member appointed by the Planning Board, one member appointed by the School Committee and three members appointed by the Select Board. The makeup of the CPC was designed to be inclusive of multiple viewpoints and relies on each member representing an appointed Board or Committee to report back to said Committee and also bring forward concerns and/or issues back to the CPC.
The CPC in evaluating each project relies on each Town entity submitting a proposal to take into consideration their immediate and long-term capital needs. A major tool that is used by the Town in developing our long-term immediate building repairs is the VFA/Gordian Building Envelope Program. This program helps to develop the expected life cycle and cost estimates for building system maintenance upgrade and replacement.

While the Town Manager is ultimately responsible for the town capital plan, through its active participation and guidance in the prioritization process, Town management allows residents to influence the capital process through its elected and appointed representatives. This program allows for long term capital planning, which helps the Town prioritize its five-year plan and align with the desires of town residents.

Additionally, the Department of Public Works and the Engineering Department have developed a comprehensive program for sewer, water, drainage, roads, traffic, sidewalks and flood mitigation projects. The Field Management Committee together with the DPW and School Department have developed a five-year field improvements plan. All of these tools utilized by the various Town agencies contribute to the development of a comprehensive plan for maintaining and improving the Town infrastructure and assets.

Project Evaluation Criteria

Fundamental to Capital Planning evaluation is a ranking process that allows the CPC to evaluate each individual project in a consistent manner. The ranking is based on the following criteria:

- Public Health and Safety
- Mandates by State or Federal Government
- Necessary for Maintenance of Town Assets
- Demonstrated Increased Efficiency and /or Cost Savings

Each project request is required to address the following items when submitting to the CPC.

1) Expected lifetime of the item/project.
2) Expected operating costs of and manpower available to complete or use the item or project.
3) Comparison of purchasing versus leasing or outside contracting of the service and, where relevant, the cost of multi-town sharing of resources or equipment.
4) Need for the item/project and its effect on the operating budget-what it might save in maintenance and repair.
5) Departmental priorities for the current year's projects/items.
6) Cost estimates of the item/project, supported by bids or quotes whenever possible.
7) A plan detailing item/projects awarded during the past three (3) years and those to be requested over the next three (3) years.
8) A schedule of implementation for approved items and projects, including a timeline within the proposed FY.

One of the critical steps in completing the CPC's evaluation of each project is meeting individually with department representatives seeking project funding. In these meetings we discuss where the request fits into the overall goals for departmental long-range capital plans. In this process each party submitting a request is asked to ensure that alternative strategies for meeting their needs have been considered. It is also required that each party has evaluated utilizing alternative funding sources as well, if available.